



Development Finance for Gender Equality 2024



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Foreword

The 2024 *DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* provides a framework for promoting gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls in development co-operation and humanitarian assistance globally, throughout policy frameworks, design and planning, programming and financing, monitoring and evaluation, and in development partners' own internal structures and systems. In addition, the *Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls: DAC Guidance for Development Partners* sets out practical guidance and good practice examples for doing so. In the Recommendation, DAC members have committed to striving “to increase financing for gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls through official development assistance (ODA) and other forms of finance”.

In that context, *Development Finance for Gender Equality 2024* presents a fresh overview of international development finance globally and the extent to which it contributes to gender equality. In an effort to promote transparency and accountability, it presents and unpacks OECD data on development finance with gender equality objectives, exploring trends, analysing different actors' efforts, uncovering new details, and suggesting areas where finance can be better used to advance gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls around the world. Findings aim to spur a culture where all development finance is spent in a way that advances, or at the very least is not harmful to, gender equality and where information about financial investments are reported and made publicly available.

This first, comprehensive report on *Development Finance for Gender Equality* comes at a time when progress towards the gender equality goal in the 2030 Agenda on Sustainable Development is stalling. OECD analysis shows a recent drop in the share of financing with a gender equality focus overall, with a particularly worrying trend within humanitarian assistance. Knowing where financing is going is essential for decision makers to steer progress and implement the *DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls*. It is all the more crucial as the international community prepares for the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development in July 2025, and the Beijing Platform for Action celebrates its 30th Anniversary in 2025. The report also contributes to implementing broader OECD efforts, as set out in the 2023 “OECD’s contribution to promoting gender equality” report.

Chapter 1 of this report provides an overview of all international development finance for gender equality, including by DAC and non-DAC countries, multilateral organisations and banks, and private actors. Chapter 2 focuses on DAC members' funding for gender equality and discusses its relative decline in the context of a global pushback against whole-of-society inclusion and gender equality. Chapter 3 sheds light on how gender equality is integrated across thematic areas which are either of key importance to strengthening women's voices and achieving transformative change for gender equality, or provide opportunities for increased investments in gender equality: fragile- and conflict-affected states and humanitarian assistance; energy; women's rights organisations and feminist movements; reproductive health and rights; and inequalities at the intersection of gender. Chapter 4 explores development finance for gender equality by development actors beyond the DAC. Chapter 5 closes with overarching conclusions and policy recommendations. Annex A provides methodological definitions and clarifications.

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Abbreviations and acronyms

ADB	Asian Development Bank
ADF	Asian Development Fund
CRS	Creditor Reporting System
CSO	Civil society organisation
DAC	Development Assistance Committee
DRR	Disaster risk reduction
EU	European Union
GBV	Gender-based violence
LGBTQIA+	Lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer, intersex, asexual and gender-diverse
NGO	Non-governmental organisation
ODA	Official development assistance
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
OOF	Other official flows
PD/GG	Participatory development/good governance
PSI	Private sector investment
RMNCH	Reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SRHR	Sexual and reproductive health and rights
STD	Sexually transmitted disease
TOSSD	Total official support for sustainable development
UN	United Nations
USD	United States dollar
WFP	World Food Programme
WRO	Women's rights organisation

Executive summary

Gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls are essential goals for achieving inclusive and sustainable development. Effective support for gender equality in development co-operation requires a range of tools and efforts, all underpinned by financial investments. The OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) has recently adopted both a Guidance and a Recommendation to support these efforts. The OECD also collects and makes publicly available data on development finance overall and notably for gender equality, which helps guide investments and foster accountability for commitments.

A concerning drop when needs are rising

Over the last decade, DAC members have paid increased attention to gender equality in their bilateral allocable official development assistance (ODA), reaching USD 60.4 billion with gender equality objectives in 2021-22. This represented 42% of ODA (USD 143 billion). Most of this integrated gender equality as one policy objective among others (38%), while 4% focused on gender equality as the principal objective.

However, despite a rise in volume, the share of 42% of ODA with gender equality objectives was a drop from 45% in 2019-20. Of the 32 DAC members, 20 focused less on gender equality in 2021-22 than in 2019-20. This is concerning and needs to be reversed considering that progress towards Sustainable Development Goal 5 is off track, more countries are seeing a pushback against gender equality, and there is an alarming increase of poverty and inequalities. It is worrying that conflicts and violence rise around the world, yet responses tend to pay little attention to women's rights and gender equality. No correlation can be observed between existing gender inequalities and the focus on gender equality in ODA to countries. Climate change, environmental degradation and biodiversity loss are also obstacles, as they disproportionately affect women and girls. Every development intervention has an impact on gender equality, whether intended or not, and excluding gender equality objectives from policies, programmes or investments leads to missed opportunities to advance on several fronts in parallel.

In addition to the USD 60.4 billion of ODA, DAC members also included gender equality considerations in USD 3.5 billion of their other official flows, corresponding to 42% of such flows that were examined to see if they had gender equality objectives, using the DAC gender equality policy marker. However, DAC members can largely improve their reporting of such flows against the Marker for greater transparency.

A mixed picture across sectors, with a worrying trend in humanitarian assistance

Gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls remains unevenly integrated across development themes and sectors. The strong focus on gender equality by DAC members in other social infrastructure and services, education, and agriculture and rural development is positive. Conversely, humanitarian aid and aid in the energy sector continue to have a particularly low focus on gender equality.

It is especially concerning that while DAC members' volume of humanitarian aid has grown, from USD 21.6 billion in 2019-20 to USD 29.3 billion in 2021-22, the focus on gender equality has decreased,

from 19% to 17% over the same period. Strikingly, less than 10% of the ODA provided to Ukraine in 2022 in the context of Russia's war of aggression included gender equality objectives. In conflict zones, women and girls tend to be disproportionately affected by violence and displacement. DAC members need to tailor aid to local realities to avoid compromising the future of recovery efforts.

The clean energy transition is an opportunity to advance gender-responsive initiatives while reducing greenhouse gas emissions. Integration of gender equality in the energy sector has improved in recent years, notably in energy generation from renewable sources, but the share of aid with gender equality objectives can be further increased from its current 30%. Gender equality is central to achieving universal energy access.

Looking at areas recognised as essential to achieving transformative change for gender equality, sexual and reproductive health and rights are fundamental. Worryingly, recent years have seen well-funded attempts to reverse progress in this area. While funding with the objective of supporting reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health has increased overall, aid in the specific areas of reproductive health care and family planning dropped in 2021-22. Reporting by DAC members can improve in the area of reproductive health to allow for a comprehensive understanding.

It is vital to consider how financing reaches those most in need. DAC members recognise the important role of women's rights organisations and feminist movements in creating change by addressing the root causes of inequalities and being on the frontline in local communities. Funding for their effectiveness, influence and sustainability, however, remains low, persistently under 1% of ODA for gender equality. DAC members should replicate those members who have been strong supporters for women's rights organisations over several years.

Every form of finance is needed, but information is lacking

Development actors other than DAC members represent an enormous potential to ensure sufficient financial support for gender equality. Multilateral organisations and banks committed USD 36.6 billion of development flows with gender equality objectives on average in 2021-22. However, an additional USD 144.4 billion per year of multilateral outflows were reported to the OECD but either lacked a gender equality focus or the potential focus was not reported.

Non-DAC donor countries and South-South co-operation providers can offer valuable political support for gender equality. Currently, 11 countries report support for gender equality either to the OECD or to total official support for sustainable development (TOSSD), adding up to approximately USD 13 million per year in total.

The private sector is also stepping up efforts to invest with a gender equality lens. USD 4.6 billion of private finance mobilised through DAC members' public development finance in 2022 included gender equality objectives. Approximately the same amounts of mobilised finance were reported as lacking gender equality objectives and without information about their potential gender equality focus. In addition, more than 40 private foundations provided USD 3.4 billion of funding with gender equality objectives. This corresponds to 28% of foundations' overall development funding and indicates scope for a stronger focus on gender equality.

Missed opportunities to achieve gender equality and inclusive development

OECD data show that USD 108.4 billion of development finance from all actors currently have gender equality objectives, while an additional USD 271.2 billion are available but either lack a gender equality focus or the focus is not reported. The amount of development finance available is potentially much larger, since a sizable part of finance is not reported to the OECD

1 Overview

This chapter provides an overview of the extent to which international development finance contributes to advancing gender equality objectives, as well as recommendations for the members of the OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) and other development partners.

Progress on Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 5 on gender equality is off track. Six years before the 2030 deadline for the SDGs, no indicator under SDG 5 has been fully achieved (UN Women, 2024^[1]). Global challenges and tensions, including a pushback against whole-of-society inclusion and gender equality, as well as an alarming increase of poverty and inequalities in low- and middle-income countries, have contributed to stalling progress in many places: nearly 40% of countries stagnated or even declined on gender equality between 2019 and 2022 (EM2023, 2024^[2]). In that context, development co-operation represents an essential line of support. The OECD data presented and analysed in this report allows members of the OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) and the wider community of development partners to assess their efforts and monitor them over time.

1.1. How development co-operation actors monitor global efforts to achieve gender equality

Bilateral official development assistance (ODA) from DAC members represents a major part of global development finance. Thanks to their complete reporting to the OECD, it is also the most well-known source of financing with gender equality objectives. Indeed, gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls have been among the first cross-cutting policy areas actively tracked by the OECD in development finance statistics. The DAC gender equality policy marker was introduced as part of the OECD *Creditor Reporting System* in 1997 to allow development partners to examine and report whether their finance is dedicated to gender equality as the principal objective (score 2), integrates gender equality as one significant policy objective among others (score 1), or does not include gender equality as a policy objective (score 0). Nearly all bilateral official development assistance (ODA) is screened by the 32 DAC members every year against the marker (See Annex A).

Beyond ODA, DAC members are also increasingly screening their other official flows (OOFs) using the DAC gender equality marker, although to a lower extent than ODA. Even if they do not meet ODA criteria, OOFs represent important official resources for advancing gender equality (see Annex A for the full definition of OOF).

In addition to DAC members, an increasing number of development actors, including multilateral organisations and banks, non-DAC donor countries and private philanthropy, also use the DAC marker to report at least some of their development finance with gender equality objectives.

In 2023, the United Nations (UN) system adopted its own gender equality marker, which can be translated into the DAC marker system. Its use will be mandatory for UN organisations as of 2026 and, as financial information becomes available, this will increase the transparency of global outflows for gender equality and allow for greater accountability overall.

Finally, some non-DAC countries report their bilateral, triangular or South-South co-operation to the OECD while others report to the total official support for sustainable development (TOSSD) indicating if they are aligned to SDG 5 (Annex A).

Based on the above, this report aims to capture and analyse all development flows for which data is available, that either qualify as ODA or other types of development flows, and that are allocable, meaning that the development partner can define the policy intention of its contribution (Table 1.1). The report does not analyse cross-border flows such as remittances and much of private commercial investments.

Table 1.1. Types of development finance flows covered in this report

	Concessional	Non-concessional
Official	Official development assistance (ODA) by DAC members (Chapters 2 and 3) South-South co-operation and ODA by non-DAC providers (Chapter 4)	Other official flows (OOF) by DAC members (Chapter 2)
Private	Private philanthropic funding (Chapter 4)	Private finance mobilised by DAC members (Chapter 4)
Multilateral institutions active in development	Concessional multilateral outflows (Chapter 4)	Non-concessional multilateral outflows (Chapter 4)

1.2. Global development finance for gender equality: volumes and trends

The big picture

Based on OECD data and the reporting by various development actors, it is possible to estimate that USD 108.4 billion of international development finance included gender equality objectives on average per year in 2021-22 (Table 1.2 and Figure 1.1). An additional USD 108 billion in development finance was reported by various actors as lacking gender equality objectives. A striking USD 163.3 billion was reported to the OECD but not assessed against the gender equality policy marker nor the SDGs, which prevents the painting of an exhaustive picture.

Table 1.2. Volumes of international development finance by type and by gender equality integration, 2021-22 averages

USD billion

	Includes gender equality objectives or align to SDG 5	Does not include gender equality objectives nor align to SDG 5	Is not screened against the gender equality policy marker nor the SDGs
DAC official development assistance	60.4	82.6	7.9
DAC other official flows	3.5	4.8	3.8
Concessional outflows from multilateral actors	7.8	1.6	52.6
Non-concessional outflows from multilateral actors	28.7	5	85.3
Non-DAC bilateral official development assistance	0.012	0.6	8.8
South-South co-operation providers (TOSSD)	0.001	0.2	0
Private finance mobilised by DAC members (2022 only)	4.6	4.7	4.5
Private philanthropic funding	3.4	8.5	0.4
TOTAL	108.4	108	163.3

Note: Resources reported to Total official support for sustainable development (TOSSD) are assessed against the SDGs and not against the gender equality marker.

Source: OECD (2024^[3]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9> and TOSSD (2024^[4]), Data Visualisation Tool, <https://tossd.online>.

DAC members' development finance for gender equality

The volume of bilateral ODA with gender equality objectives has increased over time, along with the overall increase in ODA. In 2021-22, DAC members included gender equality objectives in USD 60.4 billion of their ODA on average per year. However, **the share of aid with gender equality objectives has dropped** for the first time after a decade on the rise, from 45% of total aid in 2019-20 to 42% in 2021-22. This drop happened in several sectors, and for 20 of the 32 DAC members.

The integration of gender equality is particularly low in ODA to contexts exposed to fragility and conflict, showing that DAC responses to recent global crises have paid little attention to gender equality. For example, only 32% of ODA to Afghanistan, 29% to Yemen and 11% to Ukraine integrated gender equality objectives in 2021-22.

There is no evidence of a correlation between the extent to which ODA integrates gender equality and levels of gender inequality, meaning that **ODA with gender equality objectives is not necessarily going to the countries where inequality is more pronounced**.

DAC members are increasingly using multilateral organisations as a channel for bilateral ODA with gender equality objectives, while civil society organisations (CSOs) are used less and less. CSOs based in partner countries generally receive a marginal share of the ODA channelled through CSOs.

In 2021-22, **USD 3.5 billion of OOFs integrated gender equality objectives**, mostly to the banking and financial services sector.

Gender equality objectives remain unevenly integrated across sectors in bilateral ODA by DAC members:

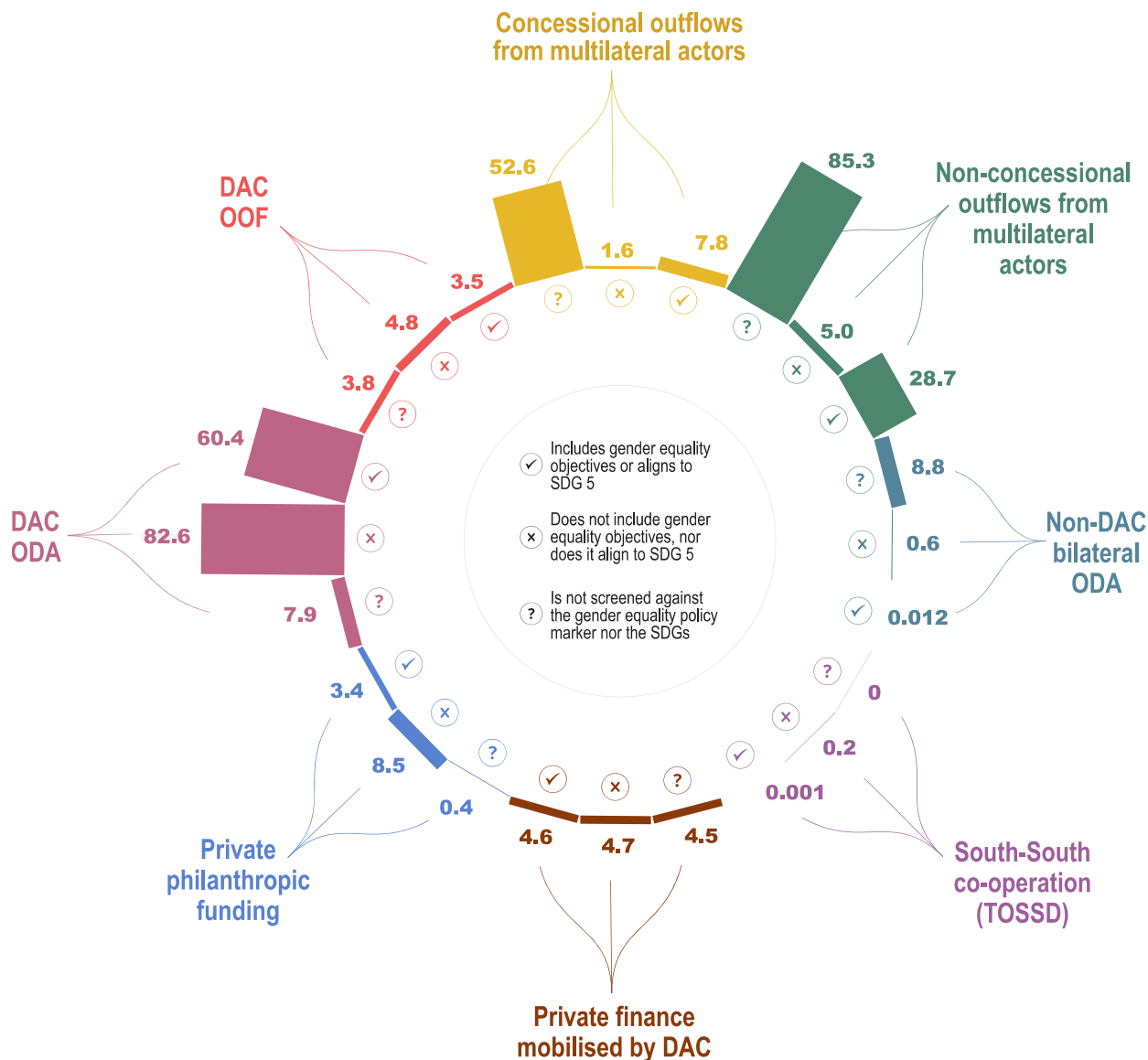
- While bilateral **humanitarian aid** grew over the past decade, its gender equality focus shrunk to 17%. Similarly, the share of aid with gender equality objectives to **contexts exposed to extreme fragility** seems to decrease as the volume of aid increases. This illustrates important and concerning challenges with maintaining commitments to gender equality while responding to urgent crises and humanitarian situations.
- In the **energy sector**, the focus on gender equality has **increased** over the past years in the areas of energy generation from renewable sources, energy policy and energy distribution, alongside an increase in aid volumes going to these areas. This reflects the DAC's recognition of the importance of addressing the objectives of gender equality and clean energy simultaneously. At the same time, only 30% of ODA to the broader energy sector had gender equality objectives, one of the lowest sectoral shares.
- Despite DAC members' recognition of the importance of **women's rights organisations and feminist movements**, ODA to enhance their effectiveness, influence and sustainability remains low, at around USD 0.5 billion. This represents less than 1% of ODA for gender equality.
- Funding with the policy objective of supporting **reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health** (RMNCH) has increased: USD 14.7 billion of aid had RMNCH objectives on average per year in 2021-22, up from USD 11.9 billion on average in 2019-20. The additional funds with RMNCH objectives were largely committed in the area of COVID-19 control, while support in the areas of reproductive health care and family planning declined from 2019-20 to 2021-22.
- **Compounding inequalities that intersect with gender** position the women who face them as the most disadvantaged in their society across the globe. It remains challenging, however, to track funding at the intersection of gender and other inequalities. Only 22 DAC members examine either some or all aid against the DAC policy marker for the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, meaning that the disability focus of most bilateral aid is unknown.

Development finance for gender equality by actors other than DAC members

- Of the USD 181 billion in total development outflows reported to the OECD by **multilateral** organisations and banks, both ODA and OOFs, **the bulk (USD 137.9 billion) was not screened** against the DAC gender equality policy marker. Out of the USD 43.1 billion of multilateral outflows that were, USD 36.6 billion had gender equality objectives, allocated mainly to the sectors of economic infrastructure and services, government and civil society, and business and banking.
- As for **countries that are not members of the DAC**, some, but far from all, report their ODA with gender equality objectives to the OECD. Data show that **a mere USD 12.5 million of the USD 9.4 billion of their ODA included gender equality objectives**. Instead of reporting to the OECD, an increasing number of South-South bilateral providers report their cross-border resources to TOSSD, indicating whether they are aligned with SDG 5 (Annex A). These providers reported USD 1 million of cross-border flows on average per year in 2021-22 as aligned with SDG 5, out of a total of USD 165.5 million on average per year. These flows were reported to TOSSD only and are additional to those reported to the OECD against the gender equality policy marker.
- DAC members and multilateral actors increasingly report the private finance that they help mobilise with their official development finance. **Of the USD 9.3 billion of private finance mobilised** by DAC members and screened against the policy marker, **USD 4.6 billion included gender equality objectives**.
- **Private philanthropies included gender equality objectives in USD 3.4 billion of the total USD 12.3 billion they spent on development**, nearly half of which was concentrated in the health, population policy and reproductive health, and agriculture and rural development sectors.

Figure 1.1. The bulk of international development finance either has no gender equality focus, or is not screened against that criterion

Volumes per type of international development finance that include and do not include gender equality objectives, and are not screened against the gender equality policy marker or SDG 5, USD billion, 2021-22 averages



Note: Includes: Includes gender equality objectives or align to SDG 5; Does not include: Does not include gender equality objectives nor align to SDG 5; Is not screened: Is not screened against the gender equality policy marker nor the SDGs; DAC: Development Assistance Committee; ODA: official development assistance; OOF: other official flows; TOSSD: Total official support for sustainable development; CRS: *Creditor Reporting System*. Private finance mobilised by DAC is for 2022 only.

Source: OECD (2024^[3]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9> and TOSSD (2024^[4]), Data Visualisation Tool, <https://tossd.online>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/jdqsm1>

1.3. Improving development finance for gender equality: recommendations to development partners

Regular financial reporting against robust standards, such as the OECD *Creditor Reporting System* and the DAC gender equality policy marker, helps track collective efforts, facilitates the sharing of good practices and encourages the mobilisation of additional finance. Wider reporting by all development actors would allow a more complete understanding of such efforts, fostering transparency and collective accountability, and creating a positive race for more aid to advance gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls through development co-operation. Although the above measures potentially underestimate the actual volume of global development finance that includes gender equality objectives – since a great deal, especially from multilateral actors, is not reported to the OECD – the fact that large volumes explicitly do *not* include them shows that there is a lot of room for improvement.

In addition to encouraging an increase in quantity of development finance for gender equality, better monitoring can also help ensure, qualitatively, that every dollar spent on development has a positive impact. Whether intended or not, every development co-operation intervention will have an impact on gender equality, and it can be harmful to work within systems that perpetuate existing discriminatory gender stereotypes and norms. At a minimum, a do-no-harm approach is required to ensure that interventions do not reinforce such inequalities. Gender equality thus needs to be considered throughout policy frameworks, in design and planning, programming, and financing, implementing, monitoring and evaluation, and in development partners' own internal structures and systems. The 2024 *DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* ([OECD/LEGAL/5022](#)) (OECD, 2024^[5]) and the 2022 *Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls: DAC Guidance for Development Partners* (OECD, 2022^[6]) set out a comprehensive standard and provide good practice guidance for how to do this.

Recommendations to DAC members

- Reverse the declining trend in the share of ODA with gender equality objectives.
- Maintain a focus on gender equality in all interventions, including in contexts exposed to fragility and conflict, and in countries where inequality is high.
- Continue supporting CSOs based in partner countries directly, which hold critical contextual expertise.
- Increase the focus on gender equality across all sectors where it is low, including humanitarian aid, and in emergency situations and contexts exposed to extreme fragility. Successes in improving gender equality integration in ODA to the peace and security sector may serve as avenues for learning.
- At a minimum, avoid that any development interventions perpetuate inequalities or have unintended harmful consequences on gender equality.
- Increase support for women's empowerment in the energy sector, learning from those members with high shares of aid integrating gender equality.
- Increase support for women's rights organisations and feminist movements, which are rooted in communities and bring critical contextual expertise, learning from the experience of the few DAC members which stand out as consistent, strong supporters.
- Ensure sustained levels of funding for reproductive health.
- Further strengthen statistical reporting on funding for RMNCH.
- Strengthen their own capacity to use the DAC gender equality policy marker and statistical reporting, in order to ensure robust data.

- Improve the reporting of OOFs to support a more comprehensive picture of how different forms of finance are responsive to gender inequalities and discrimination.
- For those who do not do it yet, examine aid against the DAC policy marker for the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, to allow for a more complete picture of funding flows and more in-depth analysis of support at the intersection of gender equality and disability.

Recommendations to the wider community of development partners

- DAC members and multilateral actors could further enhance their reporting of private finance mobilised with a gender equality focus of these mobilised flows.
- Multilateral organisations and development banks could helpfully use a common framework for monitoring their development outflows for gender equality. Those that already report their development finance to the OECD could screen their flows against the DAC gender equality policy marker, following the example of banks that already do so.
- While some non-DAC members report their ODA with gender equality objectives to the OECD, more non-DAC and South-South co-operation providers could screen and report the gender equality focus of their development finance.
- Private philanthropies could further strengthen their focus on gender equality. More foundations could report their development funding with gender equality objectives.

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2 Development finance for gender equality by DAC members

This chapter analyses bilateral official development assistance and other official flows by DAC members and the extent to which they include gender equality considerations. It also discusses the declining focus of gender equality in DAC members' development finance against a backdrop of pushback against whole-of-society inclusion and gender equality.

Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members are the main source of development finance for gender equality for which information is available. The bulk of their funding is in the form of official development assistance (ODA), but they also provide other official flows (see Annex A for definitions). This chapter presents the trends of development finance for gender equality by DAC members, as a group and individually, and shares insights about the integration of gender equality into finance for different partner countries, through the various channels of delivery and across sectors.

2.1. Official development assistance for gender equality

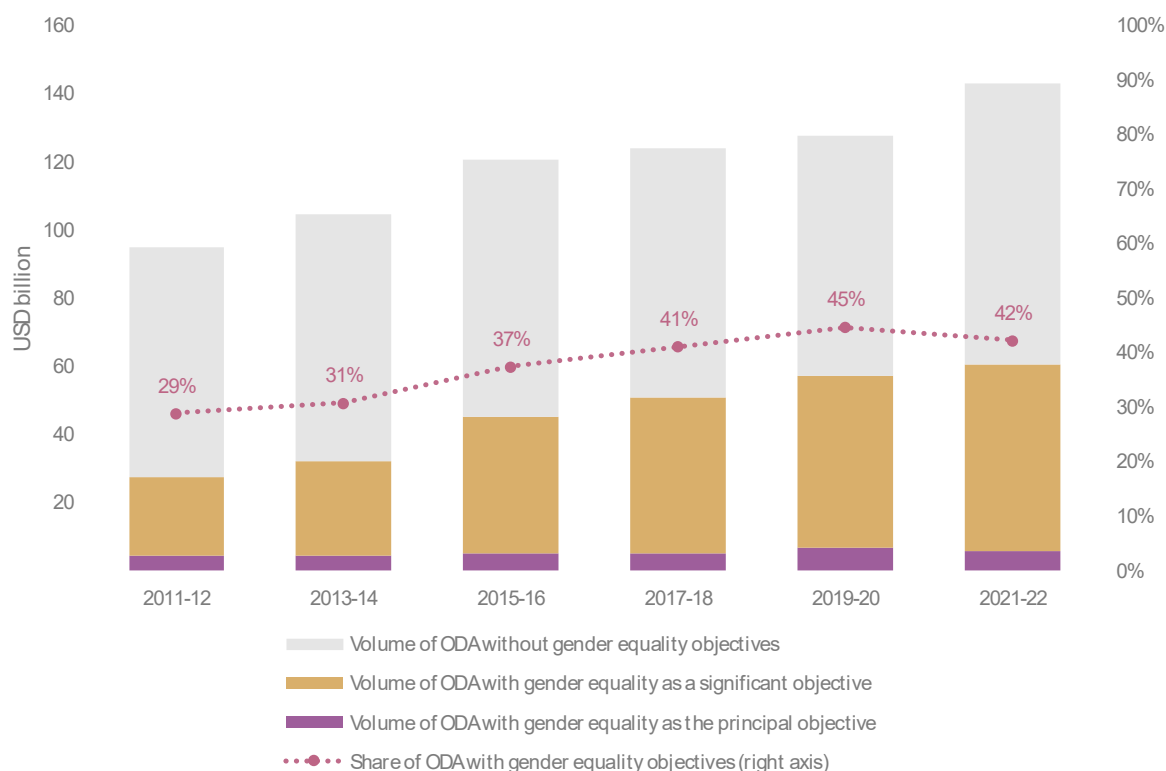
Bilateral ODA for gender equality has dropped for the first time in a decade

Over the last decade, DAC members have increasingly included gender equality objectives in their bilateral allocable ODA (Figure 2.1) either as the main objective of projects and programmes or as one significant objective. In 2019-20, they reached a record share of 45% of bilateral allocable ODA including gender equality objectives, but this **share dropped to 42% in 2021-22**. Although the volume of ODA with gender equality objectives increased from USD 57 billion in 2019-20 to USD 60.4 billion in 2021-22, this is in line with overall increases in volumes of ODA. The decrease in the share of ODA with gender equality objectives after a decade of growth is, however, of serious concern as it shows DAC members' policy intention in providing their aid.

The 42% of bilateral allocable ODA with gender equality objectives represented **USD 60.4 billion** out of USD 143 billion screened against the gender equality policy marker (see Annex A for a definition). Most of it was for programmes that integrate gender equality as one **significant** policy objective among others: **USD 54.9 billion** (38% of total bilateral aid), while **USD 5.5 billion** (4%) was for programmes where gender equality was the **principal** objective. Having a principal objective is not, by definition, better than a significant objective: a dual-track approach in the development co-operation portfolio allows dedicating some interventions to gender equality while mainstreaming gender equality across all policy areas, strategies and programming (OECD, 2022^[1]). It is noteworthy that 58% of ODA does not aim to have a positive impact on advancing gender equality, reducing gender discrimination or inequalities, or meeting gender-specific needs.

Figure 2.1. Volume and share of official development assistance from DAC members with gender equality objectives, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance.

Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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The drop in the share of ODA with gender equality objectives is concerning for several reasons. With five years to go until 2030, evidence shows that the world is not on track to fulfil the promise “to leave no one behind” and to achieve Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 5 on gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls (UN Women et al., 2024^[3]). Not achieving SDG 5 also puts at risk the realisation of other SDGs and the 2030 Agenda more broadly. Gender inequalities continue to prevail across countries, including those at the forefront of gender equality policy (2023^[4]; OECD, 2024^[2]).

It is difficult to establish the direct causes for the recent drop in the share of ODA for gender equality as there are many variables and interdependencies which cannot be isolated. However, the following observations can be made from the available data:

- **No one single DAC member’s performance is causing the drop.** Of the 32 DAC members, 20 decreased the share of their ODA with gender equality objectives from 2019-20 to 2021-22 (Table 2.1). DAC members providing larger volumes of ODA could skew the average DAC share, but while a couple of the largest development partners have dropped their share, this may have been compensated by significant increases from other large donors. It is noteworthy that the DAC member committing the largest volume of ODA, the United States, has a share of gender equality objectives far below the average DAC share: 15% in 2021-22 (down from 22% in 2019-20).

- **ODA to Ukraine was a major factor in the drop.** Following the start of Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine, bilateral allocable ODA to Ukraine went up from yearly volumes of around USD 1.1 billion to a record USD 18.9 billion in 2022. However, less than 10% of this amount in 2022 included gender equality objectives, showing that donor responses to the crisis paid very little attention to gender equality issues. Although the war cannot be singled out as the only factor for the overall decrease in gender focus in ODA, such a large increase in volume with such a low integration of gender equality objectives certainly contributed to a drop in the overall share (OECD, 2024^[5]).
- **No single sector is driving the drop in share.** The share of ODA with gender equality objectives fell in several sectors, notably in "government and civil society" and "water supply and sanitation", but it also rose in others, such as "energy" and "general environmental protection".

Two aspects which are sometimes raised as potentially impacting the drop in share are in-donor refugee costs and budget support to governments. In-donor refugee costs – the cost of receiving refugees and asylum seekers in donor countries – reached its highest level in 2022 (OECD, 2024^[6]). General budget support, or finance that flows directly into a partner government's budget and enables them to use their own financial management systems and budget procedures, also increased during the COVID-19 crisis (OECD, 2023^[7]). However, in-donor refugee costs and general budget support are not allocable aid, so they are not included in this report's calculations and, therefore, could not have contributed to the drop in the share of ODA with gender equality objectives.

Even gender equality champions are struggling to keep the focus

While the DAC as a group integrated gender equality objectives into 42% of its bilateral allocable ODA in 2021-22, individual DAC members have done so to very different extents (Table 2.1 and Figure 2.2). The **Netherlands** ranked the highest, with 84%, followed by **Ireland** and **Canada**, with 78% and 77%, respectively, reflecting the high priority that these DAC members have placed on gender equality in their development co-operation policies and programmes over several years. While the Netherlands increased its share from 79% in 2019-20, Ireland and Canada dropped from 80% and 88%, respectively. Iceland and Luxembourg also had high shares in 2019-20 but dropped in 2021-22, with Iceland going from 88% to 72% and Luxembourg from 81% to 35%. High shares indicate that gender equality is a clear policy intention for these governments when designing their programmes and projects. It means that most of their interventions were informed by a gender analysis and include at least one explicit gender equality objective backed by at least one gender-specific indicator, that data and indicators are disaggregated by sex where applicable, and that there is a commitment to monitor on the gender equality results. It is concerning that 20 DAC members decreased the share of ODA with gender equality objectives compared to 2019-20 (Table 2.1).

Table 2.1. Volumes and shares of official development assistance with gender equality objectives by DAC member, 2019-22

	Share in 2019-20	Share in 2021-22	Change in share from 2019-20 to 2021-22	ODA with gender equality as a principal objective (average per year 2021-22)	ODA with gender equality as a significant objective (average per year 2021-22)	Core funding to UN Women (average per year 2021-22)
Australia	39%	44%	Increased	USD 166 million	USD 965 million	USD 6 million
Austria	38%	40%	Increased	USD 29 million	USD 174 million	USD 0 million
Belgium	76%	67%	Decreased	USD 50 million	USD 384 million	USD 9 million
Canada	88%	77%	Decreased	USD 540 million	USD 3 651 million	USD 2 million
Czechia	42%	20%	Decreased	USD 1 million	USD 15 million	USD 0 million
Denmark	42%	37%	Decreased	USD 122 million	USD 421 million	USD 11 million
Estonia	15%	9%	Decreased	USD 1 million	USD 1 million	USD 0 million
EU institutions	58%	59%	Increased	USD 418 million	USD 11 014 million	
Finland	53%	68%	Increased	USD 66 million	USD 393 million	USD 21 million
France	42%	47%	Increased	USD 552 million	USD 3 817 million	USD 6 million
Germany	45%	46%	Increased	USD 656 million	USD 10 735 million	USD 17 million
Greece	22%	1%	Decreased	USD 0 million	USD 0 million	
Hungary	48%	26%	Decreased	USD 0 million	USD 67 million	
Iceland	88%	72%	Decreased	USD 9 million	USD 30 million	USD 1 million
Ireland	80%	78%	Decreased	USD 57 million	USD 285 million	USD 2 million
Italy	52%	39%	Decreased	USD 56 million	USD 354 million	USD 3 million
Japan	46%	58%	Increased	USD 88 million	USD 7 267 million	USD 4 million
Korea	25%	26%	Increased	USD 90 million	USD 930 million	USD 4 million
Lithuania	41%	17%	Decreased	USD 0 million	USD 3 million	USD 0 million
Luxembourg	81%	35%	Decreased	USD 24 million	USD 93 million	USD 4 million
Netherlands	79%	84%	Increased	USD 896 million	USD 1 766 million	USD 8 million
New Zealand	52%	55%	Increased	USD 26 million	USD 179 million	USD 2 million
Norway	43%	37%	Decreased	USD 169 million	USD 1 444 million	USD 12 million
Poland	5%	6%	Increased	USD 2 million	USD 5 million	
Portugal	38%	32%	Decreased	USD 3 million	USD 40 million	
Slovak Republic	38%	13%	Decreased	USD 0 million	USD 4 million	USD 0 million
Slovenia	36%	8%	Decreased	USD 0 million	USD 1 million	
Spain	46%	43%	Decreased	USD 241 million	USD 271 million	USD 1 million
Sweden	77%	72%	Decreased	USD 213 million	USD 1 544 million	USD 0 million
Switzerland	56%	71%	Increased	USD 106 million	USD 1 848 million	USD 25 million
United Kingdom	66%	57%	Decreased	USD 328 million	USD 1 774 million	USD 4 million
United States	22%	15%	Decreased	USD 623 million	USD 5 427 million	USD 14 million

Note: Core funding to UN Women is not included in other parts of the report. An empty cell means that no volume was reported, and zero may be the result of rounding to the nearest million.

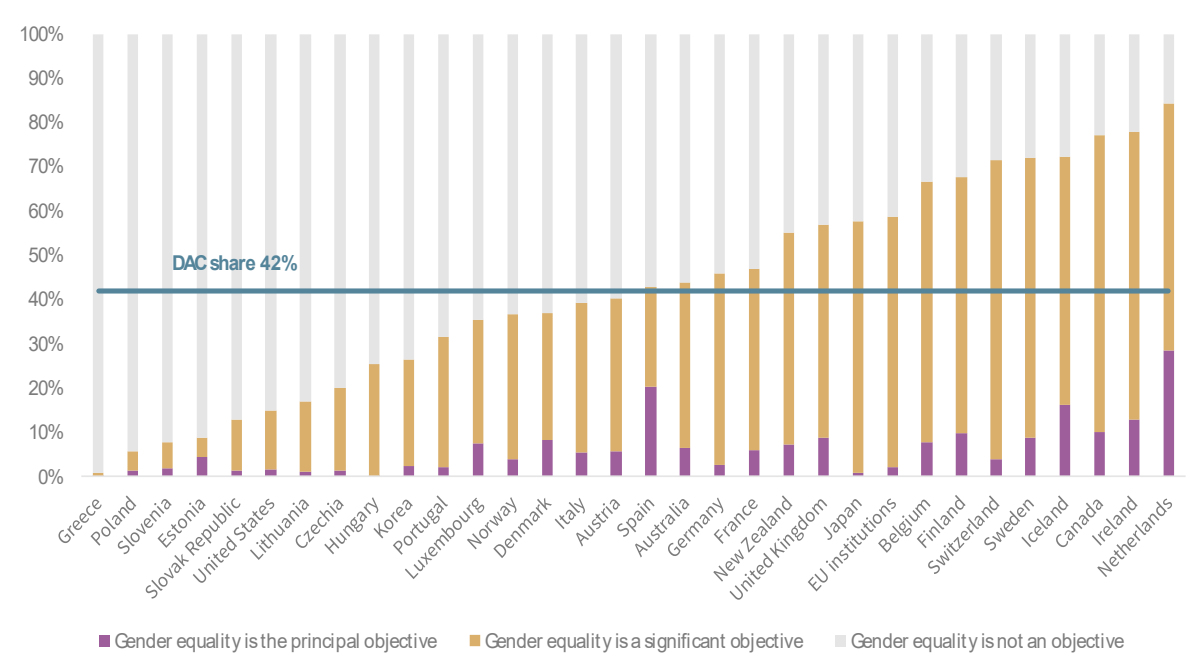
Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

The Netherlands and **Spain** stood out for having the largest shares of ODA for projects **dedicated** to gender equality, where gender equality is the principal objective, with 28% and 20%, respectively, high above the DAC average of 4%. Interventions that are dedicated to gender equality typically include a results framework with gender-specific indicators to track outcomes and are projects that would not have been undertaken without the gender equality objective.

The **EU institutions** and **Germany** provided the largest volumes of ODA including gender equality as a policy objective (principal and significant combined), both with USD 11.4 billion on average per year

in 2021-22. They were followed by **Japan** with USD 7.4 billion and the **United States** with USD 6 billion. In turn, the Netherlands had the largest volume of ODA dedicated to gender equality as the principal objective, at USD 0.9 billion on average per year in 2021-22.

Figure 2.2. Share of bilateral allocable official development assistance per inclusion of gender equality objectives per DAC member, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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Beyond bilateral aid, core support to multilateral organisations is critical to advance gender equality

Core support to multilateral organisations – a co-operation modality where the donor gives up the exclusive control of its funds by sharing the responsibility with other stakeholders – is not considered bilateral allocable ODA due to the fact that DAC members are unable to decide on their policy objective. These funds are therefore not reported against the DAC gender equality policy marker and are not included in the figures and analysis in this report.

However, in the specific case of UN Women, the United Nations entity dedicated to gender equality, even if DAC members cannot define the policy objective of their core funding, they are by default supporting efforts to advance the full realisation of women's rights and opportunities, which is UN Women's mandate. While some, or much, of the core funding provided for the United Nations Population Fund, the United Nations Children's Fund, the World Health Organization and others will also help advance gender equality, the exact extent of the focus on gender equality may vary and these data are thus not included here.

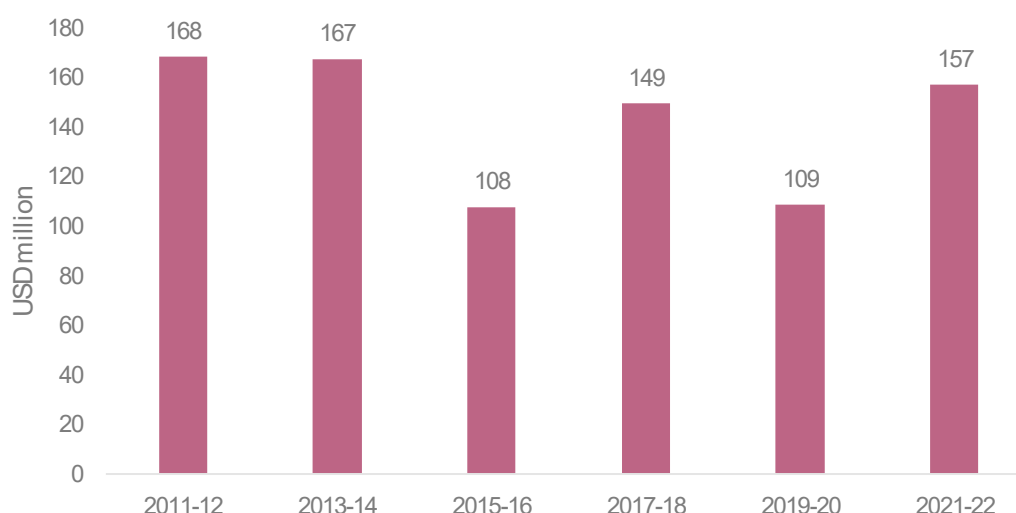
Many DAC members provide core funding for UN Women to support their work on gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls; however, volumes have varied over the years and clearly have not increased (Figure 2.3). In 2011-12, DAC members committed USD 168 million on average per year in core funding to UN Women; a decade later they committed USD 157 million. The main contributors of core

support in 2021-22 were Switzerland, Finland, Germany and the United States, which together represented close to half of DAC members' core support to UN Women in the period (Table 2.1). It is important that DAC members continue providing core support to UN Women and other multilateral organisations to ensure their effective functioning, in addition to integrating gender equality objectives into bilateral ODA, which may be channelled through UN Women as well as other multilateral organisations and banks.

In turn, multilateral organisations and banks can assess and report the gender equality focus of their development outflows based on the core support received, to increase transparency and accountability and complete the picture of development finance with gender equality objectives. Chapter 4 provides more information about outflows from multilateral organisations and banks, and the extent to which these actors use the DAC gender equality policy marker.

Figure 2.3. Volume of core funding to UN Women from DAC members, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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Several DAC members have targets to drive more finance for gender equality

Setting quantitative targets for a share of ODA to include gender equality objectives can help direct more resources towards gender equality, create internal awareness on the matter, and enable constructive discussions across teams and development actors involved in development co-operation (OECD, 2022^[1]). On the other hand, financial targets also carry the risk of “gender-washing”, since organisations may simulate working on gender equality to ensure funding, or the risk of it becoming a “ceiling” rather than an incentive (OECD, 2022^[1]). Targets for gender equality may also be perceived as setting up competition with other cross-cutting issues and sectors. To be effective, it is crucial that financial targets are realistic and accompanied by leadership commitment, human resources and expertise, as well as a clear understanding of the criteria for the DAC gender equality policy marker. Several DAC members have set quantitative targets (Box 2.1) but the DAC as a community does not have a common target for bilateral aid that integrates or is dedicated to gender equality.

Box 2.1. Targets for official development assistance with gender equality objectives

Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members' targets are typically based on the scores of the DAC gender equality policy marker. This box discusses some examples of quantitative targets from DAC members.

In its Feminist International Assistance Policy, **Global Affairs Canada** commits to integrate gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls into 80% of its bilateral international development assistance and to dedicate 15% to advance gender equality. According to the policy, a targeted approach allows focusing on initiatives that fight poverty and inequality by supporting gender equality. Global Affairs Canada also expects its implementing partners to consult with women and involve them in needs assessments, decision making and planning of initiatives, as well as in the implementation, monitoring and evaluation of projects.

The **European Union** Gender Action Plan III commits to ensuring that 85% of new EU external actions contribute to gender equality by 2025. The purpose of this gender mainstreaming is to ensure that all policies and programmes maximise their benefits for all and contribute to ending the perpetuation of inequality.

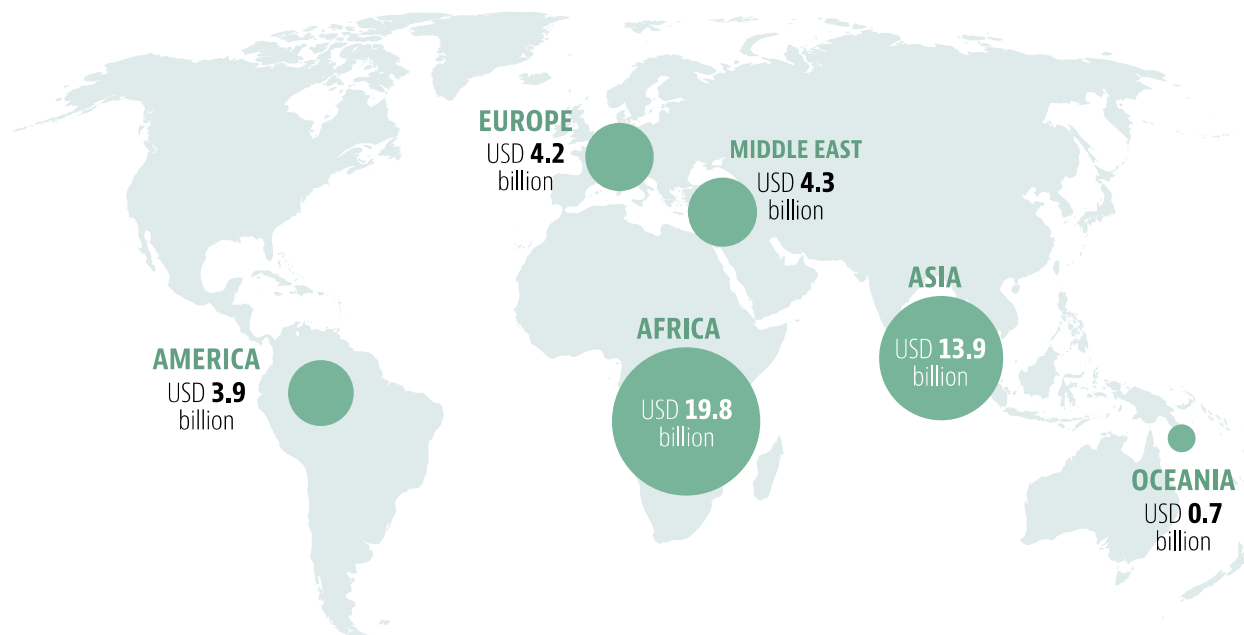
The **Norwegian Ministry of Foreign Affairs** has committed to making efforts to integrate a gender perspective into all of its major initiatives, spanning areas such as climate, renewable energy, food security, health, education, peace and humanitarian efforts, and decent work. In its Action Plan for Women's Rights and Gender Equality in Norway's Foreign and Development Policy, the ministry commits to explicitly prioritise gender equality as a principal or significant target in at least 50% of its bilateral aid.

Source: Global Affairs Canada (2021^[8]), *Canada's Feminist International Assistance Policy*, https://www.international.gc.ca/world-monde/issues_development-enjeux_developpement/priorities-priorites/policy-politique.aspx?lang=eng; European Commission (2020^[9]), *EU Gender Action Plan (GAP) III – An Ambitious Agenda for Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment in EU External Action*, https://international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2021-01/join-2020-17-final_en.pdf; Norwegian Ministry of Foreign Affairs (2023^[10]), *A Just World is an Equal World: Action Plan for Women's Rights and Gender Equality in Norway's Foreign and Development Policy (2023-2030)*, <https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/807b40290fe54663ae1bca5fafaef1218/en-gb/pdfs/a-just-world-is-an-equal-world.pdf>.

Gender equality is unevenly integrated across partner countries and noticeably low in conflict-affected settings

Africa and Asia receive most of bilateral allocable ODA with gender equality objectives, with USD 19.8 billion and USD 13.9 billion, respectively, on average per year in 2021-22 (Figure 2.4). This corresponds to the regional distribution of overall ODA (with and without gender equality objectives). The main difference is in Europe, where ODA with gender equality objectives is proportionally lower than overall ODA, as a result of the high volume of ODA to Ukraine which has a mostly low gender focus. Projects dedicated to gender equality are more frequent in the Caribbean and Central America (included under America in Figure 2.4), where 7% of ODA has gender equality as the principal objective. The global average is 4%.

Figure 2.4. Volume of bilateral allocable official development assistance with gender equality objectives per region, 2021-22 averages



Note: Excludes multi-regional and unspecified projects.

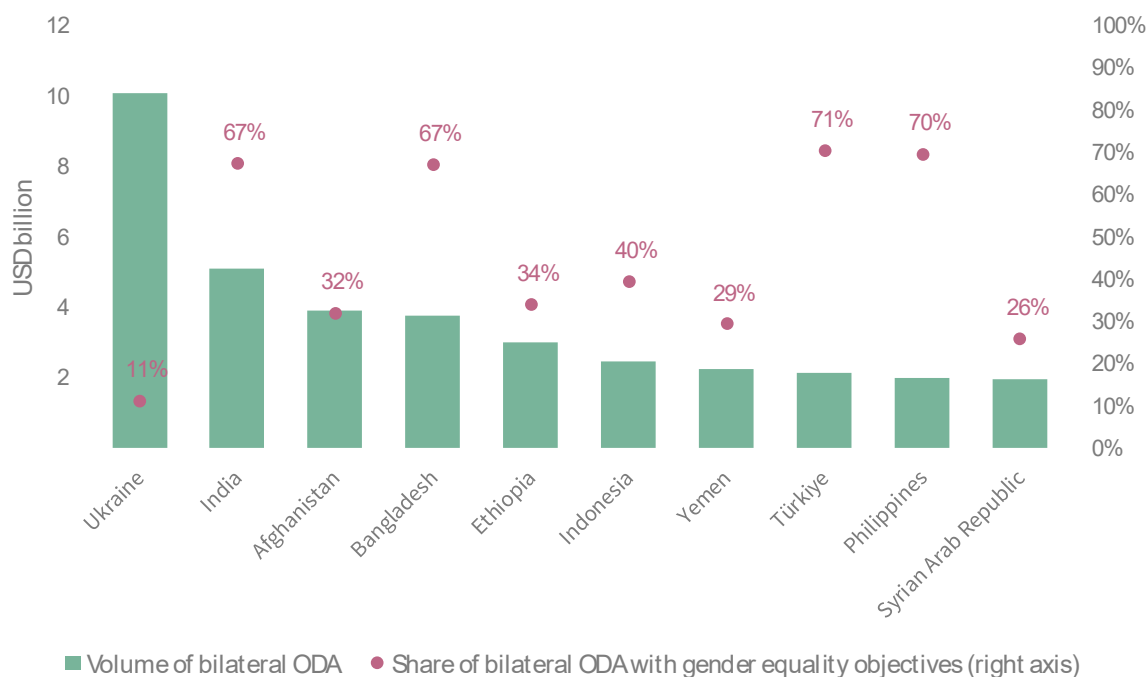
Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

The share of ODA with gender equality objectives varies significantly by partner country. A closer look at the top 10 recipients of bilateral allocable ODA in terms of volume in 2021-22 shows striking differences in the level of gender equality integration, with a low focus on gender equality in conflict-affected countries (Figure 2.5). While DAC members included gender equality objectives in 42% of their bilateral allocable ODA overall in 2021-22, they did so in less than 10% of their ODA to Ukraine in 2022, the year when Russia's large-scale aggression against Ukraine started (see Box 3.1 in Chapter 3) (OECD, 2024^[5]). Other countries affected by conflict like Afghanistan, Ethiopia, Indonesia, the Syrian Arab Republic and Yemen, which have featured among the largest recipients of ODA from DAC members for several years, also have shares of gender equality integration below the DAC share of 42%.

A case in point is Afghanistan, where women and girls have seen their rights severely curtailed since the takeover of the country by the Taliban in 2021. Over the past three years, more than 70 edicts, directives and decrees have deprived Afghan women and girls from fundamental rights (UN Women, 2024^[11]). Women are currently required to cover their entire bodies and faces, are prohibited from singing or raising their voices in public, prohibited from using public transport alone, and are not allowed to attend secondary school or university. Unless there is a concerted effort to include gender equality considerations in every ODA intervention in Afghanistan, development co-operation will contribute to normalising and perpetuating these inequalities and discrimination, harming women and girls. Chapter 3 further discusses the necessity of maintaining a focus on gender equality in development co-operation to conflict-affected settings.

On the other hand, ODA to Bangladesh, India, the Philippines and Türkiye, which are also among the largest ODA recipients, integrated gender equality objectives to a high extent in 2021-22, well above the DAC total share of 42%.

Figure 2.5. Volume of bilateral allocable official development assistance and share that integrates gender equality objectives, top 10 recipients by volume, 2021-22 averages



Note: The share for Ukraine is 11% on average in 2021-22. Broken down by individual year, 39% of ODA to Ukraine included gender equality objectives in 2021 and less than 10% in 2022.

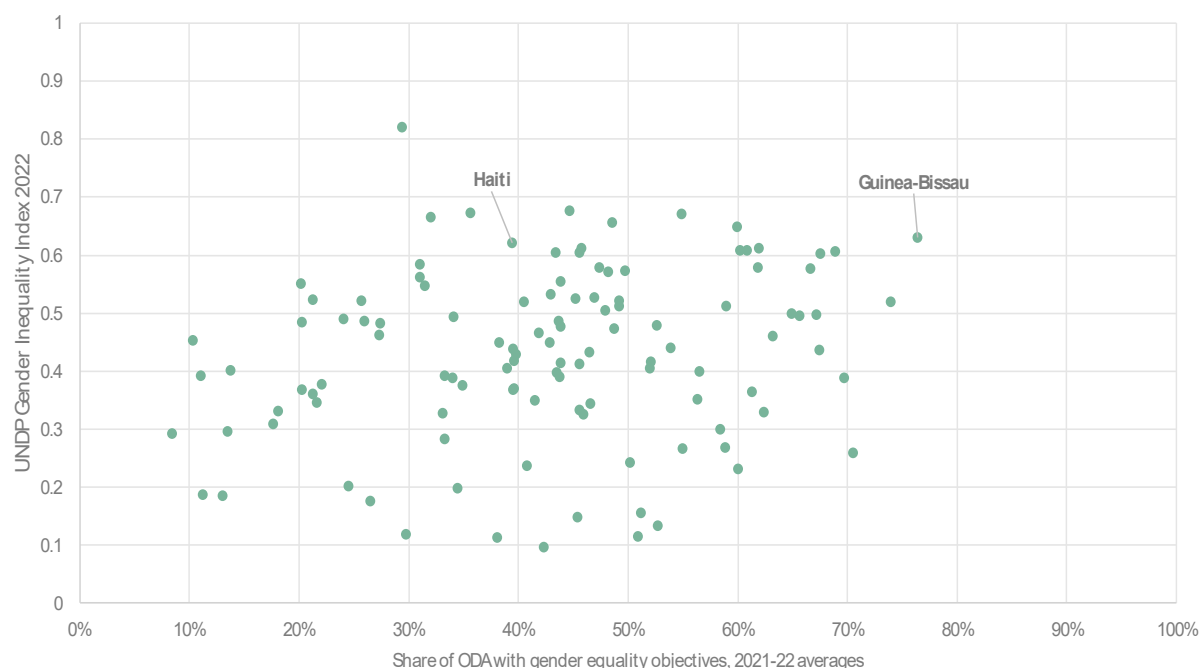
Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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Finance for gender equality is not necessarily going where inequalities are the greatest

One might think that there is a stronger effort to integrate gender equality objectives into ODA to countries where gender inequality is higher. However, crossing information on gender-focused ODA with the United Nations Development Programme's Gender Inequality Index¹ scores does not show such a pattern. If the integration of gender equality objectives into ODA was perfectly responsive to gender inequality, a diagonal line would be evident in Figure 2.6, suggesting higher levels of gender-focused aid for countries with higher levels of gender inequality. However, there is no evidence of this correlation. Guinea-Bissau and Haiti provide a striking example: Both countries have similarly high levels of gender inequality according to the Gender Inequality Index, but while 76% of ODA to Guinea-Bissau includes gender equality objectives, only 39% of ODA to Haiti does. It is beyond the scope of this report to explore the underlying factors, but further analysis of gender equality integration into different sectors and by development partners in these two countries could provide new insights on drivers and barriers for a gender equality focus of ODA. While every development co-operation project should aim to have a positive impact on gender equality, this is even more important in ODA for the most unequal countries.

Figure 2.6. Share of official development assistance with gender equality objectives per partner country relative to their Gender Inequality Index score



Note: ODA: official development assistance; UNDP: United Nations Development Programme. Includes the 114 countries where both the ODA data and the index score were available.

Source: OECD (2024^[12]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

UNDP (2024^[12]), Gender Inequality Index, <https://hdr.undp.org/data-center/thematic-composite-indices/gender-inequality-index#/indices/GII>.

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Gender equality remains unevenly integrated into ODA across sectors

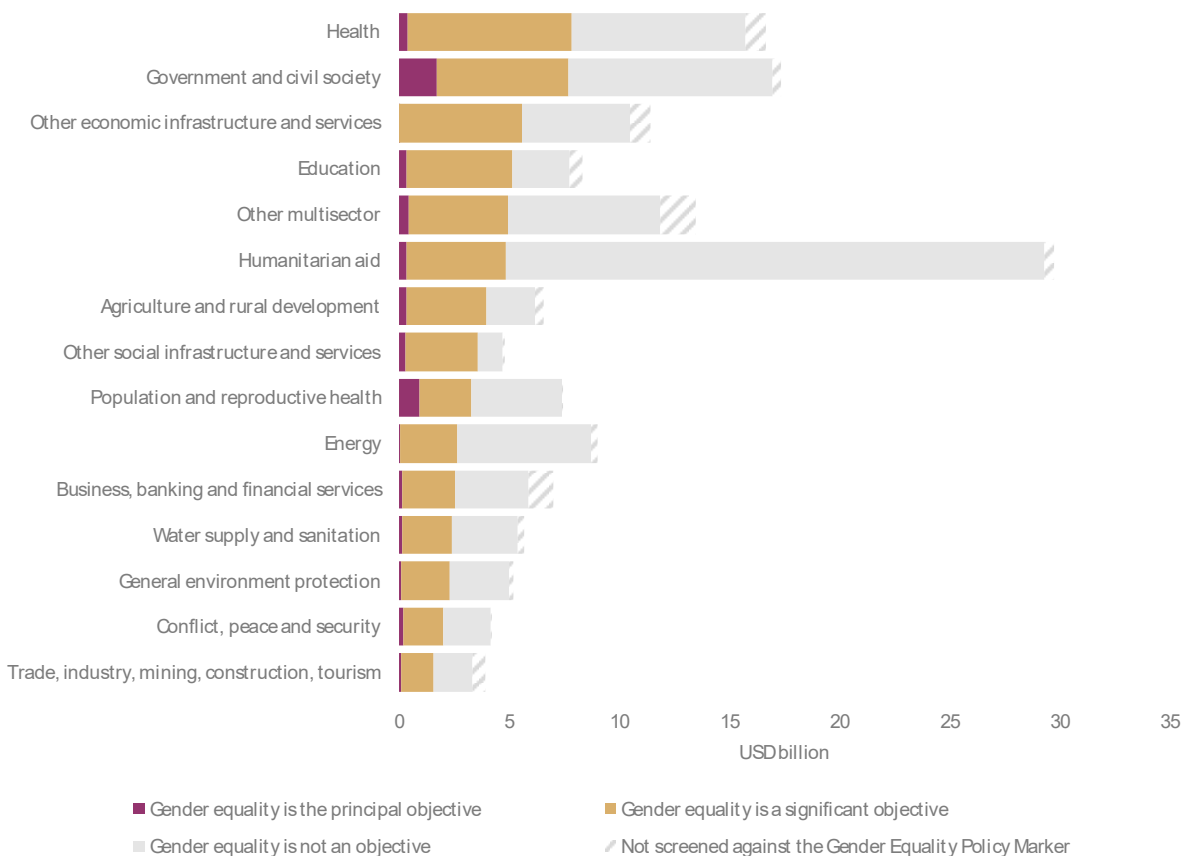
As in previous years, gender equality remains unevenly integrated across the various sectors supported by bilateral allocable ODA. “Humanitarian aid” and aid for the “energy” sector continue to have the lowest shares of aid with gender equality objectives (see Chapter 3). Conversely, it is positive that gender equality is well integrated into the “other social infrastructure and services”, “education”, and “agriculture and rural development” sectors.

In terms of volumes of ODA with gender equality objectives, the main sectors benefiting are “health”, “government and civil society”, and “other economic infrastructure and services” (Figure 2.7). The “government and civil society” sector includes areas such as public sector policy, public financial management, human rights and democratic participation. Annual volumes of ODA for this sector (with and without gender equality objectives) did not fluctuate much from 2011 to 2021; however, in 2022, ODA to this sector peaked at USD 21.8 billion, partially related to Ukraine, where gender equality was poorly integrated (see Chapter 3).

Among the largest ODA recipient partner countries, those who integrate gender equality objectives to a high extent (see Figure 2.5) do so in a variety of sectors. In Bangladesh and India, for example, large volumes of ODA with gender equality objectives were committed in the rail transport, urban development, water supply and sanitation, and medical services sectors. In Türkiye, large volumes of aid with gender equality objectives were committed to the social protection and employment creation sectors. In the

Philippines, large volumes went to rail transport, health policy and environmental policy. This diversity of sectors shows that gender equality objectives can be included in projects under any policy area. The French Development Agency's programme to finance the extension of Ahmedabad's metro line in India is an example that reflects the linkages between gender equality and safe public transportation (AFD, 2024^[13]). A gender analysis was undertaken, and a gender action plan developed with specific gender objectives and gender disaggregated data. Deliverables included surveillance cameras, lighting, dedicated parking lots and separate facilities for women. Trainings on gender equality and women's health, involving a local non-governmental organisation, were also organised as part of the programme.

Figure 2.7. Volume of bilateral official development assistance by sector and by gender equality policy marker score, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/10rpvb>

While multilateral organisations have become more prominent as a channel for ODA for gender equality, civil society organisations have become less prominent

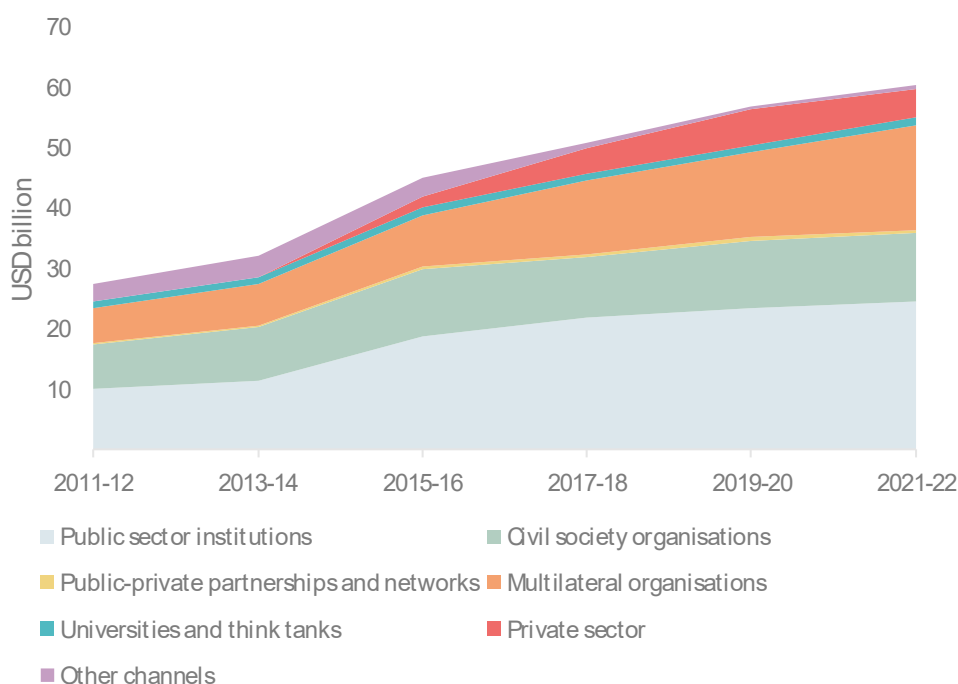
Bilateral ODA by DAC members that includes gender equality objectives is delivered (“channelled”) through different development actors, and these channels may shift over time (Figure 2.8). Public sector institutions have seen a slight increase over the last decade, constantly accounting for at least a third of ODA with gender equality objectives. This includes support by DAC members for programmes run by partner country governments, for example the Sustenta programme, which is led by Mozambique’s Ministry

of Agriculture and Rural Development and supported by the Austrian Development Agency (OECD, 2024^[2]). This programme aims to ensure food security and increase family income through improved agricultural production with a focus on households headed by women.

Changes are more visible in the multilateral organisations and civil society organisations (CSO) channels. While multilateral organisations were utilised to channel 21% of the ODA with gender equality objectives in 2011-12, this went up to 29% in 2021-22. At the same time, CSOs went from channelling 27% of ODA with gender equality objectives in 2011-12 to 19% in 2021-22. Private sector institutions, which did not feature as a channel for ODA with gender equality objectives a decade ago, are currently utilised to deliver 6%.

Figure 2.8. Volume of official development assistance with gender equality objectives by channel of delivery over time, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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It is important to note that these channels **can and may** transfer funds they receive onwards to other actors, so they are not necessarily the end recipient of the funds, but the intermediary through which the funds are channelled. For example, in programmes or funds managed by multilateral organisations such as the Women, Peace and Humanitarian Fund; the UN Trust Fund to End Violence Against Women; or the Global Partnership for Education, CSOs and other actors are likely to be involved in implementation. The increased used of multilateral organisations to channel funds with gender equality objectives is, however, in line with a broader trend observed in all ODA by DAC members, that ODA to and through multilateral organisations reached a new record high in 2022. This growth in multilateral contributions has been largely driven by crisis response rather than by long-term sustainable development priorities (OECD, 2024^[14]).

Although the share of ODA with gender equality objectives channelled through CSOs decreased, the volume increased steadily over the decade, from USD 6.9 billion on average in 2011-12 to USD 11.3 billion in 2021-22. Of the USD 11.3 billion, USD 7.2 billion were channelled through CSOs based in donor countries,² USD 2.7 billion through international CSOs, USD 1.2 billion through CSOs based in partner countries and USD 0.2 billion went through CSOs whose type was not defined at the time of reporting. CSOs based in partner countries have historically received a marginal share of the funding channelled through CSOs (Figure 2.9), despite DAC members' increasing recognition of the importance of localising support for partner country civil society actors (OECD, 2023^[15]). The tendency to channel more funds through international and donor-based CSOs than through CSOs based in partner countries is also seen in ODA more broadly, not only in ODA with gender equality objectives. Chapter 3 discusses this further.

Figure 2.9. Volume of official development assistance with gender equality objectives by type of civil society organisation, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: CSO: civil society organisation. Excludes CSOs whose type was not defined at the time of reporting.

Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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2.2. Other official flows for gender equality

Other official flows are not well screened against the gender equality policy marker and integrate gender equality objectives to a low extent

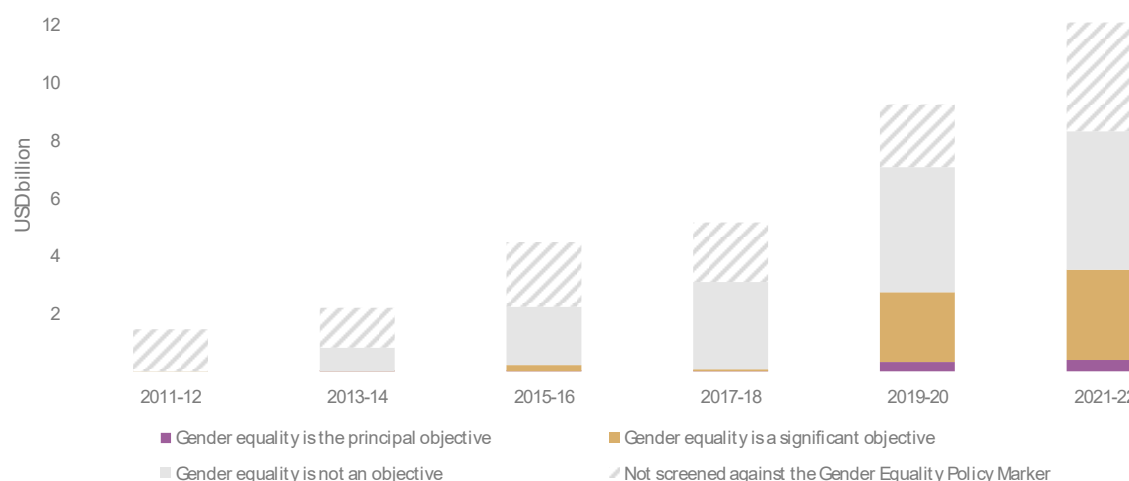
In addition to ODA, DAC members also integrate gender equality objectives into their other official flows (OOFs). OOFs are official contributions that do not meet ODA eligibility criteria, either because they are not primarily aimed at development or because they are not sufficiently concessional³ (see Annex A for the full definition of OOFs) (OECD, 2024^[16]). OOFs by DAC members are often provided by their development finance institutions. OOFs with gender equality objectives include, for example, investment

funds lending money to microfinance institutions and farmers' co-operatives, or funds investing in financial and health services. In the 2024 *DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* ([OECD/LEGAL/5022](https://oecd.org/legal/5022)) (OECD, 2024^[17]), members committed to promoting “the availability of different forms of finance for gender equality, including ODA but also other official flows such as those used in blended finance, bonds, guarantees and private investments”.

Although it is not mandatory for DAC members to report their OOFs to the OECD, reporting has improved over the years (Figure 2.10). In 2021-22, total OOFs reached USD 12.1 billion on average per year, with 18 of the 32 DAC members reporting.

Figure 2.10. Volume of other official flows per inclusion of gender equality objectives over time, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: Reporting of types of aid for other official flows became mandatory starting with 2021 flows.

Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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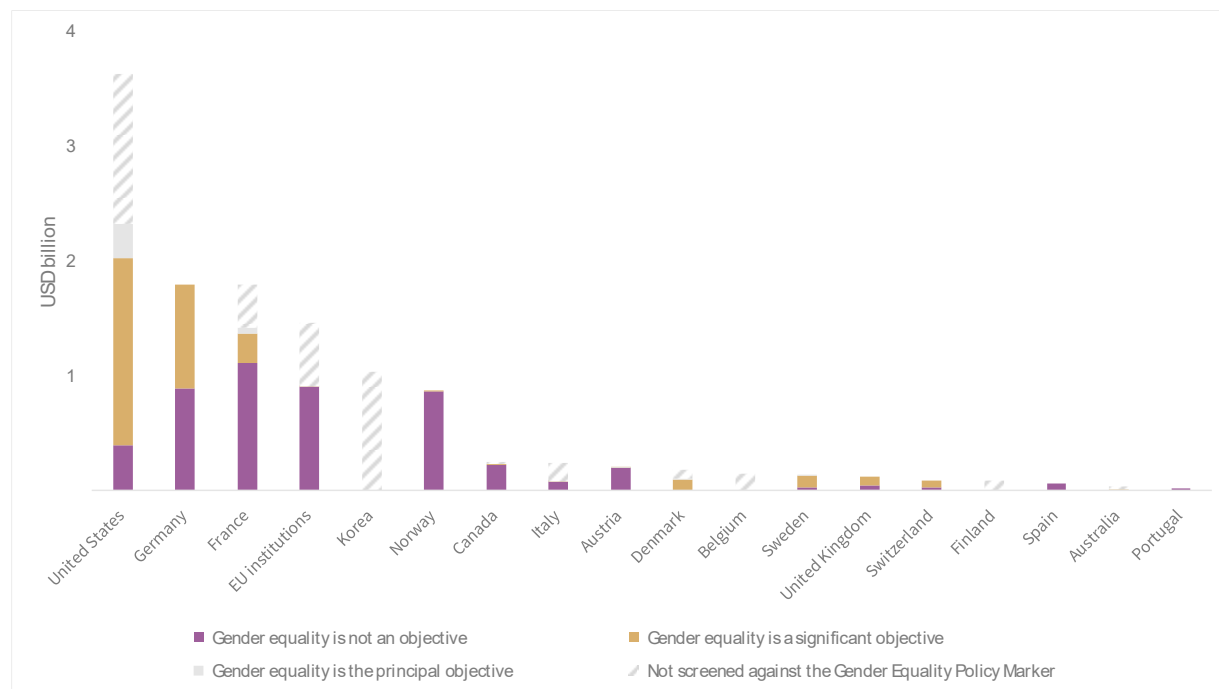
In addition to reporting more OOFs over time, DAC members have also been screening more of their OOFs against the gender equality policy marker, providing greater transparency on the extent to which these funds include gender equality considerations. While in 2011-12 no funds were examined against the marker, more than two-thirds of them were examined in 2021-22 (USD 8.3 billion out of USD 12.1 billion). From the 18 DAC members who reported OOFs in 2021-22, 13 examined more than half of their OOFs against the marker (Figure 2.11).

Some DAC members are also, or instead, reporting their OOFs to the 2X Challenge, a collective effort to mobilise private sector investments with a gender lens, which tracks gender lens investments using its unique methodology. Efforts are ongoing to map the 2X criteria to the DAC gender equality policy marker scores to facilitate and align reporting. Chapter 4 discusses this further.

In terms of including gender equality objectives in OOFs, the trend has also been positive. In 2021-22, 42% of the OOFs examined against the marker (USD 3.5 billion out of USD 8.3 billion) had gender equality objectives, which is the same share as for ODA flows. So, in addition to the USD 60.4 billion of ODA, DAC

members also included gender equality considerations in USD 3.5 billion of their OOFs in 2021-22. The United States was the largest contributor of OOFs with gender equality objectives in 2021-22, with USD 1.9 billion on average per year. Of this, USD 0.3 billion were dedicated to achieving gender equality. One example is a loan by the US International Development Finance Corporation, the development finance institution, to a microcredit company in India to finance the expansion of its investments in the sectors of renewable energy and women's empowerment, among others (DFC, 2021^[18]). Germany included gender equality objectives in USD 0.9 billion of OOFs.

Figure 2.11. Volume of other official flows per inclusion of gender equality objectives per DAC member, 2021-22 averages

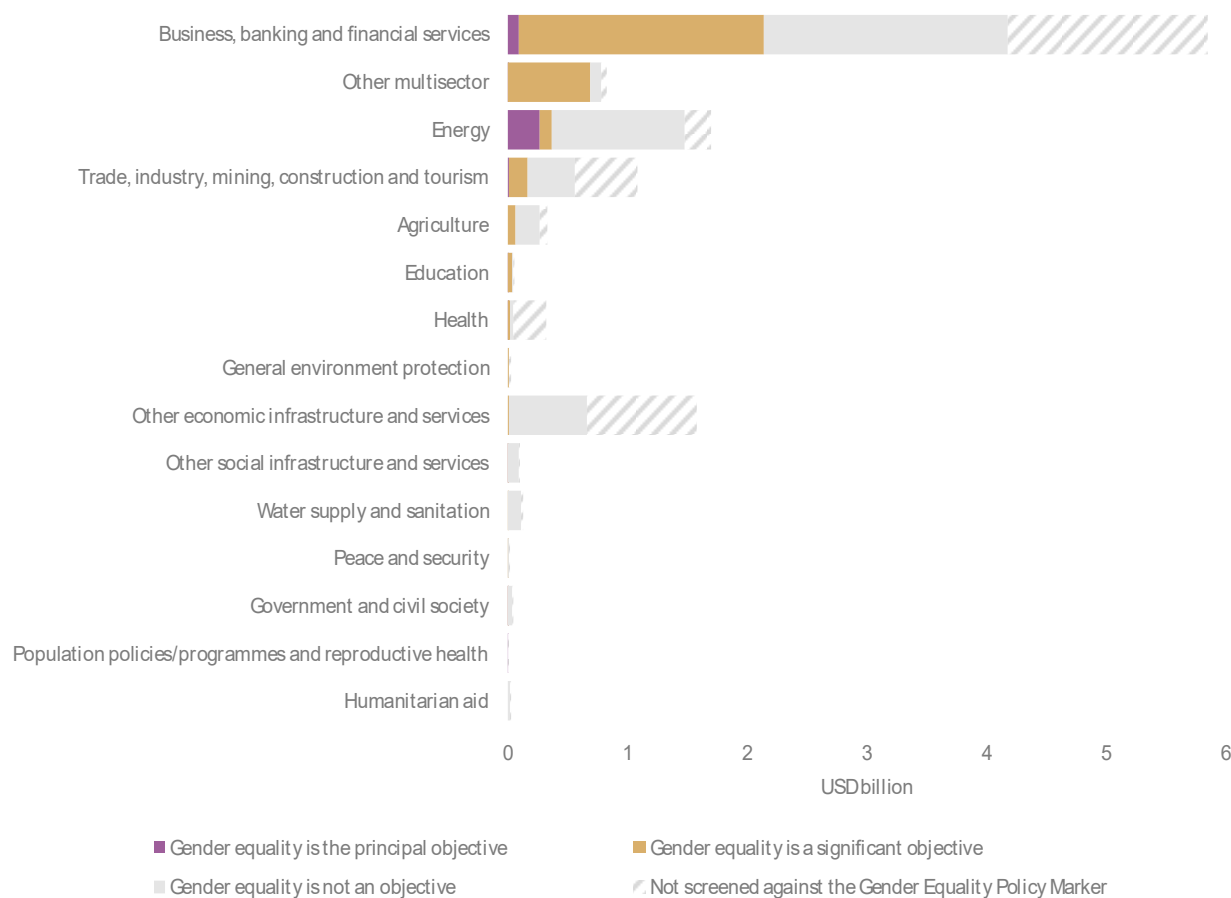


Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/z0drv7>

The banking and financial services sector benefits from the largest volume of OOF overall, which is an opportunity for those wanting to strengthen the gender equality focus of their investments. In 2021-22, USD 5.9 billion in OOFs went for banking and financial services, out of which USD 4.2 billion were examined against the gender marker and USD 2.1 billion included gender equality objectives. One example is Germany's contribution to the International Monetary Fund's Poverty Reduction and Growth Trust, which allows loans to low-income member countries at preferential terms (OECD, 2024^[2]). Loans from the trust can include financial and technical support to women entrepreneurs to launch, consolidate and grow their businesses.

Figure 2.12. Volume of other official flows by sector and by Gender Equality Policy Maker score, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[2]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/oqlv14>

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Notes

¹ The [UNDP Gender Inequality Index](#) is a composite metric of gender inequality that reflects gender-based disadvantage in three dimensions: reproductive health, empowerment and the labour market. It ranges from 0, where women and men fare equally, to 1, where one gender fares as poorly as possible in all measured dimensions.

² A donor country-based non-governmental organisation (NGO) is an NGO organised at the national level, based and operated either in the donor country or another developed (non-ODA eligible) country.

³ The Principles of ODA Modernisation on private sector instruments (PSI) present PSI as “non-concessional in nature”; however, they can convey positive grant elements that are used to measure the donor effort included in the ODA grant-equivalent measure under certain eligibility criteria. PSIs include loans to the private sector, guarantees, equity investments, mezzanine finance instruments and reimbursable grants. For more information see the 2024 [Converged Statistical Reporting Directives for the Creditor Reporting System](#) and the [relevant annex](#) for treatment of PSI.

3

Thematic focus of bilateral official development assistance for gender equality

This chapter sheds light on how gender equality is integrated into official development assistance to selected themes and to fundamental issues for women's voices and rights.

USD 143 billion of bilateral official development assistance (ODA) were examined against the Development Assistance Committee's (DAC) gender equality policy marker on average per year in 2021-22, distributed across development co-operation sectors. Only USD 60.4 billion of those funds include gender equality objectives, much of which also include other complementary policy objectives. There is scope to increase the focus on gender equality in bilateral ODA overall.

Some areas, such as humanitarian aid and energy, are well funded by DAC members but have a very limited focus on gender equality. Although the focus is improving in energy, it remains low. In addition, support for some of the fundamental areas for women's and girls' voices and rights, such as the sustainability and effectiveness of local women's rights organisations (WROs), represents only a fraction of ODA.

Other sectors, such as peace and security, have seen their focus on gender equality increase over time. Directly linked to gender equality, while funding with the policy objective of supporting reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health (RMNCH), tracked by the DAC policy marker with the same name, has overall increased, aid in the areas of reproductive health care and family planning dropped.

This chapter provides an in-depth analysis of ODA by DAC members in a few thematic areas. These were selected either because they are of key importance to strengthening women's voices and achieving transformative change for gender equality or because they provide clear opportunities for increased investments in gender equality.

3.1. Aid to contexts exposed to fragility and conflict, and humanitarian assistance

Conflicts are escalating around the world, with 614 million women and girls living in contexts exposed to fragility and conflict in 2022, 50% higher than in 2017 (UN Women and United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs, 2023^[1]). The OECD assesses fragility in countries and contexts through a multidimensional framework which covers economic, environmental, security, societal and human dimensions. Gender indicators are included in all these dimensions (OECD, 2022^[2]). In 2021-22, 60 contexts¹ were classified as experiencing high to extreme fragility, of which some are also conflict-affected.²

Conflict and fragility affect everyone. None of the contexts currently experiencing high to extreme fragility are on track to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) related to hunger, good health or gender equality. Recognising that fragility and conflict have differential and devastating consequences for different segments of the population is a prerequisite for effective crisis response and humanitarian aid that alleviates suffering in both the short and the long term. Responses to fragility, crises and conflict, including through ODA, must account for the needs and participation of women and girls. During historic, recent and ongoing conflicts, women experience: higher rates of death compared to women and children in peaceful settings; increased maternal and infant mortality; heightened levels of conflict-related sexual violence, including rape and human trafficking; heightened risks of other forms of gender-based violence, including being targeted for political violence and intimate partner violence at higher rates; and an overall deepening of gender inequalities (Bendavid et al., 2021^[3]; United Nations Secretary-General, 2024^[4]; UN OCHA, 2022^[5]; United Nations Security Council, 2023^[6]). Conflict also has less immediately visible impacts on women and girls, including: diminished opportunities for and access to education; increased prevalence of early pregnancy and early marriage; diminished economic opportunities which, in turn, increases the risk of intimate partner violence; and increased disruption to health and income from food insecurity, hunger and famine (Phelps, 2023^[7]; UK Aid, 2024^[8]; Bentaouet Kattan, Khan and Merchant, 2023^[9]; OECD, 2022^[2]).

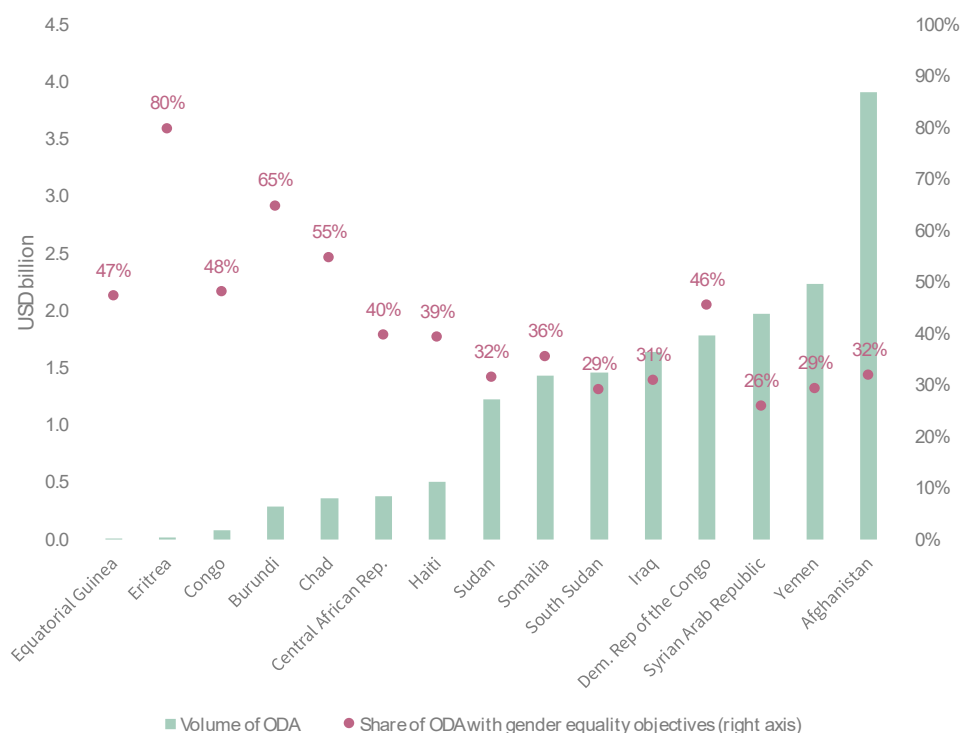
All the above-mentioned factors illustrate some of the reasons why it is necessary to maintain a focus on gender equality in development aid to fragile- and conflict-affected settings. Ignoring gender in these settings may inadvertently perpetuate instability, heighten the risk of or exacerbate existing armed conflict, increase mortality rates, and deepen pre-existing gender inequalities. Involving women in peacebuilding processes is also crucial for their success and sustainability.

DAC members struggle with integrating gender equality objectives into greater volumes of aid to contexts experiencing extreme fragility

It is often in settings exposed to fragility and conflict that DAC members deliver ODA. Out of the USD 143 billion of bilateral ODA examined against the gender equality policy marker on average per year in 2021-22, USD 47.7 billion were committed to contexts experiencing fragility. Of this, USD 20.5 billion (44%) integrated gender equality objectives. Of the 60 contexts classified as fragile by the OECD in 2021-22, 15 are considered to be exposed to extreme fragility – scoring high on all the dimensions of the fragility framework. Extreme fragility is often protracted and necessitates whole-of-system approaches to support stabilisation and sustainable development – including working on advancing gender equality. While extreme fragility is not synonymous with being conflict-affected, 11 contexts experiencing extreme fragility were also conflict-affected (Davies, Pettersson and Öberg, 2022^[10]; OECD, 2022^[2]).

It is striking that, overall, extremely fragile countries that are also conflict-affected and receive high amounts of ODA tend to have a low focus on gender equality. The vast majority of contexts receiving over USD 1 billion had gender equality objectives in less than one-third of ODA (Figure 3.1). For example, Afghanistan received USD 3.9 billion in 2021-22, but only 32% included gender equality objectives. With Afghan women and girls currently living in conditions described as “gender apartheid” (OHCHR, 2024^[11]; UN Women, 2024^[12]), the low integration of gender equality objectives into aid to Afghanistan is concerning and risks contributing to a deeper entrenchment of the backsliding of the rights of women and girls. While recognising the difficulties of operating in a deeply politically constrained environment, DAC members must commit to consistently supporting both targeted and mainstreamed efforts for advancing the rights of and conditions for women and girls in all contexts experiencing fragility and conflict.

Figure 3.1. Volumes of official development assistance by DAC members to contexts experiencing extreme fragility and share of gender-focused aid, 2021-22 averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>. OECD (2022^[2]), *States of Fragility 2022*, <https://doi.org/10.1787/c7fedf5e-en>.

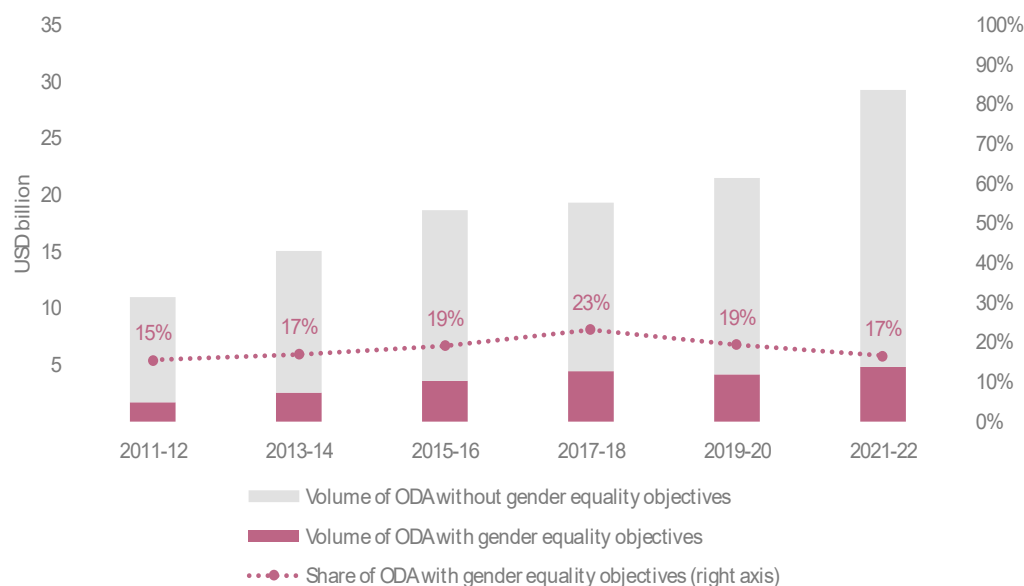
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While volumes of humanitarian aid have grown, the focus on gender equality has shrunk

In the humanitarian aid sector, the share of bilateral aid with gender equality objectives has historically been low. However – worryingly – this share is decreasing even further. The volume of bilateral humanitarian aid overall has more than doubled over the past decade, making it one of the sectors with the highest volumes of ODA at USD 29.3 billion on average per year screened against the gender equality policy marker in 2021-22. The share of bilateral humanitarian aid with gender equality objectives has, however, decreased over the past four years, stagnating at only 17% in 2021-22 (Figure 3.2). While the growing volumes of bilateral humanitarian aid reflect DAC members' responsiveness to a global rise in contexts necessitating humanitarian aid (OECD, 2024^[14]; UN OCHA, 2021^[15]; 2022^[5]), the low and decreasing inclusion of gender equality objectives illustrates important and concerning challenges with maintaining commitments to gender equality while responding to urgent crises and humanitarian situations.

Figure 3.2. Volume of DAC members' humanitarian aid and share of gender-focused humanitarian aid, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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The areas of humanitarian aid that received the highest volumes of ODA in 2021-22 also had some of the lowest shares of gender equality integration. This especially concerns emergency food assistance, which received USD 9.8 billion, of which only 8% included gender equality objectives.

Access to emergency assistance is, however, not gender-neutral. A study by the World Food Programme conducted in five contexts experiencing extreme fragility (Afghanistan, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Haiti, South Sudan and the Syrian Arab Republic) on access to assistance shows that women and girls face particular barriers in accessing humanitarian assistance in crises settings: as a result of structural inequality, women and girls often have lower levels of literacy and limited access to educational opportunities and access to financial services. This impacts their ability to access basic information on how, when and where to receive humanitarian assistance (World Food Programme, 2023^[16]). Other examples include bureaucratic barriers, such as women having lower rates of access to the civil documentation often needed to register for food distribution lists. These obstacles occur *before* women and girls seek to access food assistance, yet there are challenges throughout the process, including security concerns and heightened risks of gender-based violence in contexts where women are the primary collectors of assistance (World Food Programme, 2023^[16]). For example, poorly organised and managed distribution sites heighten the risk of sexual exploitation and abuse and can be exacerbated by operating intermixed lines of women and men (The Global Women's Institute, 2023^[17]). Designing interventions with a gender lens, as a minimum, is crucial to avoid further exacerbating the differentiated impact of humanitarian crises on women and girls.

These challenges around integrating gender equality in humanitarian assistance or aid to contexts experiencing fragility also applies to emerging crisis response, for example in ODA to Ukraine in 2022 (Box 3.1).

Box 3.1. Missed opportunities to advance gender equality in crisis response to Ukraine

Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members committed USD 18.9 billion in bilateral allocable official development assistance (ODA) to Ukraine in 2022 in the context of Russia's war of aggression, representing a significant increase from 2021. However, less than 10% of it (USD 1.8 billion) included gender equality objectives.

Half of ODA to Ukraine (USD 9.4 billion) was committed to the "government and civil society" sector, largely to support public sector policy and administrative management in particular (USD 8.7 billion). This includes, for example, institution-building assistance to strengthen core public sector management systems and capacities as well as public policy co-ordination, human resource management or organisational development. However, of all ODA to this sector, 96% (USD 9.1 billion) did *not* include any gender equality objectives.

Examples of programmes that *did* account for gender equality include support for building greater democratic resilience through media training and support to civil society; capacity development of lawyers, health professionals and other human rights defenders; legal assistance to victims of human rights violations; and institutional capacity building and administrative modernisation.

Similarly, humanitarian aid to Ukraine in 2022 amounted to USD 3.1 billion, of which only USD 908 million (29%) included gender equality objectives (OECD, 2024^[18]). This share is higher than the average share of humanitarian assistance with gender equality for all partner countries combined but remains low.

Several humanitarian aid programmes in Ukraine in 2022 that were intended to support affected people, provide basic food and health services, shelter, and medical material were reported to the OECD as not considering gender issues. Bearing in mind the disproportionate impact of crises and conflict on women and girls, it is essential to level up efforts to advance gender equality across all contexts and crisis responses.

Women's rights organisations as agile first-responders in crises

Conflict-related sexual violence has been reported in high numbers in Ukraine and while the government was swift to acknowledge the prevalence of it, women's rights organisations (WROs) were at the forefront of supporting victims/survivors, reprogramming funding and mobilising donor support for humanitarian response activities that targeted women and girls (Trokhym, 2024^[19]; Women's Peace and Humanitarian Fund, 2024^[20]). This included scaling up services for victims of gender-based violence, including emergency shelters for women and girls (Trokhym, 2024^[19]).

A sudden increase in funding also came with additional challenges, namely the risk of overwhelming and undermining WROs' strategic planning and shrinking the space for dialogue concerning their missions (Trokhym, 2024^[19]). However, by addressing the risks associated with an unsustainable expansion of operations, some WROs pivoted from providing frontline support to acting as capacity-strengthening partners for other WROs while working with international partners to scale programming to address the needs of women and girls across the country (Trokhym, 2024^[19]).

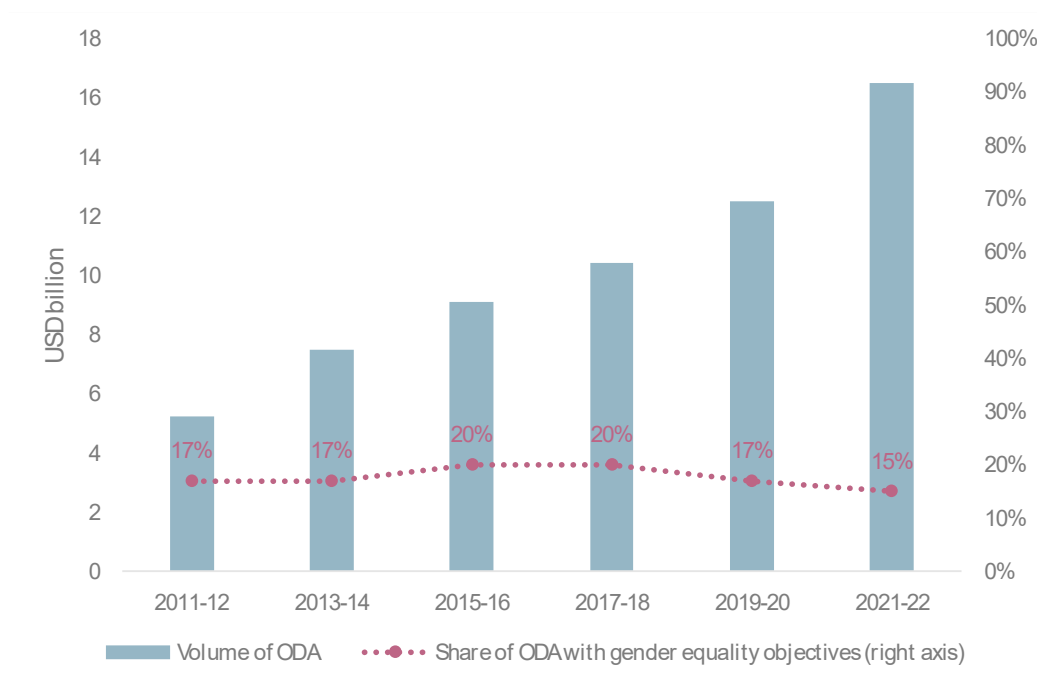
Source: OECD (2024^[18]), *Official Development Assistance for Gender Equality in Ukraine in 2022*, [https://one.oecd.org/document/DAC/GEN\(2024\)4/en/pdf](https://one.oecd.org/document/DAC/GEN(2024)4/en/pdf); World Bank et al. (2023^[21]), *Second Ukraine Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA2): February 2022-February 2023*, <http://documents.worldbank.org/curated/en/099184503212328877/P1801740d1177f03c0ab180057556615497>; The Kvinna till Kvinna Foundation (2023^[22]), *They Came Together Not to Be Silenced: Gender-based Violence in Conflict & the Role of Women's Rights Organisations*, <https://kvinnatillkvinna.org/publications/they-came-together-not-to-be-silenced-gender-based-violence-in-conflict-the-role-of-womens-rights-organisations>.

Humanitarian aid is increasingly channelled through United Nations agencies but with a low and declining focus on gender equality

Most commonly, DAC members channel bilateral humanitarian aid through multilateral organisations, particularly through UN agencies, funds or commissions. In 2021-22, this sub-channel alone was used to deploy more than half of all bilateral humanitarian aid (USD 16.5 billion of the USD 29.3 billion of bilateral aid screened against the gender equality policy marker). The volume of humanitarian aid channelled through UN agencies has tripled over the past decade. At the same time, the gender equality focus of aid channelled through UN agencies, funds or commissions has steadily declined (Figure 3.3). In 2021-22, only 15% of humanitarian aid channelled through UN agencies had gender equality objectives. While these channels can and may transfer funds they receive onwards to other actors, it is still concerning that, at the outset, only a fraction of bilateral humanitarian assistance includes gender equality objectives. DAC members need to work closely with UN agencies to ensure gender equality objectives are included in emergency contexts and humanitarian aid.

Figure 3.3. Volume of DAC members' humanitarian aid channelled through UN agencies and share with gender equality objectives, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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The second largest sub-channel by volume is donor country-based non-governmental organisations (NGOs), which was used for about one-fifth of all bilateral humanitarian aid in 2021-22 (USD 5.1 billion). Of this, 22% included gender equality objectives (USD 1.1 billion). The third largest sub-channel by volume is international NGOs, which received one-tenth of all humanitarian aid (USD 3.1 billion). Of this, 20% included gender equality objectives (USD 0.6 billion). Cumulatively, these three sub-channels were used

for almost all humanitarian aid in 2021-22 (USD 24.6 billion of USD 29.3 billion), all with low integration of gender equality objectives.

While the share of humanitarian aid with gender equality objectives is low across most channels, there are some noticeable exceptions. For example, 82% of humanitarian aid channelled via recipient governments had gender equality objectives, although total volumes were much lower. Compared with international or donor-country based NGOs, humanitarian aid channelled through partner country-based NGOs also has a higher share of gender equality objectives (36% in 2021-22), but overall volumes are very low.

Successes in putting gender equality on the agenda: Lessons from peace and security

The data paint a mixed picture of the successes and failures in integrating gender equality across the humanitarian, development and peace nexus. Whereas the share of humanitarian aid with gender equality objectives decreased, the share of ODA with gender equality objectives in the peace and security sector has grown over the past decade, from 26% in 2011-12 to 49% in 2021-22. However, the sector has experienced a decline in overall volumes of ODA over the past years (OECD, 2023^[23]).

The peace and security sector has likely benefited from political momentum and concerted efforts to implement the women, peace and security agenda over the past decades, propelled by the adoption of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 in 2000 (UNSC, 2000^[24]) and ensuing resolutions, as well as countries' national action plans. This is an illustration of how political will and policy efforts can help drive more financing.

3.2. Official development assistance for energy and gender equality

DAC members recognise that promoting gender equality is crucial for climate change mitigation and adaptation and are increasingly financing projects that tackle these objectives in an interconnected manner (OECD, 2023^[25]) (Box 3.2). A similar conclusion has also been observed in the intersection of biodiversity and gender equality (OECD, 2023^[26]). Energy, especially clean energy, is a central theme in efforts to combat climate change, since many renewable energy sources emit little to no greenhouse gases or pollutants and are continuously replenished. However, transitioning away from fossil fuels can reduce climate-related pressure on biodiversity, but brings its own risks. Unless carefully managed, the expansion of renewable power could compromise biodiversity, which in turn would have negative repercussions on gender equality and other social goals (OECD, 2024^[27]).

The case for a gender-responsive just transition towards clean energy economies is underscored in global commitments such as the Paris Agreement, Sustainable Energy for All (SEforALL) and the SDGs (OECD, 2024^[28]). Gender equality and energy access are inextricably linked, and addressing them together can offer multiple development gains, including poverty reduction, food security, increased access to health, clean air and education, and innovation (ENERGIA, World Bank and UN Women, 2018^[29]). Policies and programmes that consider gender equality in the energy sector are essential not only for achieving SDG 5 on gender equality and SDG 7 on affordable and clean energy but also for those linked to poverty (SDG 1), health and well-being (SDG 3), education (SDG 4), climate change (SDG 13), life below water (SDG 14), and life on land (SDG 15) (Cecelski and Oparaocha, 2023^[30]).

Women and girls are disproportionately affected by energy poverty due to gender norms and economic disparities, particularly in female-headed households that often have fewer financial resources (ENERGIA, 2024^[31]; ENERGIA, World Bank and UN Women, 2018^[29]; Cecelski and Oparaocha, 2023^[30]). Energy poverty limits their ability to carry out daily activities, such as cooking, accessing clean water and using technology, which directly impacts their health, education and livelihoods (ENERGIA, 2024^[31]). An estimated 341 million women and girls will still lack electricity by 2030, with 85% residing in sub-Saharan Africa (ENERGIA, 2024^[31]). Their reliance on inefficient energy sources for cooking not only increases

indoor air pollution and health risks but also the amount of time spent on unpaid domestic work, limiting opportunities for education and employment (Krishnapriya et al., 2021^[32]). Women and girls also bear the physical burden of collecting fuel and water, often risking their safety and health, especially in areas affected by climate change and biodiversity loss (WHO, 2016^[33]; OECD, 2021^[34]). Further evidence indicates that women and girls are at risk of sexual violence when they collect fuel and water or are outside after dark (Rewald, 2017^[35]).

The interlinkages between energy and gender equality go beyond clean cooking and access to energy. Despite making up 39% of the global labour force, women only account for 16% of the energy sector (IEA, 2022^[36]). Gender norms and systemic barriers restrict their participation in the energy sector labour market, where they face wage gaps and limited opportunities. In 18 economies around the world, women are still prohibited to perform certain tasks in the energy sector (World Bank, 2024^[37]). Despite their key role in energy use and clean energy deployment in underserved areas, women are also underrepresented in energy governance and decision making (ENERGIA, 2024^[31]). In January 2023, only 11% of ministerial positions responsible for energy, natural resource fuels and mining were held by women across 190 countries (IPU and UN Women, 2023^[38]).

Enhancing women's access to modern³ energy services and involving them in energy policy, decision making and the labour market are essential for a sustainable and just energy transition. This is an opportunity for DAC members to accelerate progress on the SDGs, and is in line with the commitments set out in the *OECD DAC Declaration on a New Approach to Align Development Co-operation with the Goals of the Paris Agreement on Climate Change* ([OECD/LEGAL/0466](#)) (OECD, 2021^[39]).

Box 3.2. Official development assistance for the intersection of climate, biodiversity and gender equality

Gender inequality, climate change, biodiversity loss and environmental degradation are interconnected challenges and are mutually reinforcing. Women and girls are disproportionately exposed to the impacts of climate change and have fewer resources and less information to be able to adapt to it. For example, when families are faced with scarce resources due to climate change, they may feel forced to take girls out of school and sometimes into early marriage. Another example is the increased exposure to gender-based violence, as women and girls need to travel longer distances to collect resources.

The OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) has been tracking the extent to which international development finance approaches these challenges in an interconnected manner. The data show a positive trend. While only 32% of climate-related official development assistance (ODA) included gender equality objectives 2011-12, this increased to 59% in 2021-22. The volume of bilateral ODA targeting both gender equality and climate also reached a record high in 2021-22 at USD 27.6 billion.

Achieving gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls is considered particularly crucial for biodiversity and for the effective implementation of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. Women and girls, particularly from indigenous peoples and local communities, play a vital role in biodiversity management and conservation. However, gender inequalities limit their rights to land and produce, and restrict their access to decision-making processes. Acknowledging this, DAC members have been increasingly integrating biodiversity and gender equality across their development finance and increasing bilateral ODA focused on both gender equality and biodiversity over time, in absolute and relative terms: in 2021-22, 68% of biodiversity-related bilateral ODA from DAC members also targeted gender equality (USD 6.8 billion), an increase from 53% in 2011-12 (USD 3.1 billion).

Source: OECD (2024^[40]), *Biodiversity and Development Finance 2015-2022: Contributing to Target 19 of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework*, <https://doi.org/10.1787/d26526ad-en>; OECD (2023^[25]), "The gender equality and environment intersection: An overview of development co-operation frameworks and financing", <https://doi.org/10.1787/c16d8fe8-en>; Elias et al (2024^[41]), *Placing Gender Equality at the heart of the implementation of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework*.

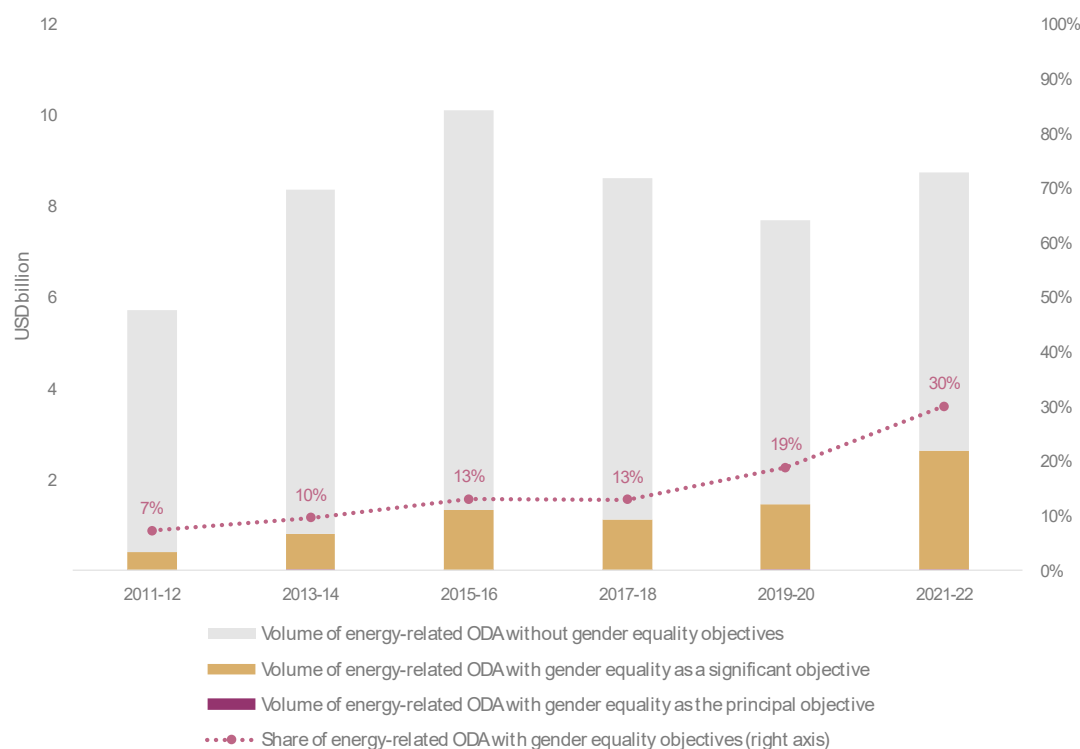
Gender equality is more and more integrated in energy ODA but there is still a lot of room for improvement

Out of the USD 143 billion of bilateral ODA examined against the gender equality policy marker on average per year in 2021-22, USD 8.7 billion went to the energy sector. Of this, USD 2.6 billion, or 30%, included gender equality objectives. This represents an increase from 2011-12, when the share was only 7% (USD 0.4 billion of USD 5.7 billion).

DAC members are overall moving in the right direction, but the energy sector continues to be one of the sectors with the lowest share of gender equality objectives: two-thirds of energy-related ODA still entirely lack gender equality considerations and there are almost no energy-related programmes with gender equality as a principal objective (Figure 3.4).

Figure 3.4. Volume and share of DAC members' official development assistance for the energy sector with gender equality objectives, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/ldaeob>

The DAC members with the highest shares of energy-related ODA with gender equality objectives in 2021-22 were Canada (100%), Ireland (95%), Iceland (73%), Finland (71%) and the EU institutions (65%). These DAC members are leading the way to show that gender integration is possible. Other DAC members who are struggling to make their energy-ODA more gender-responsive could learn from those who are ahead of the curve to make the most of their energy programmes and projects. It is good practice for DAC members to collectively exchange on how to promote sustainable development in a gender-responsive way.

In terms of volumes of ODA with gender equality objectives for the energy sector, the European Union is the largest contributor, followed by Canada, France, Germany, Japan and the United Kingdom. While Germany and Japan are among the largest funders of overall ODA for the energy sector, most of their ODA does not include gender equality objectives. It is important to note, however, that both increased their gender equality focus in 2021-22 compared to 2019-20.

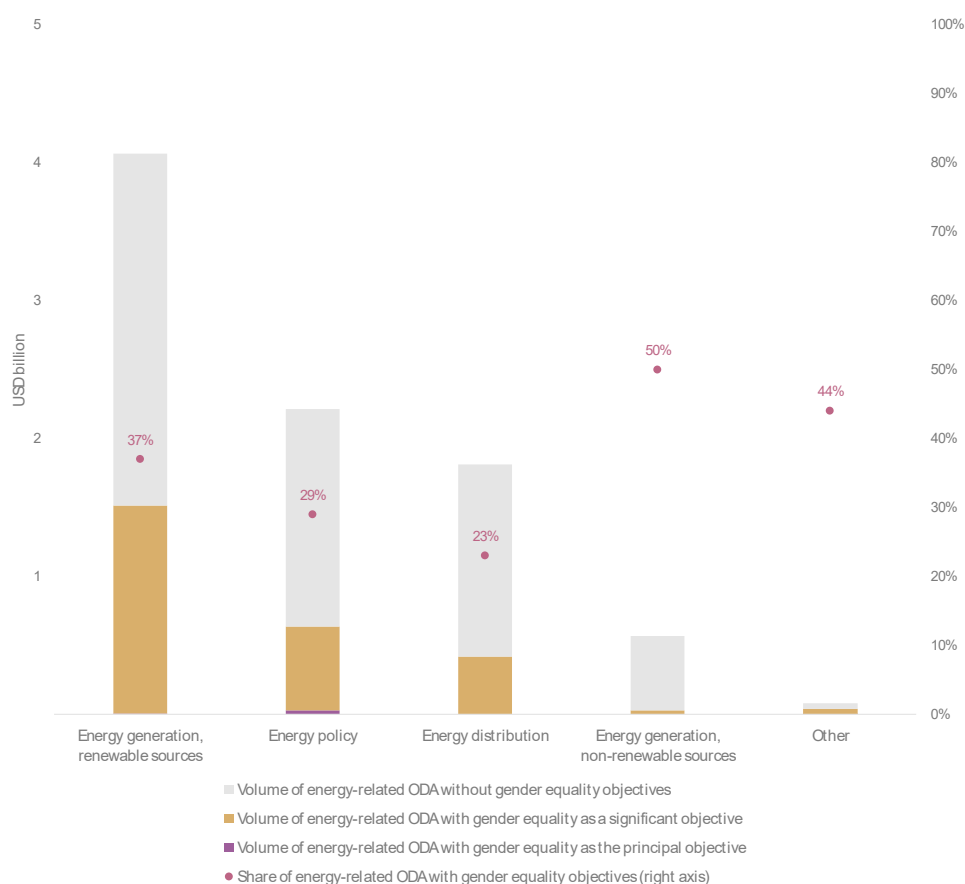
The focus on gender equality of ODA in support of clean energy generation has increased

Of the USD 8.7 billion of bilateral allocable ODA committed to the energy sector on average per year in 2021-22, USD 4.1 billion went to energy generation – renewable sources. This is the largest focus area

and one which has been increasing since 2011-12. ODA for this area has also seen a better integration of gender equality objectives over time. In 2021-22, 37% of the USD 4.1 billion included gender equality objectives (corresponding to USD 1.5 billion; Figure 3.5), up from only 10% (USD 0.2 billion of USD 2.1 billion) a decade ago. This suggests a stronger focus on gender equality in new programmes related to clean energy.

ODA with gender equality objectives in this area includes contributions to financial funds; financial incentive schemes for private and public actors for renewable energy generation; capacity development for local institutions and communities, with a particular focus on vulnerable communities and women; and the installation of infrastructure facilities for clean energy generation. For instance, Global Affairs Canada invested in the Climate Investment Funds to accelerate the transition from coal-powered to clean energy in Asia and Africa. In addition, Canada set up a Women-Led Coal Transitions mechanism to directly support local communities and organisations working on the rights of women and other excluded groups (Climate Investment Funds, 2024^[42]).

Figure 3.5. Volume and share of DAC members' official development assistance for the energy sector with gender equality objectives by energy areas, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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In 2021-22, the areas in the energy sector with the next two largest volumes of ODA with gender equality objectives were energy policy (USD 0.6 billion) and energy distribution (USD 0.4 billion). Energy policy

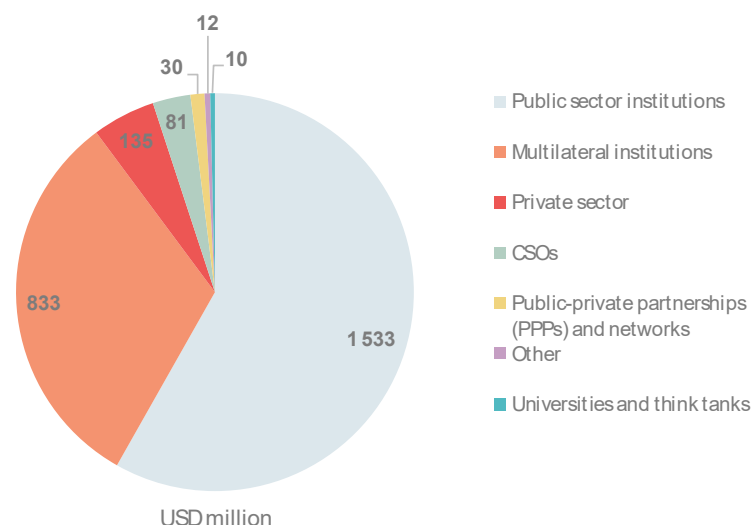
programmes can target technical, knowledge or capacity development support that enables countries to create, sustain and use renewable energy sources. For example, Oxfam's Inclusion Project Phase II in the Mekong sub-region funded by the Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade and the Swiss Agency for Development Cooperation is a good practice example. The project promotes the leadership roles of women and representatives of marginalised social groups in influencing national and regional state and non-state actors in water resource governance and energy policy and planning processes (Oxfam, 2020^[43]). Programmes in this area also focus on providing assistance on national policy and regulatory framework reforms for energy. Norway's programme is another example. It aims to promote a just transition from coal to renewable energy and clean cooking solutions in three African countries (OECD, 2024^[13]) by improving national energy policies and regulatory frameworks, boosting cross-border renewable energy trade, and encouraging financial divestment from coal while increasing investment in renewables, including women-led enterprises. Energy distribution programmes include for example rural electrification programmes, improvement of existing systems and power transmission capacity development, among others. For instance, Germany provided a USD 3 million promotional loan to Uganda to enhance the power transmission capacity between Kampala and Entebbe, ensuring a reliable electricity supply for Entebbe (OECD, 2024^[13]).

In all three of these areas, over the past decade, the volume and share of ODA that includes gender equality objectives has been steadily increasing, and rose significantly from 2019-20 to 2021-22.

Delivery channels of energy-related ODA integrating gender equality objectives

Of the USD 2.6 billion of energy-related ODA with gender equality objectives, more than half is channelled through public sector institutions and nearly a third through multilateral organisations and banks (Figure 3.6). The ODA being channelled through the World Bank stands out as a good practice, integrating gender equality objectives in four-fifths of the USD 0.5 billion in 2021-22 on average (OECD, 2024^[13]).

Figure 3.6. Volume of official development assistance with gender equality objectives for the energy sector by channel of delivery, 2021-22 averages



Note: CSO: civil society organisation; PPP: public-private partnership.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

3.3. Women's rights organisations and feminist movements: Key partners for delivering official development assistance with gender equality objectives

Women's rights organisations and feminist movements are essential actors to achieve transformative and sustainable change for gender equality. They are rooted inside communities and bring contextual expertise that is critical to understand and address structural drivers of inequality. For example, WROs work on the frontlines to protect women and girls from violence and support victims/survivors of violence. Analysis shows that strong local women's rights and feminist movements have been instrumental in changing laws on ending violence against women (Weldon and Htun, 2013^[44]). As such, it is important to support their core functioning with direct, flexible and predictable multi-year funding to enhance their effectiveness, influence and sustainability. It is positive that DAC members have committed to increasing funding for these actors in the *DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* ([OECD/LEGAL/5022](#)) (OECD, 2024^[45]) and to supporting civil society and locally led development through the *DAC Recommendation on Enabling Civil Society in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* (OECD-LEGAL-5021) (OECD, 2021^[46]) and the *Donor Statement on Supporting Locally Led Development* (USAID, 2022^[47]).

A dedicated code of the OECD database allows tracking funding aimed specifically to support the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of women's rights organisations and institutions.⁴

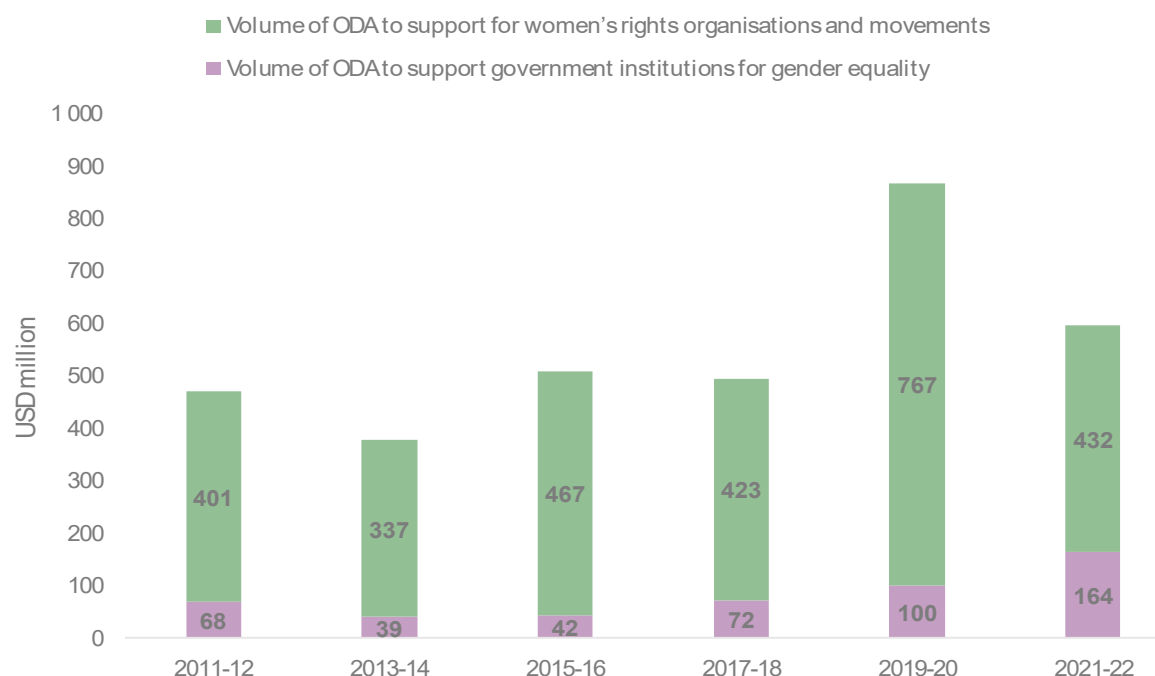
The volume of aid to women's rights organisations remains around USD 0.5 billion per year

ODA to the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs consistently remains at a strikingly low volume and amounts to less than 1% of ODA for gender equality. In terms of volumes, this has slightly fluctuated over the past decade but remained around USD 0.5 billion per year, with a spike in 2019-20 (Figure 3.7). Total ODA to enhance the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs in 2021-22 was USD 596 million. Excluding ODA to support public sector institutions, mainly ministries of women and gender equality, this amount drops to USD 432 million in 2021-22. In turn, the amount of this ODA for public sector institutions has increased slightly over time, amounting to USD 164 million.

The spike in funding in 2019-20 was mainly due to large contributions by Canada to the Equality Fund (USD 269 million) reported in 2019 and contributions by the Netherlands to Power of Voices and Leading from the South projects (USD 164 million) reported in 2020.

Figure 3.7. Volume of official development assistance for women's rights organisations and movements, and government institutions by DAC members, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Note: ODA: official development assistance; WRO: women's rights organisation.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/pxc8vh>

While funding remains low, there are many examples of good practices for working with WROs, including leveraging their power in post-conflict recovery and reconstruction efforts as an avenue for advancing gender equality, sustainable development and stabilisation in conflict settings (Box 3.3).

Box 3.3. Leveraging women's rights organisations for gender-sensitive social reconstruction in conflict settings

In 2021, Sweden funded a programme to support political transition in the Syrian Arab Republic through gender-sensitive social reconstruction. The programme leverages the Euromed Feminist Initiative, a local women's rights network with decades-long experience collaborating with Syrian women's rights activists. By contributing to inclusive and gender-sensitive peacebuilding and social reconstruction processes in Syria, the programme is expected to support women's rights organisations (WROs) with a toolkit towards combating gender-based violence as a barrier to women's participation in all levels of decision making, enhance synergies between women's rights- and human rights organisations, improve access to comprehensive knowledge on gender issues for activists, including youth; and address gender-based discrimination in law and prepare a comprehensive legal framework for curbing violence against women and girls.

Programmes that foster the empowerment of local WROs and actors are crucial towards engendering sustainable and durable development for gender equality.

Different components of the programme were reported to the OECD under the women's rights organisations and movements, and government institutions code, the ending violence against women and girls code, and the democratic participation and civil society code – all channelled through "networks".

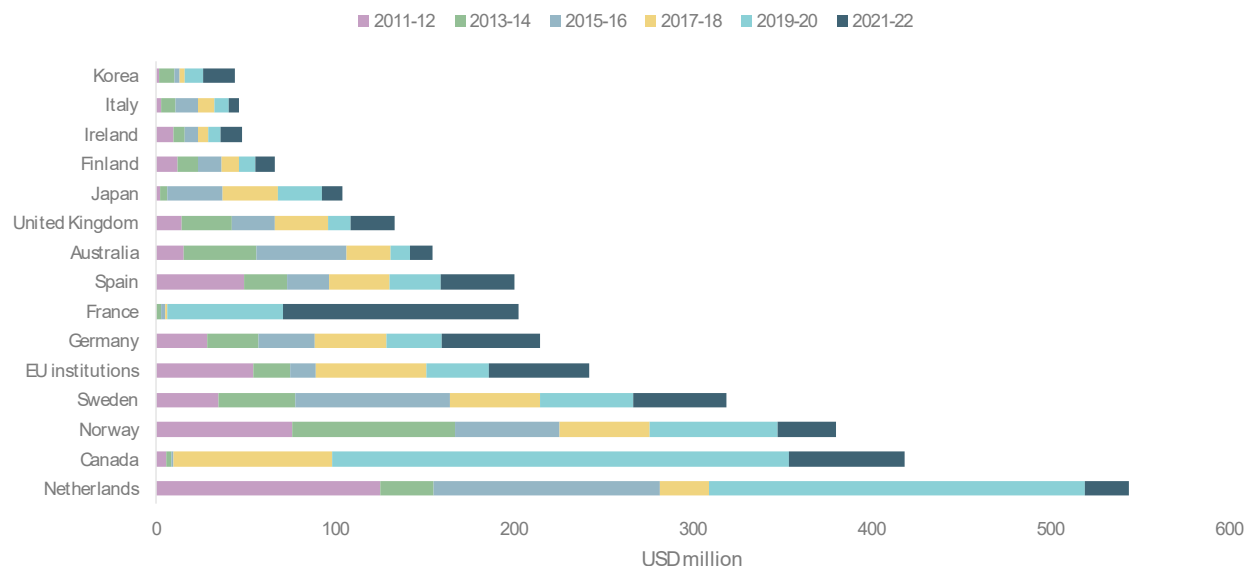
Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>; Euromed Feminist Initiative (2023^[48]), "Supporting political transition in Syria through gender-sensitive social reconstruction", <https://www.efi-ife.org/en/offer-detail/309-terms-of-reference-for-external-evaluation-of-the-program-supporting-political-transition-in-syria-through-gender-sensitive-social-reconstruction>.

Few DAC members provide consistent funding for women's rights organisations

Some DAC members stand out as consistent and strong supporters of WROs to enhance their effectiveness, influence and sustainability (Figure 3.8). Others have increased their support in the last few years.

Figure 3.8. Volume of official development assistance for the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of women's rights organisations, top 15 DAC members, 2011-22

Two-year averages



Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/k1ismr>

Over the past decade, 15 DAC members consistently accounted for nearly all the ODA to enhance the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs. In particular, over time, the volume of ODA has largely been driven by the consistent contributions of the Netherlands and Canada, who have also initiated some of the most innovative programmes aimed to reach local women's rights organisations and movements while ensuring leadership by local actors. For example, the Netherlands supported the Leading from the South programme that worked with the African Women's Development Fund to manage and disburse grants for local, national and regional WROs working towards the empowerment of African women and the promotion and realisation of their rights (OECD, 2024^[13]); (OECD, 2022^[49]).

This funding landscape is currently shifting slightly, with France being the largest contributor of ODA to the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs in 2021-22 (USD 132 million) through the Feminist Fund, followed by Canada (USD 64 million) then the EU institutions (USD 56 million). It is a positive sign that more DAC members are increasingly funding WROs. More members should follow the example and learn from those who have been strong and consistent supporters over several years.

Challenges remain in terms of directly funding the core work of southern women's groups, including donors' institutional or regulatory barriers on funding modalities. For example, development partners may encounter concerns over the perceived risk of funding local organisations, leading to a preference to fund organisations already familiar to them, which will typically be international CSOs or CSOs based in DAC

member countries (OECD, 2023^[50]). Other challenges include reporting requirements to demonstrate results and a reigning perception that WROs have less capacity to deliver at scale and in a manner that meets donor requirements (OECD, 2016^[51]). Finally, pressure to keep transaction costs low may leave fewer people to administer grants in DAC member institutions, while there is a simultaneous concern that capacity building WROs is time- and resource-intensive (OECD, 2016^[51]). For the organisations themselves, these challenges impact their work beyond solely being a barrier to funding in the first place. Having to live up to complex and burdensome administrative requirements from DAC member institutions, for example the effort put into extensive grant proposal writing or reporting, may not always correlate positively to the amount or type of funding received, i.e. directive or heavily earmarked (OECD, 2016^[51]). In an OECD review of donor support to WROs, women's rights organisations expressed that reporting requirements were often inappropriate for capturing the structural and transformative changes they were seeking, and that the organisations do not struggle with a lack of capacity per se but may lack capacity to meet current donor requirements (OECD, 2016^[51]). Mitigating these challenges may include shifting funding modalities by increasing direct, core support to local CSOs to favour ownership and leadership (OECD, 2024^[52]). The first Toolkit for Implementing the DAC Recommendation on Enabling Civil Society in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance on Funding Civil Society in Partner Countries (OECD, 2023^[50]) underlines the need for providers to increase the availability and accessibility of direct, flexible and predictable support to partner country CSOs, including women-led ones.

Over half of the funding for women's rights organisations' sustainability is channelled through the UN system or civil society organisations based in a donor country

DAC members' funding in support for women's rights organisations' and movements' effectiveness, influence and sustainability most often reaches these actors through intermediaries such as multilateral organisations, larger CSOs or women's funds.

In 2021-22, USD 160 million were channelled through UN institutions such as the Women's Peace and Humanitarian Fund, which mobilises and channels flexible and quality funding and capacity support to women peacebuilders, humanitarians and human rights defenders. This was followed by USD 145 million channelled through donor-based CSOs (Figure 3.9).

Figure 3.9. Volume of official development assistance to support women's rights organisations' effectiveness, influence and sustainability by sub-channel, DAC members, 2021-22 averages



Note: UN: United Nations; CSO: civil society organisation; PPP: private-public partnership.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

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Only USD 29 million were provided directly from DAC members to WROs based in a recipient country (Figure 3.9). Directly providing funding to local WROs reduces the intermediaries in the aid chain from development partner to recipient and allows for support to be grounded in local contexts and needs (OECD, 2023^[50]). Local civil society actors also tend to demand accountability from their governments, and vice versa (OECD, 2023^[50]). On the other hand, many contexts have legal restrictions in place that impact WROs' and CSOs' ability to receive direct funding from development partners and channelling funds directly may expose them to risks (OECD, 2023^[50]). DAC governments may also have limited capacities to manage direct funding relationships with local civil society actors due to transaction costs. Overall, of the USD 60.4 billion of total ODA with gender equality objectives in 2021-22, only USD 1.2 billion were channelled directly by DAC members to and through a local CSO based in a partner country (see Chapter 2).

With one of the overarching challenges facing WROs being a lack of predictable and flexible funding, their ability to do invaluable work is threatened and this continuity risk is deepening (Women's Peace and Humanitarian Fund, 2023^[53]). Additional challenges – and dangers – include the shrinking or restricted civic spaces in which many WROs operate, backlash against the rights of women and girls, and the direct influxes of aid may inadvertently heighten WROs' operational and physical risks. Tangible risks include harassment, violence and threats of “retaliation” (Women's Peace and Humanitarian Fund, 2023^[53]; The Kvinna till Kvinna Foundation, 2023^[54]).

However, WROs consistently illustrate immense resilience as actors which can be leveraged to enable positive social change. They have contributed to lowering rates of child marriage, establishing quotas for women's participation in government, and improved societal attention to gender equality issues such as care and labour rights (Alliance for Feminist Movements and Equal Measures 2030, 2024^[55]). This includes in fragile and conflict-affected settings (Box 3.4); however, less than 1% (USD 142 million) of total ODA to contexts exposed to fragility and conflict went towards enhancing the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs in these contexts.

Box 3.4. In conflict and beyond, women's rights organisations are critical actors

Despite the extremely modest levels of funding, women's rights organisations (WROs) play a crucial role for delivering sustainable development and humanitarian assistance and supporting peace. They can play productive roles in peace negotiations and processes; their participation in peace processes can lower the risk of conflict relapse, for example in the aftermath of civil war; and they act as important advocates for advancing better governance systems on a national level (OECD, 2023^[23]). During conflict, WROs also showcase extensive capacity for resilient responses and are uniquely situated to do so.

Currently, during the evolving conflict in the West Bank and Gaza Strip – with catastrophic levels of food insecurity and famine in some parts, outbreaks of communicable diseases such as polio, ever worsening maternal health and birth conditions, more women and children killed by military than in any other recent conflict in a single year, and much more – women-led organisations are at the forefront of humanitarian responses.

These organisations provide critical field support, and many organisations have shifted their operations virtually overnight to provide life-saving aid (UN Women, 2024^[56]). This is *despite* the fact that half of the organisations surveyed in UN Women's Rapid Gender Alert saw their funding decline or suspended entirely by donors (UN Women, 2024^[56]). The vast majority of organisations report that – second only to safety and security concerns – a lack of funds to address extensive humanitarian need is the most critical challenge (UN Women, 2024^[56]).

The examples of the resilience and adaptability of WROs in conflict stretch across contexts experiencing fragility and conflict such as Afghanistan, Myanmar and Ukraine, among others.

Source: OECD (2023^[23]), "Peace and official development assistance", <https://doi.org/10.1787/fccfbffc-en>; IPC (2024^[57]), *Gaza Strip: IPC Acute Food Insecurity Special Snapshot*, <https://www.un.org/unispal/document/gaza-strip-famine-ipc-snapshot-25jun24>; WHO (2024^[58]), "Regional health ministers rally to support immediate steps to stop polio from paralyzing children in the Gaza Strip", <https://www.emro.who.int/polio-eradication/news/regional-health-ministers-rally-to-support-immediate-steps-to-stop-polio-from-paralyzing-children-in-the-gaza-strip.html>; Kvinna till Kvinna Foundation (2024^[59]), "Obstetric, reproductive & maternal violence in Gaza", <https://kvinna.tillkvinna.org/publications/obstetric-reproductive-maternal-violence-in-gaza>; UN Women (2024^[56]), *Gender Alert: Voices of Strength: Contributions of Palestinian Women Led Organizations to the Humanitarian Response in the Occupied Palestinian Territory*, https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/2024-06/gender-alert_palestine-wlos-en.pdf; Oxfam (2024^[60]), "More women and children killed in Gaza by Israeli military than any other recent conflict in a single year", <https://www.oxfam.org/en/press-releases/more-women-and-children-killed-gaza-israeli-military-any-other-recent-conflict>.

The second Toolkit for Implementing the DAC Recommendation on Enabling Civil Society in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance on Shifting Power with Partners (OECD, 2024^[61]) underlines the necessity of a power shift when it comes to supporting CSOs – including WROs. This includes levelling up direct support to partner country CSOs and engaging consciously with the power imbalances present between provider country and international CSOs *vis-à-vis* partner country CSOs – an imbalance which may be exacerbated by the operating practices of development partners – to improve the efficacy and long-term sustainability of development efforts (OECD, 2024^[61]).

The overall low levels of funding to enhance the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs, especially those channelled through recipient-based CSOs, indicate that there are still many missed opportunities for synergising efforts for gender equality in development co-operation and humanitarian assistance. The above-mentioned factors, and more, underline the importance of identifying the most efficient and appropriate channels and modalities for funding WROs so that they can continue to do critical work globally.

3.4. Sexual and reproductive health and rights

Sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) are fundamental to achieve gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls. Only when people have the possibility to decide over their own bodies and lives, with access to comprehensive sexuality education and healthcare, will they be able to realise opportunities and contribute fully to society.

2024 marks the 30th anniversary of the Programme of Action of the International Conference on Population and Development. However, pervasive challenges and deficits in SRHR continue. While most men have complete bodily autonomy, only 56% of married or in-union women aged 15-49 make their own choices regarding sexual relations, contraceptive use and reproductive healthcare, and maternal mortality remains unacceptably high. Nearly nine in ten deaths due to complications related to pregnancy, childbirth and unsafe abortion occur in sub-Saharan Africa and Central and Southern Asia (UN Women and United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs, 2023^[1]).

Recent years have seen increased attempts to reverse progress on SRHR. The broad movement of actors leading this opposition is known as the “anti-rights” or “anti-gender” movement, reflecting the fact that it is transnational, well-financed and increasingly co-ordinated (Denkovski, Bernarding and Lunz, 2021^[62]). Opposition to SRHR often goes hand-in-hand with broader democratic issues of restrictions on freedom of expression, freedom of the press and the right to organise (Roggeband and Krizsán, 2020^[63]).

While support with “reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health” objectives is overall increasing, aid to reproductive health is decreasing

A DAC policy marker for reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health (RMNCH) was introduced in 2012. The marker is intended to capture activities on the “continuum of care” life-cycle approach and includes funding for a broad range of issues in this area, such as integrated service delivery for women and children from reproductive health to pre-pregnancy, delivery, the immediate postnatal period, and childhood.

While not all DAC members apply the RMNCH policy marker in their reporting to the OECD to the same extent that they use the gender equality policy marker, reporting has improved over the years. Currently 88% of bilateral allocable ODA (USD 132 billion) are screened against the RMNCH policy marker, allowing for a reasonably good overview of funding with RMNCH as a policy objective. However, reporting by DAC members on this policy marker can further improve to allow for full transparency.⁵

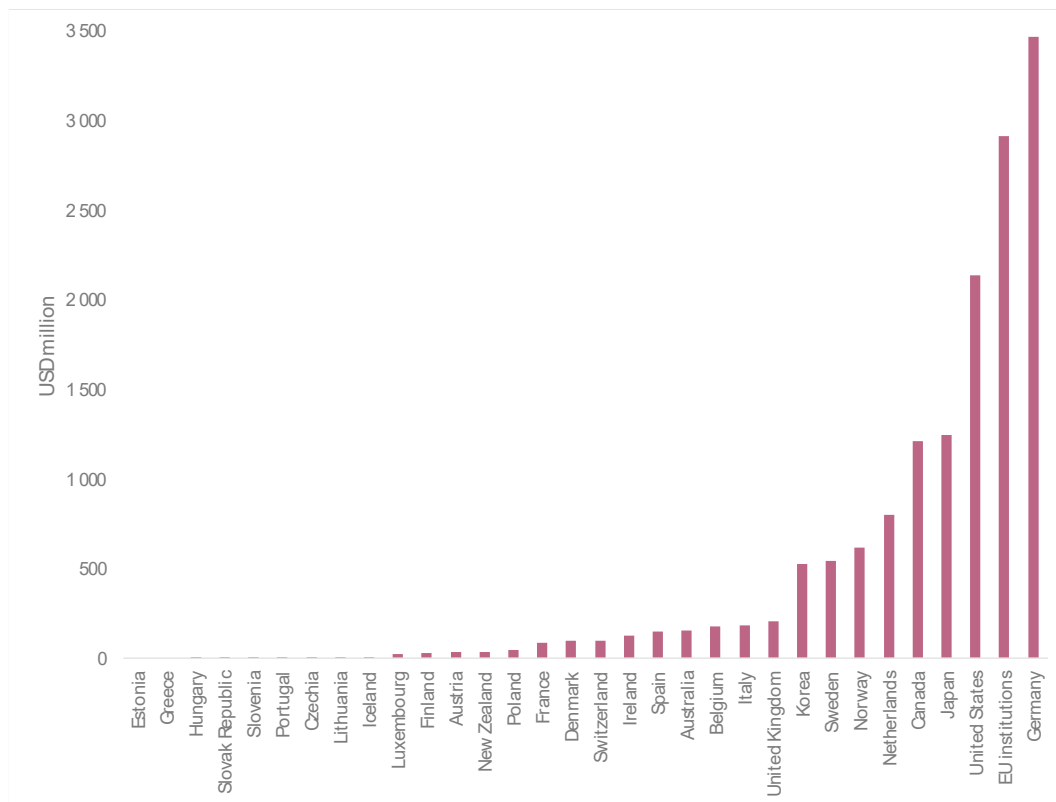
Of DAC ODA examined against the RMNCH policy marker, USD 14.7 billion included policy objectives relating to RMNCH in 2021-22. Approximately one-third of this, USD 4.9 billion, was dedicated to RMNCH as the principal objective. It is important to note that these funds are not additional to ODA with gender equality objectives analysed throughout this report, but for a large majority *also* include gender equality objectives. This is unsurprising given that gender equality and RMNCH are closely linked, and these policy objectives often align with and complement each other.

The USD 14.7 billion represent an increase in the volume of ODA with RMNCH objectives, from USD 11.9 billion on average in 2019-20. The share of ODA including RMNCH objectives also increased, from 10% in 2019-20 to 11% in 2021-22. This increase corresponds to 18 DAC members increasing the volumes of their ODA with RMNCH objectives overall, from 2019-20 to 2021-22. The additional funds with RMNCH objectives were largely committed in the area of COVID-19 control. On the contrary, support in the areas of reproductive health care and family planning declined from 2019-20 to 2021-22.

Germany was the largest donor for programmes with RMNCH objectives in 2021-22 (USD 3.5 billion on average per year), providing support, for example, for strengthening health systems, with a focus on reproductive health in several countries in sub-Saharan Africa (Figure 3.10). EU institutions

(USD 2.9 billion) and the United States (USD 2.1 billion) also provided large volumes of aid with RMNCH objectives.

Figure 3.10. Volume of official development assistance with reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health objectives, DAC members, 2021-22 averages



Note: These funds are not additional to official development assistance with gender equality objectives. A vast majority also includes gender equality objectives.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/e3ts8c>

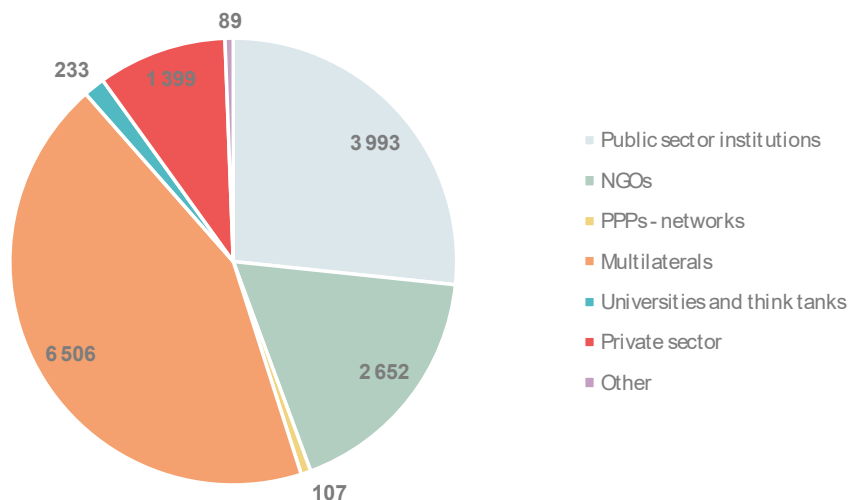
ODA with reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health objectives is mainly channelled through multilateral organisations

DAC members channelled large parts of their ODA with RMNCH objectives through multilateral organisations (Figure 3.11). This includes funds channelled through the Global Financing Facility for Women, Children and Adolescents, a partnership hosted at the World Bank that aims to reduce poverty and inequity by advancing the health and rights of women, children and adolescents. It also includes programmes channelled through United Nations Population Fund to reduce maternal mortality, eliminate female genital mutilation or strengthen health services with a focus on reproductive health.

Much of the aid with RMNCH objectives is also channelled via public sector institutions, including programmes aimed at strengthening countries' health systems, or support for health services tailored to the needs of survivors of sexual and gender-based violence.

Figure 3.11. Volume of official development assistance with reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health objectives per channel of delivery, DAC members, 2021-22 averages

USD million



Note: NGO: non-governmental organisation; PPP: public-private partnership.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/8bsqwf>

ODA with reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health objectives goes mostly to health-related sectors

Not surprisingly, a large part of ODA with RMNCH objectives was reported in the health sector, including in the areas of COVID-19 control, health policy and administrative management, and basic healthcare. In particular, the area of COVID-19 control drove much of the overall increase of aid with RMNCH objectives from 2019-20 to 2021-22.

In addition, much of the funding with RMNCH objectives was reported in the sector of population programmes/policies and reproductive health. The multi-sector, humanitarian aid, and government and civil society sectors also all received substantial amounts of aid with RMNCH objectives.

ODA to the population and reproductive health sector is decreasing

Beyond the RMNCH policy marker, the OECD database includes a sector dedicated to population programmes/policies and reproductive health. This sector is intended to capture programmes on population policy and administrative management, reproductive healthcare, family planning, and sexually transmitted diseases (STD) control including HIV/AIDS, thus partly aligning with the focus of the RMNCH Policy Marker.

Overall, a total of USD 7.4 billion of bilateral ODA was reported in the sector of population programmes/policies and reproductive health on average per year in 2021-22. This represents a decrease from USD 8 billion in 2019-20, explained by the drop in the specific areas of reproductive health care and family planning, from USD 2.5 billion in 2019-20 to USD 1.9 billion in 2021-22.

The bulk of funding in this sector – USD 5.1 billion – was committed to STD control including HIV/AIDS programmes. Such programmes include, for example, efforts to sustain HIV epidemic response and control, HIV clinical services, and efforts to develop next-generation HIV vaccines. It is noteworthy that of these USD 5.1 billion for STD control including HIV/AIDS, very little includes RMNCH objectives (only 7%) or gender equality objectives (only 27%). This low focus on gender equality and RMNCH represents a missed opportunity to ensure gender-equal HIV epidemic response and control.

3.5. Funding to address inequalities at the intersection of gender

In addition to gender inequalities, many women and girls face additional compounding dimensions of vulnerability and discrimination. These can be related, for example, to race, ethnicity and national origin; minority or indigenous status; faith/religion; socio-economic status; education level; class; caste; geographic location; age; ability; sexual orientation; gender identity and sex characteristics; or migration status. An OECD study found that most DAC members consider these inequalities in their policy and strategic framework documents in the context of their work in support of gender equality (OECD, 2024^[64]).

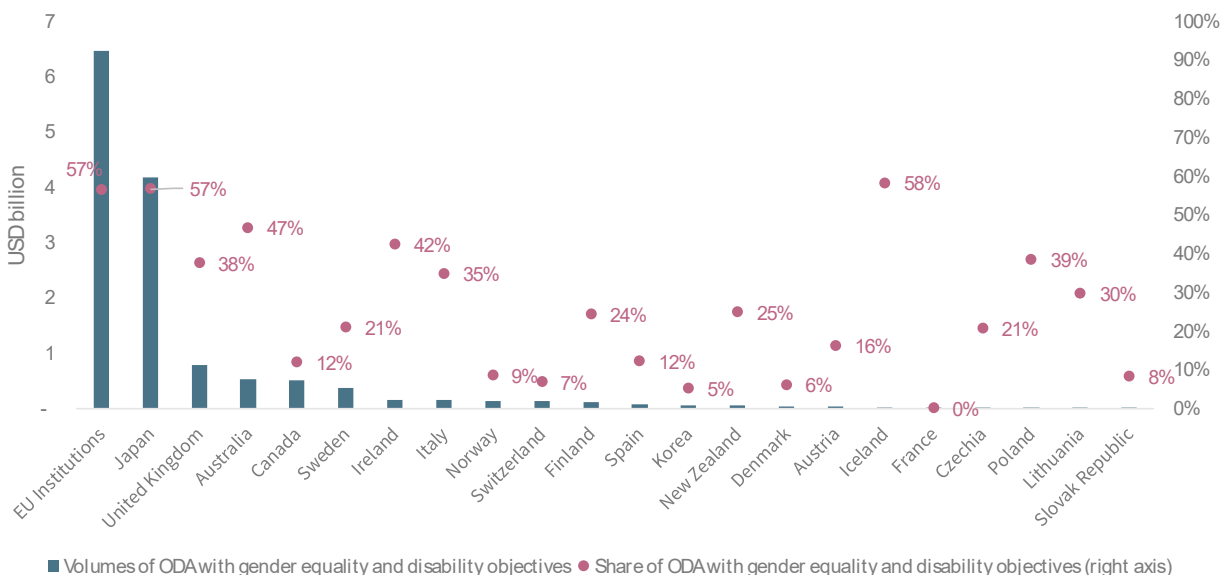
There is limited information on funding at the intersection of gender and disability

Compounding inequalities that intersect with gender position the women who also face these forms of discrimination as the most disadvantaged in their society across the globe. The status of women and girls with disabilities is not only worse than that of their male peers, but also worse than that of women without disabilities. Women with disabilities are at least two to three times more likely than other women to experience violence, including by family, intimate partners, caregivers and institutional facilities (OECD, 2024^[64]).

Data on funding for the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, based on the DAC policy marker dedicated to this theme, can be crossed with the data on funding for gender equality to allow for an understanding of DAC members' support of the intersection of gender and disability. However, the use of the disability policy marker is optional for DAC members and only 22 members examine either some or all of their aid against this marker. This implies that less than half (only 42%) of total allocable bilateral ODA by DAC members is examined against the disability policy marker and that the disability focus of most bilateral allocable aid is unknown.

Of the DAC members that reported against the disability policy marker for 2021-22, Iceland, Japan, the European Union, Australia and Ireland have the highest shares of aid with gender equality objectives that *also* targets the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities (Figure 3.12). The EU institutions and Japan provided particularly large volumes of aid integrating both policy objectives, with the European Union providing more than USD 6 billion on average per year and Japan more than USD 4 billion.

Figure 3.12. Volumes and shares of aid with gender equality objectives that also address the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, 2021-22 averages



Note: Includes the 22 DAC members that report on the DAC policy marker for the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities.

Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/djmtkw>

It is important that more DAC members report against the DAC disability policy marker to gain a more complete picture of funding flows for this issue and allow for more in-depth analysis of support at the intersection of gender equality and disability.

A few other initiatives have used OECD data to develop analyses crossing the DAC gender and disability markers, including Sightsavers (Sightsavers, 2024^[65]) and CBM (CBM Australia, 2022^[66]).

Some information can be gleaned about DAC funding at the intersection of gender and sexual orientation and identity

Many DAC members work to protect and safeguard the rights of individuals discriminated against on the basis of sexual orientation, gender identity, expression and sex characteristics. This implies extending the same rights to lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer, intersex, asexual and gender-diverse (LGBTQIA+) persons as those set out in international human rights standards (OECD, 2024^[64]). In many countries, however, discriminatory laws criminalise private, consensual same-sex intimacy, exposing millions to the risk of arrest, prosecution and imprisonment, or even the death penalty (OHCHR, 2024^[67]).

Work on LGBTQIA+ rights specifically, however, does not automatically address the lack of rights experienced by many women. On the contrary, the conceptualisation of LGBTQIA+ rights has traditionally not effectively incorporated fundamental areas of women's rights, such as women's (lack of) property and inheritance rights or their freedom of movement. Conversely, women's rights are often not conceptualised as including LGBTQIA+ rights, for instance by excluding forced marriage of lesbian women as part of a broader narrative on forced marriage (OECD, 2024^[64]).

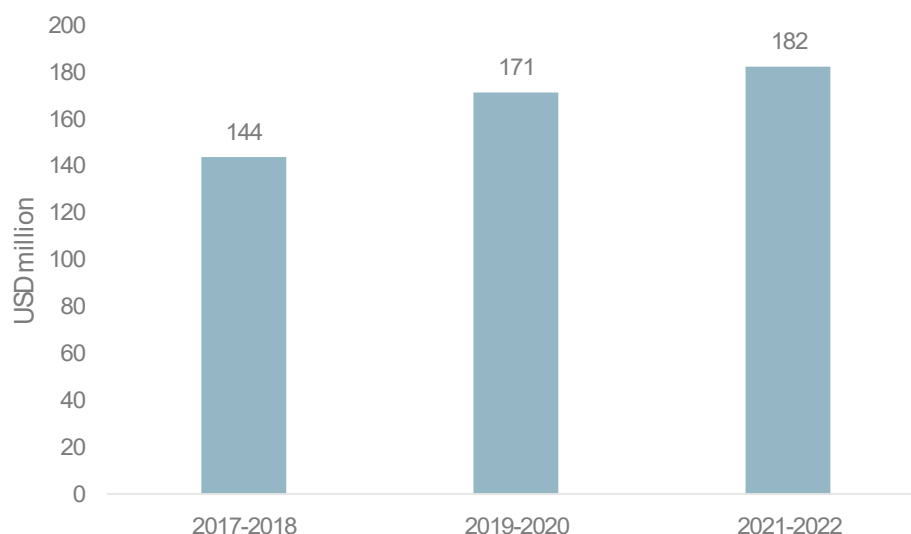
There is no dedicated DAC policy marker or CRS purpose code to track funding for LGBTQIA+ inclusion and rights. Therefore, a word search of programme descriptions reported in the CRS was instead

undertaken as a one-off exercise with a view to gaining an understanding of DAC members' support for these issues. While this methodology is not as robust as using data reported against a DAC policy marker and/or CRS purpose code, it allows gaining a basic idea of funding flows. It should be noted that this report does not argue for the creation of a DAC policy marker or purpose code. One essential limitation to this methodology is that DAC members reporting their programmes may have opted to omit their policy focus on LGTBQIA+ issues, either as an oversight or as a strategic choice given the political and legal sensitivity of these issues in many contexts, to avoid exposing their partners.

Overall, the amounts of ODA with LGTBQIA+ inclusion and rights objectives included in programme descriptions reported by DAC members to the CRS seem to increase slightly over time, standing at USD 182 million on average per year in 2021-22 (Figure 3.13).

Figure 3.13. Volume of bilateral allocable official development assistance where LGTBQIA+ inclusion and rights objectives are included in programme descriptions, DAC members, 2017-22

Two-year averages

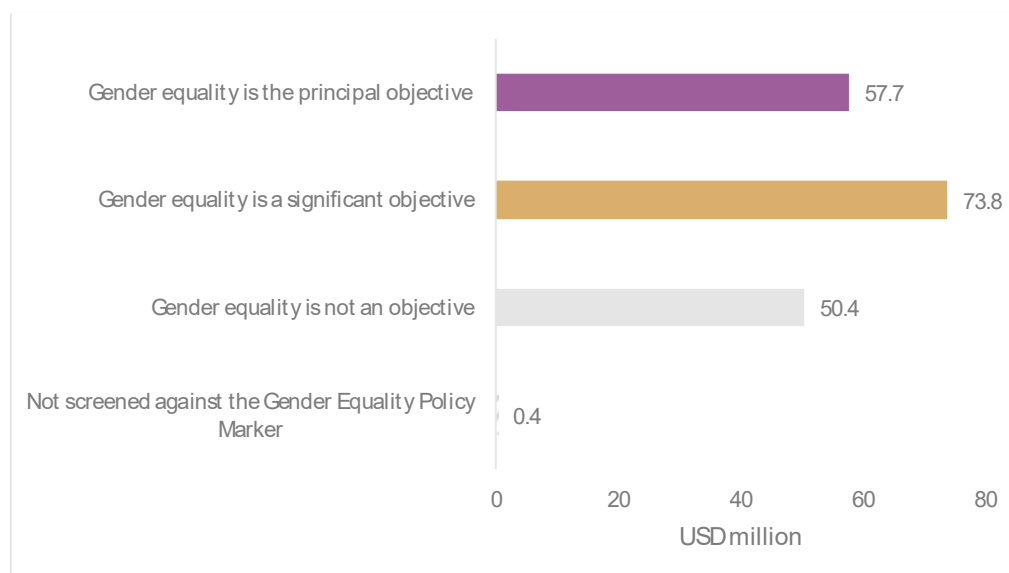


Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/w5jvq4>

It is interesting to note that, in 2021-22, only about two-thirds of ODA with LGTBQIA+ objectives included in their descriptions, as reported to the CRS, were reported as also including gender equality objectives (USD 131.5 billion out of USD 182.4 billion) (Figure 3.14). This implies that one-third of these funds was reported as not having any gender equality objectives, pointing to a potential reporting issue.

Figure 3.14. Volume of official development assistance with LGBTQIA+ objectives included in their descriptions, per inclusion of gender equality objectives, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[13]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/dpcer1>

The Global Philanthropy Project publishes a report every two years which provides data on the distribution of LGBTQIA+ funding by geography, issue, strategy, population focus and type of donor, offering a tool for identifying trends and gaps (Global Philanthropy Project, 2024^[68]).

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Notes

¹ For an exhaustive list of contexts experiencing fragility, see *States of Fragility 2022* (<https://doi.org/10.1787/c7fedf5e-en>). The forthcoming *States of Fragility 2025* will likely include updates to the conceptual classification of contexts experiencing fragility and conflict.

² Fragility is a combination of exposure to risk and insufficient coping capacity of the state, system and/or communities to manage, absorb or mitigate those risks. Fragility can lead to negative outcomes, including

violence, the breakdown of institutions, displacement, humanitarian crises or other emergencies. See *States of Fragility 2022* (<https://doi.org/10.1787/c7fedf5e-en>).

³ Electricity, automated transportation and information technology are essential to economic development. They are also basic features of modern society, and thus energy sources and systems that meet these needs reliably and affordably can be considered as “modern”. See: (<https://www.un.org/en/chronicle/article/goal-7-ensure-access-affordable-reliable-sustainable-and-modern-energy-all>).

⁴ While these data are the basis for the analysis in this section, some support channelled through these local actors is reported in other sectors and not captured here. For example, a project aimed to address sexual and gender-based violence in the West Bank and Gaza Strip was reported under civilian peacebuilding, conflict prevention and resolution, despite being centred on capacity strengthening between Palestinian feminist organisations. Another example includes the Equality Fund, funded by Canada, which aims to create sustainable and predictable grant funding for WROs in ODA-eligible countries through different grant-making streams. In 2021, some funding for the Equality Fund was reported under the code human rights or democratic participation and civil society. As such, support for these valuable initiatives for WROs will not necessarily show up in the OECD database as funding for the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of WROs. The OECD is currently exploring ways of strengthening the tracking of the extent to which those funds are committed to and through WROs.

⁵ Other well-recognised initiatives exist which are aimed at monitoring and analysing global funding in support of SRHR, notably the “Muskoka 2 Methodology”, developed by the London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine. This approach uses OECD data and applies imputed percentages to different sector codes to monitor funding for SRHR, family planning and RMNCH, respectively. See: <https://datacompass.lshtm.ac.uk/id/eprint/1526> and [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/langlo/article/PIIS2214-109X\(20\)30005-X/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/langlo/article/PIIS2214-109X(20)30005-X/fulltext). This report, however, bases its analysis on the DAC policy marker for RMNCH and argues for the strengthened use of the policy marker as a more straightforward and robust tool to monitor funding for SRHR.

4 Development finance for gender equality by actors beyond the DAC

This chapter explores international development finance for gender equality by development actors beyond the DAC, including multilateral organisations and development banks, non-DAC countries, and the private sector. It proposes the OECD-DAC gender equality policy marker as a system for global reporting of development finance for gender equality, but reporting against it needs to be improved for a more comprehensive overview.

Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members are the main source of development finance for gender equality for which information is available (see Chapters 2 and 3). However, other development actors also provide development funding to advance gender equality, representing an enormous potential to ensure sufficient financial support in this area.

This chapter presents and discusses development finance with gender equality objectives from development actors beyond the DAC, based on data reported to the OECD. It argues that a common global system for reporting development finance for gender equality would increase transparency and enable a more complete picture of how much global development finance is effectively available for gender equality, and could strengthen collective accountability. The OECD-DAC gender equality policy marker is well placed to do that, but reporting against the DAC marker needs to be improved by actors beyond the DAC.

4.1. Outflows from multilateral organisations and development banks

Little is known about the gender equality focus of multilateral outflows

The multilateral system is a significant and growing player in development co-operation. Between 2012 and 2020, development outflows from the World Bank Group and other multilateral development banks rose substantially (OECD, 2024^[1]). Multilateral organisations and banks also play a major role in supporting gender equality and women's empowerment in partner countries. For example, the World Bank Group's commitment to gender equality in its programmes has become broader and more ambitious over the past decade (Kucey et al., 2023^[2]). It recently finalised its Gender Strategy for the period 2024-2030, which sets to end gender-based violence and elevate human capital, expand and enable economic opportunities, and engage women as leaders (World Bank Group, 2024^[3]).

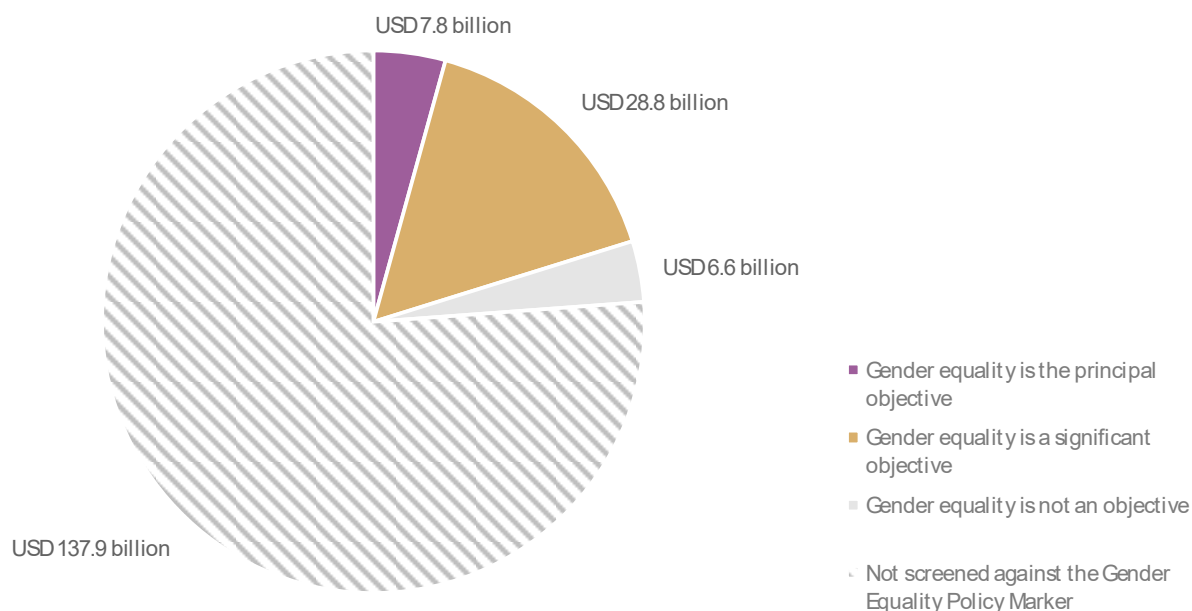
Some multilateral organisations and banks report their development outflows to the OECD. These are largely the funds that they have received as core funding from DAC members and other donor countries. Some (30) also screen and report the extent to which these outflows include gender equality objectives, using the DAC gender equality policy marker. However, several others do not screen their outflows against the gender equality policy marker when they report, and current levels of reporting are insufficient to provide a reliable and complete picture of multilateral outflows for gender equality.

It is positive that there are efforts underway, such as the United Nations (UN) system's gender equality marker which is meant to track finance for gender equality from UN system entities and to facilitate their reporting to the OECD (Box 4.1). There is currently, however, no single or streamlined system used by multilateral organisations and banks to track and make publicly available information on their financial outflows with gender equality objectives. This means that there is no way of exploring and comparing to what extent they use the core funding that they receive from DAC members for the purpose of advancing gender equality. For example, the World Bank has a Gender Tag system to track the number of operations that include interventions and results designed to address and measure gender gaps. However, it does not allow for estimating financial commitments related to gender equality.¹ DAC members are committed to encouraging multilateral organisations and other actors to report financing using the DAC gender equality policy marker or a system common to, or comparable to, the DAC gender equality policy marker (OECD, 2024^[4]).

Looking at the data reported to the OECD, multilateral organisations and banks committed USD 181 billion in total development outflows on average per year in 2021-22. However, the vast majority of these outflows, USD 137.9 billion, were not screened against the gender equality policy marker (Figure 4.1). This means that the gender equality focus of these USD 137.9 billion is unknown, representing a missed opportunity for transparency and for understanding the global landscape of multilateral development outflows for gender equality.

Of the USD 43.1 billion of multilateral outflows that were screened and reported against the DAC gender equality policy marker, USD 36.6 billion had gender equality objectives, either as a principal (USD 7.8 billion) or as a significant objective (USD 28.8 billion) on average per year in 2021-22.

Figure 4.1. Volume of development outflows from multilateral organisations and banks per gender equality focus, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/xqn8m0>

Multilateral outflows are broken down in the same way as for DAC members: some qualify as “concessional” – equivalent to official development assistance (ODA) in nature – others do not. From the USD 181 billion of development outflows reported to the OECD, **concessional** flows represented USD 62 billion on average per year in 2021-22. Only USD 9.4 billion of these were screened against the gender equality policy marker and, of the flows screened, USD 7.8 billion included gender equality objectives on average per year.

Non-concessional outflows by multilateral organisations reported to the OECD amounted to a total of USD 119 billion on average per year in 2021-22. Of this, only USD 33.6 billion were screened against the gender marker. Of the multilateral non-concessional outflows screened, USD 28.7 billion included gender equality objectives.

Box 4.1. The United Nations System-Wide gender equality marker will help provide a more complete picture of development funding for gender equality in the future

The 2023 Data Standards for United Nations (UN) System-Wide reporting of financial data introduced a common UN methodology and format for tracking the contribution of UN activities to gender equality and the empowerment of women. It defines the way UN financial information (budget and expenditures) must be reported at activity level against a gender equality marker (UN GEM). The standard is a performance indicator in the United Nations System-Wide Action Plan on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and is also meant to ensure that UN entities report to the OECD in a similar manner on their support to achieving gender equality.

The UN gender equality marker was approved on 1 January 2023 with a transition period until 31 December 2025, making it mandatory for UN organisations as of 1 January 2026. It applies to 69 UN system entities.

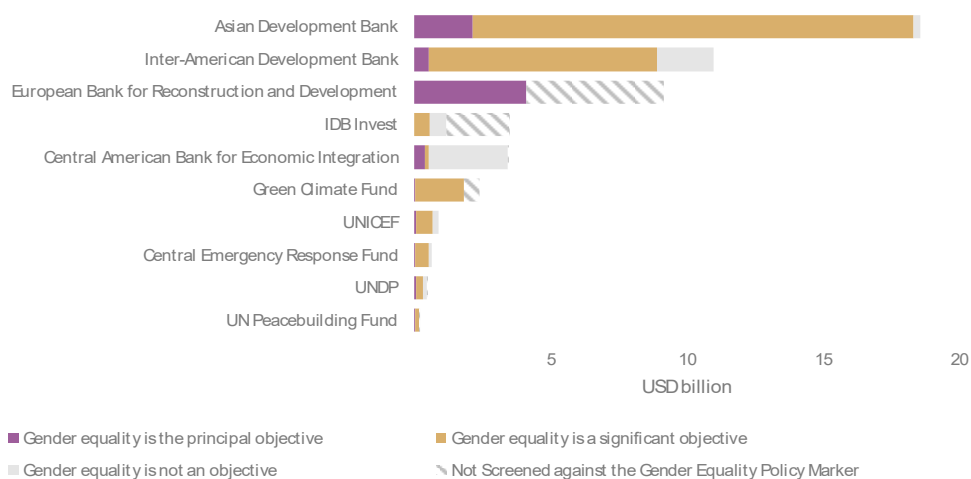
Source: United Nations Sustainable Development Group (2023^[6]), *Data Standards for United Nations System-Wide Reporting of Financial Data*, https://unsdg.un.org/sites/default/files/2023-07/Data%20Standards%20for%20UN%20System%20Wide%20reporting%20of%20financial%20data_2023_Final_0.pdf.

Several multilateral organisations are using the DAC gender equality policy marker

Thirty multilateral organisations and banks reported at least some of their finance against the DAC gender equality policy marker when reporting their development outflows to the OECD in 2021-22 (Figure 4.2). The largest multilateral donors of funding with gender equality objectives on average per year in 2021-22 as reported to the OECD were the Asian Development Bank (ADB) with USD 18.3 billion, the Inter-American Development Bank with USD 8.9 billion, and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development with USD 4.1 billion. Almost all (99%) outflows from the ADB and 81% of those from the Inter-American Development Bank include gender equality objectives, indicating that gender equality is a clear policy priority for these banks (Box 4.2).

Other multilateral organisations and banks, including the largest providers of multilateral development outflows, did not screen their funding against the gender equality policy marker when reporting their outflows to the OECD. If multilateral organisations and banks integrated gender equality into their finance and used the DAC gender equality policy marker or a similar common tracking system to report on it, a better picture could be drawn of the global state of finance for gender equality.

Figure 4.2. Volumes by the ten largest multilateral funders for gender equality, concessional and non-concessional outflows, as reported against the DAC gender equality policy marker, 2021-22 averages



Note: UNICEF: United Nations Children's Fund; UNDP: United Nations Development Programme.

Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/swikty>

Box 4.2. Investing in gender equality and women's empowerment in operations by the Asian Development Bank

Promoting gender equality and women's empowerment is an operational priority of the Asian Development Bank (ADB), which is underpinned by an institutional architecture to ensure that commitments translate into investments in gender equality. As part of the ADB's Strategy 2030's Operational Plan for Priority 2: Accelerating Progress in Gender Equality 2019-2024, the ADB committed to a target of 55% of the ADB's sovereign and non-sovereign operations mainstreaming gender.¹ Over 2021-2023, this target was significantly overachieved: 88% (3-year average) of the ADB's operations were gender mainstreamed.² The ADB also maintains a corporate target of 80% for the share of completed operations delivering the intended gender equality results.

The ADB pursues a two-pronged investment approach to gender equality: gender mainstreaming across all sectors and gender-focused projects. Gender mainstreaming across all sectors entails integrating ambitious gender performance indicators which are grounded in gender analysis for each project and cover a range of areas such as job creation, women's leadership and voice, and resilience, among others. The majority of the ADB's investments to date have applied this gender mainstreaming approach, which allows the ADB to leverage a sector-specific loan to integrate gender equality targets. Technical assistance grants are often combined with the loan to enhance gender results, promote innovation and strengthen knowledge. Gender-focused investments, which also include technical assistance programmes, provide dedicated support on areas such as gender-based violence (GBV), gender-responsive fiscal policy reform and women's entrepreneurship.

The Asian Development Fund's (ADF) Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 5 thematic window has been an important innovation for ADB investments. Representing 20% of the thematic window (under the current ADF 14 cycle, this equates to approximately USD 190 million), grants are only available for the ADB's most vulnerable economies to promote social norm approaches to address complex areas of gender equality in line with SDG 5, such as GBV, sexual and reproductive health and rights, unpaid care, and domestic work.

In Palau, for example, an ADF grant is supporting a multidisciplinary GBV prevention and a social norm change programme, which includes a strong intersectional lens targeting women with disabilities and older women. It will train frontline workers, develop new tools and guidance, and work closely with community-based women's organisations on GBV case management, including referral pathways (ADB, 2021^[7]). In Pakistan, the Women's Inclusive Finance Development Program aims to strengthen the enabling policy environment for women's entrepreneurship, including through implementation support to the Banking on Equality Law, financial literacy programmes for women, digital technologies and platforms, and facilitating access to finance for up to 2 million women through lending to financial institution partners (ADB, 2023^[8]).

Notes: 1. The ADB's system for project gender categorisation at-entry is guided by the 2021 Guidelines for Gender Mainstreaming Categories of ADB Projects, which involves a four-tier project gender mainstreaming categorisation system, which is applied to all projects. 2. On account of this overperformance, the ADB is deepening the organisation's commitment to gender equality through a more robust and focused approach and methodology, which represents an important evolution in its gender mainstreaming track record. The new methodology will be applicable from 1 January 2025 to all new ADB operations and will see revised corporate targets and baselines.

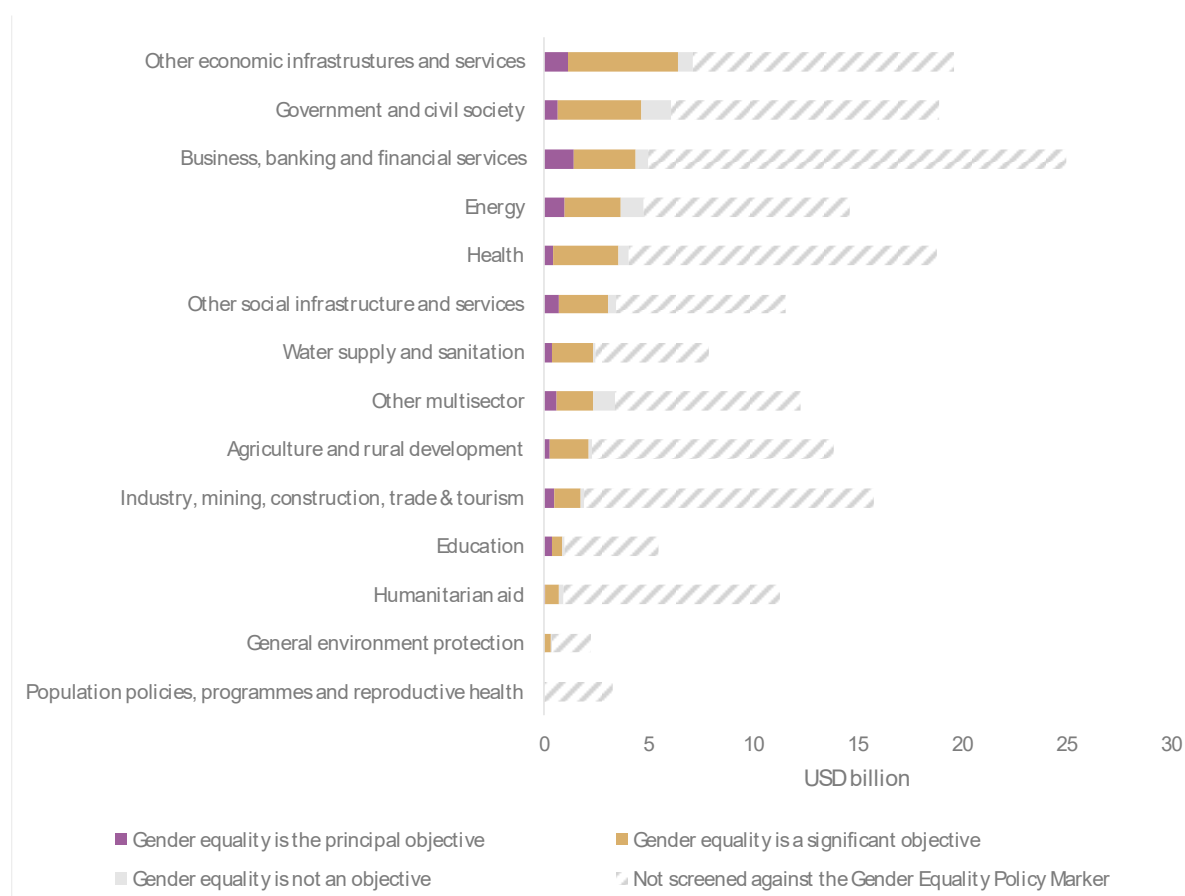
Source: ADB (2019^[9]; n.d.^[10]) <https://www.adb.org/what-we-do/funds/adf>.

Multilateral organisations and banks integrate gender equality objectives into a variety of sectors

Looking at the total outflows from multilateral organisations' and banks' core resources that were reported to the OECD and examined against the DAC gender equality policy marker, it is possible to identify the main sectoral focus of those with gender equality objectives: USD 6.4 billion were committed to "other economic infrastructure and services", which includes support for transport policy, planning and administration, public transport services, road construction, rail transport, information services, media, and information and communication technology (Figure 4.3). An additional USD 4.7 billion were committed to "government and civil society", and USD 4.4 billion to "business, banking and financial services".

However, significant amounts of funding reported to the OECD in these sectors were not examined against the DAC marker. For example, it is striking that in the "business, banking and financial services" sector alone, USD 20 billion reported to the OECD were *not* screened against the DAC marker, meaning that the gender equality focus is unknown. Support in this area can be essential for women's economic empowerment.

Figure 4.3. Volume of multilateral outflows (concessional and non-concessional) by sector and by gender equality policy marker score, 2021-22 averages



Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/cymqud>

4.2. Finance for gender equality from non-DAC countries

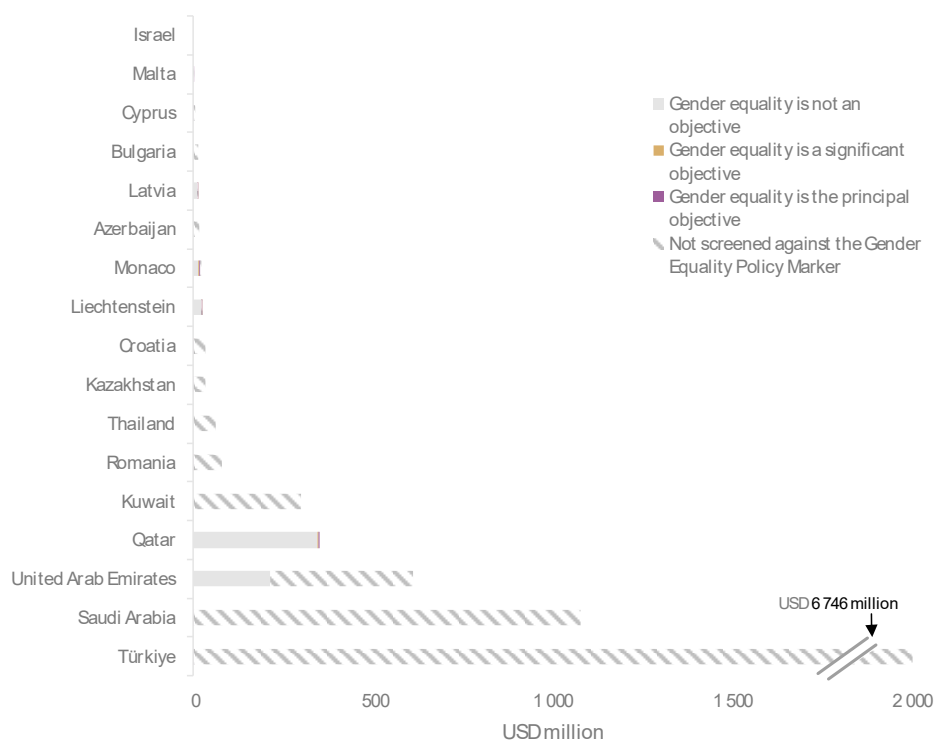
Non-DAC countries are offering valuable support for gender equality through bilateral, triangular or South-South co-operation. Some of these countries report their development finance to the OECD while others instead report to the total official support for sustainable development (TOSSD).

Few non-DAC donor countries apply the DAC gender equality policy marker

Seventeen non-DAC countries reported a total of USD 9.4 billion of ODA to the OECD on average in 2021-22, though only four of them used the DAC gender equality policy marker to screen and report more than half of their funding: Latvia, Liechtenstein, Monaco and Qatar (Figure 4.4). These four countries reported USD 12.5 million of aid with gender equality objectives. The largest volumes of ODA with gender equality objectives were provided by these countries to Ghana and Tajikistan, with over USD 1 million on average per year, followed by Yemen, Madagascar, Burkina Faso, and the West Bank and Gaza Strip.

Of the total of USD 9.4 billion of aid provided by non-DAC countries, Saudi Arabia, Türkiye and the United Arab Emirates together committed USD 8.4 billion, much of which was provided to the Syrian Arab Republic. These countries, however, did not screen their aid against the gender equality policy marker when reporting to the OECD. The extent to which their development co-operation contributes to advancing gender equality remains unanswered.

Figure 4.4. Volume of official development assistance by non-DAC countries, by gender equality policy marker score, 2021-22 averages



Note: The volume for "Türkiye" goes beyond the axis scale, so the bar is broken, and the value is shown in the data label.

Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

A growing number of South-South co-operation providers report to total official support for sustainable development, with high potential to expand reporting on gender equality

TOSSD is a statistical framework agreed upon by a large, diverse group of countries and organisations. It aims to ensure a coherent, comparable, unified system to track SDG-related investments. TOSSD informs development planning and SDG monitoring and helps identify priorities to finance sustainable development.

Eleven South-South co-operation providers that did not report their development finance to the OECD in 2021-22 instead reported a total of USD 165.5 million cross-border flows to TOSSD (Table 4.1). TOSSD is designed to monitor cross-border resources to partner countries, regional and global expenditures in support of international public goods, and mobilised private finance. It captures funding for the SDGs and support for gender equality as defined by SDG 5.

Seven of these providers extended cross-border flows that supported the achievement of SDG 5 solely or with SDG 5 as one among other goals in 2021 and 2022: Brazil, Chile, Costa Rica, the Dominican Republic, Indonesia, Mexico and Peru, adding up to approximately USD 1 million on average per year in 2021-22. These flows were reported to TOSSD only and are additional to those reported to the OECD against the gender equality policy marker. In addition, Uruguay reported non-monetised support for SDG 5.² This leaves significant scope for better aligning South-South and triangular co-operation with SDG 5, drawing on existing good practice such as the examples outlined in Box 4.3.

Table 4.1. Volumes of cross border resource flows reported to TOSSD by South-South co-operation providers, per alignment to SDG5, 2021-22 averages

USD thousand (2022 constant prices)

	Not aligned to SDG 5	Aligned to SDG 5 among other SDGs	Aligned to SDG 5 only
Brazil	107 813.5	105 ^{1,2}	55 ²
Chile	3 293.5 ¹	407.5	52.5
Costa Rica	189.5	11 ²	
Dominican Republic	253 ^{1,2}		16 ²
Ecuador	462 ^{1,2}		
Indonesia	4 600		433 ²
Mexico	39 936.5 ¹	3	Non-monetised support
Nigeria	7 558 ²		
Palestinian Authority	Non-monetised support		
Peru	363 ¹	4 ¹	1 ^{1,2}
Uruguay	Non-monetised support	Non-monetised support	Non-monetised support
Total average	164 469 Plus non-monetised support	530.5 Plus non-monetised support	557.5 Plus non-monetised support

Notes: SDG: Sustainable Development Goal.

1. These providers reported a combination of monetized and non-monetised support to TOSSD. The TOSSD Standard, following the UN initial agreement on the measurement of South-South co-operation (SSC) allows SSC providers to report non-monetised activities, that could take the form of technical co-operation, training, and in-kind donations.

2. This data point was reported in one of the two years (either 2021 or 2022). No data was provided for the other year.

Source: TOSSD (2024^[11]), *TOSSD Data Visualisation Tool*, <https://tossd.online>.

Box 4.3. Triangular co-operation for reproductive health and ending gender-based violence

Triangular co-operation is designed to build inclusive and impactful partnerships, which leverages different stakeholders and their expertise to support sustainable development (OECD/IsDB, 2023^[12]). It can be applied to any development programming, including work to advance gender equality.

Building the evidence base to end gender-based violence in El Salvador

This project aims to develop a knowledge management system to enable the design, implementation and evaluation of evidence-based public policies for reducing gender-based violence – and in particular its extreme manifestation as femicide – in El Salvador.

Nationally, the project aligns forces between the El Salvadoran Ministry of Justice and Public Security, the Institute for the Development of Women, and the El Salvador Agency for International Cooperation.

Internationally, the project triangulates co-operation between the technical co-operation offices of the Spanish Agency for International Cooperation in El Salvador and Peru, and the Peruvian Agency for International Cooperation.

The goal is for the knowledge management system to be built, approved and operational by the institutions involved – including setting up a specialised unit against gender-based violence, particularly femicide, implemented by the Ministry of Justice and Public Security – to reduce gender-based violence.

Promoting family planning with religious leaders in East Asia and Africa

This programme, led by Indonesia, aims to share Indonesia's national experiences and knowledge in implementing and advocating for family planning programmes. The programme is training-oriented, sharing best practices and experiences with local Muslim leaders and faith-based organisations to promote family planning, illustrating its compatibility with Islamic principles.

With learning and advocacy at its core, the programme is facilitated as a triangular co-operation activity in collaboration with the United Nations Population Fund, local Muslim leaders and other participants from more than 20 countries in Asia and Africa – including Afghanistan, Algeria, India, Nepal, Nigeria and Sudan, among others.

The programme, or slightly different iterations of it, has run for more than ten years, and population and family planning programmes are one of the government of Indonesia's priority programmes through the National Family Planning Coordinating Board.

The programme is considered highly successful, primarily because it has gained commitment and support from high-standing religious leaders in the country, who hold large-scale influence and respect in local communities (UNFPA, 2021^[13]).

Source: TOSSD (2024^[11]), TOSSD Data Visualisation Tool, <https://tosssd.online>; AECID (2022^[14]), Cooperación triangular entre Perú, El Salvador y España para institucionalizar un sistema de gestión del conocimiento para la generación de evidencia en materia de violencia feminicida en El Salvador, con base a la experiencia de Perú y España – Fase II, <https://aecid.sv/cooperacion-triangular-entre-peru-el-salvador-y-espana-para-institucionalizar-un-sistema-de-gestion-del-conocimiento-para-la-generacion-de-evidencia-en-materia-de-violencia-feminicida-en-el-salva>; APCI (2023^[15]), Cooperación de España y Perú impulsan la lucha que El Salvador realiza contra la violencia hacia las mujeres, <https://www.gob.pe/institucion/apci/noticias/871350-cooperacion-de-espana-y-peru-impulsan-la-lucha-que-el-salvador-realiza-contr-la-violencia-hacia-las-mujeres>.

4.3. Private sector finance for gender equality

Private cross-border finance offers an important opportunity for investments in gender equality. Gender lens investing is an approach to investing that takes into consideration gender-based factors across the investment process to advance gender equality and better inform investment decisions (GIIN, 2024^[16]).

OECD data include private finance mobilised from the private sector by public interventions (OECD, 2023^[17]). DAC members and multilateral actors report the private finance they help mobilise through their public development finance using a range of leveraging mechanisms, such as syndicated loans, shares in investment vehicles, direct investment in companies and guarantees. To some extent, they also report the gender equality focus of these interventions. In addition, private philanthropies report their cross-border concessional finance with gender equality objectives to the OECD.

Beyond the OECD, initiatives such as the 2X Challenge monitors investments with a gender lens based on a set of agreed criteria. Since its launch in 2018, the 2X Challenge has raised several billions of “gender lens investments” (Box 4.4). Some of the finance captured by 2X corresponds to private finance mobilised, non-concessional development finance or other official flows using the OECD framework and is also reported to the OECD as such (see also Chapters 2 and 3). The 2X criteria have been widely adopted by investors, financial intermediaries and companies as well as other stakeholders to assess and monitor gender lens investments, and are largely seen as the standard for assessing and structuring private investments that provide women with leadership opportunities, quality employment, finance, enterprise support, and products and services that enhance economic participation and access. While the 2X criteria do not correspond to the DAC gender equality policy marker scores, efforts are ongoing to map the 2X criteria to the DAC marker scores to support transparency and facilitate and increase reporting for development actors using both tracking systems, such as bilateral development finance institutions.

Box 4.4. Private sector investments for gender equality: The 2X Challenge

The 2X Challenge, launched at the G7 Summit in Canada in 2018, is a collective effort to mobilise private sector investments that provide women in partner country markets with improved access to leadership opportunities, quality employment, finance, enterprise support, and products and services that enhance economic participation and access. Since its creation, the initiative has raised USD 33.6 billion of what is considered “gender lens investments”.

The 2X Challenge includes development finance institutions from Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members, multilateral finance institutions and private sector investors. Although 2X has its own approach to defining “gender lens investing”, its members have committed to also align their reporting to the OECD-DAC gender equality policy marker. Efforts to map the 2X criteria to the OECD-DAC gender equality policy marker are ongoing and will promote further transparency and accountability in financing for gender equality.

The G7 Leaders’ Summit 2024 in Italy welcomed a new commitment by development and multilateral finance institutions to invest at least USD 20 billion from 2024 to 2027 to advance women’s empowerment. They also called upon other public and private actors to join the 2X Challenge.

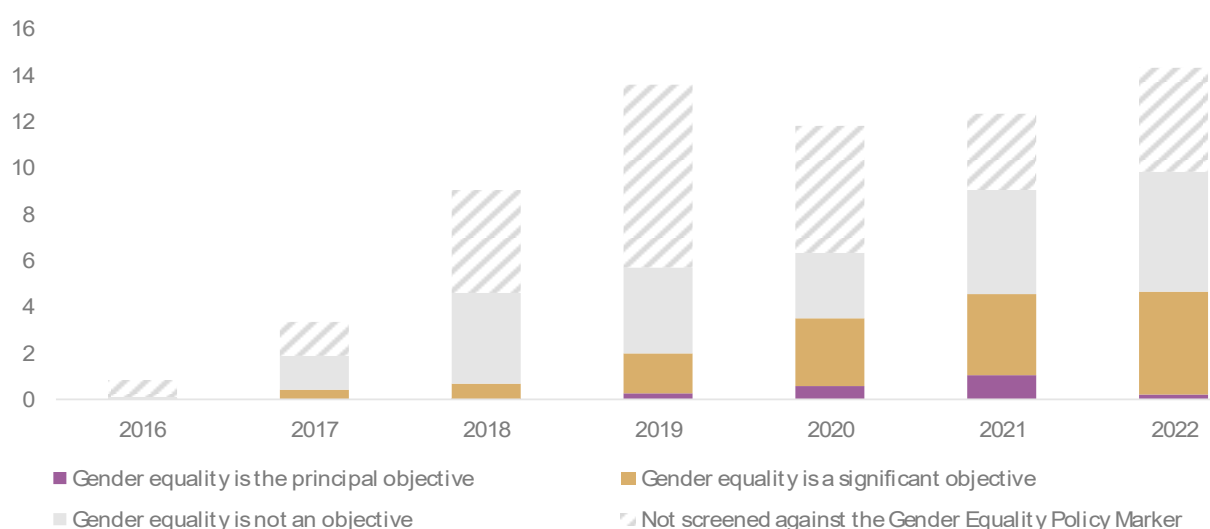
Source: 2X Challenge (2024^[18]), “Invest in women. Invest in the world”, <https://www.2xchallenge.org>; 2X Challenge (2024^[19]), “History”, <https://www.2xchallenge.org/history>.

Gender components can be strengthened for finance mobilised from the private sector by DAC members

Over the last 5 years, 25 of the 32 DAC members have reported to the OECD about their private finance mobilised. In 2022, 21 DAC members reported a total of USD 13.8 billion of private finance mobilised, but only 67% of this was screened against the DAC gender equality policy marker (Figure 4.5).³ Of the USD 9.3 billion screened, **USD 4.6 billion (49%) included gender equality objectives**, either as a significant or a principal objective. The United States mobilised by far the largest volumes of private finance with gender equality objectives in 2022, corresponding to half of the total (USD 2.3 billion). The United Kingdom followed, mobilising USD 1.2 billion of private finance with gender equality objectives in 2022.

DAC members can do more to increase the share of private finance mobilised screened against the marker and strengthen their gender components. They can also incentivise and strengthen the mandates governing their development finance institutions and multilateral development banks to consider gender-related issues in investment strategies.

Figure 4.5. Volumes of private flows mobilised by DAC members, 2016-22



Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9> and <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/q>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/nlw9my>

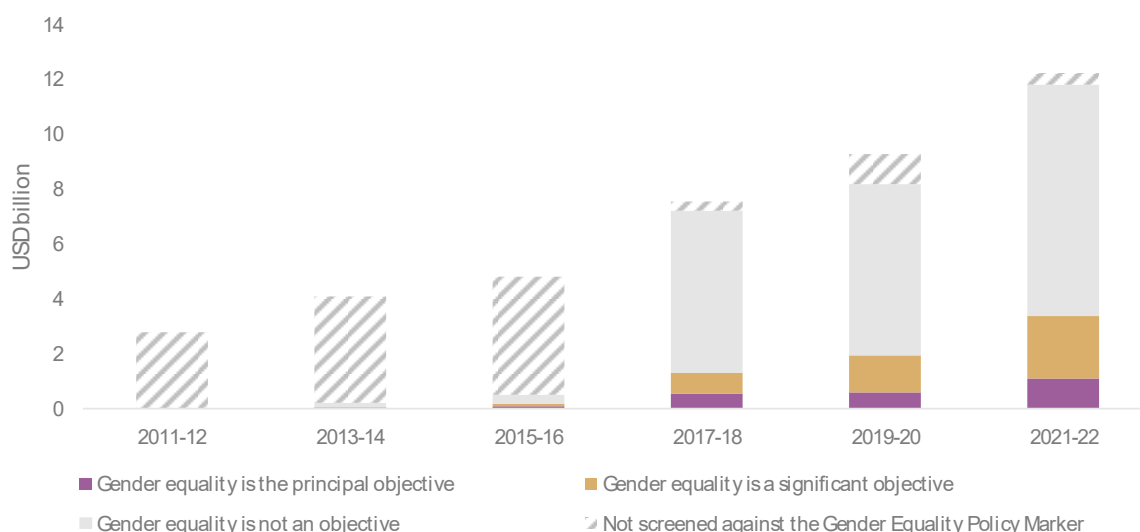
Private philanthropies can further increase their focus on gender equality

Over 40 private foundations report their development flows to the OECD using the DAC gender equality policy marker. This represents a valuable source of finance, even though more foundations could report on their financial flows. Foundations are key drivers of innovative development finance for gender equality, with unique opportunities to play a catalytic role in de-risking investments and attracting increased funds (2024^[20]).

Of a total of USD 12.3 billion that qualify as allocable development flows provided by foundations on average per year over 2021-22, USD 11.9 billion were screened against the gender equality policy marker. Of the USD 11.9 billion, **28% included gender equality objectives, corresponding to USD 3.4 billion** (Figure 4.6). This represents an increase over time of both the volume and share of ODA flows by foundations with gender equality objectives, up from 19% in 2017-18 and 23% in 2019-20. In addition, the share of funding with gender equality as the principal objective, 9%, is significantly higher than that of DAC members, at 4%. At the same time, the total share of funding with gender equality objectives remains low compared to that provided by DAC members.

Figure 4.6. Volume of bilateral allocable development finance by foundations, 2011-22

Two-year averages

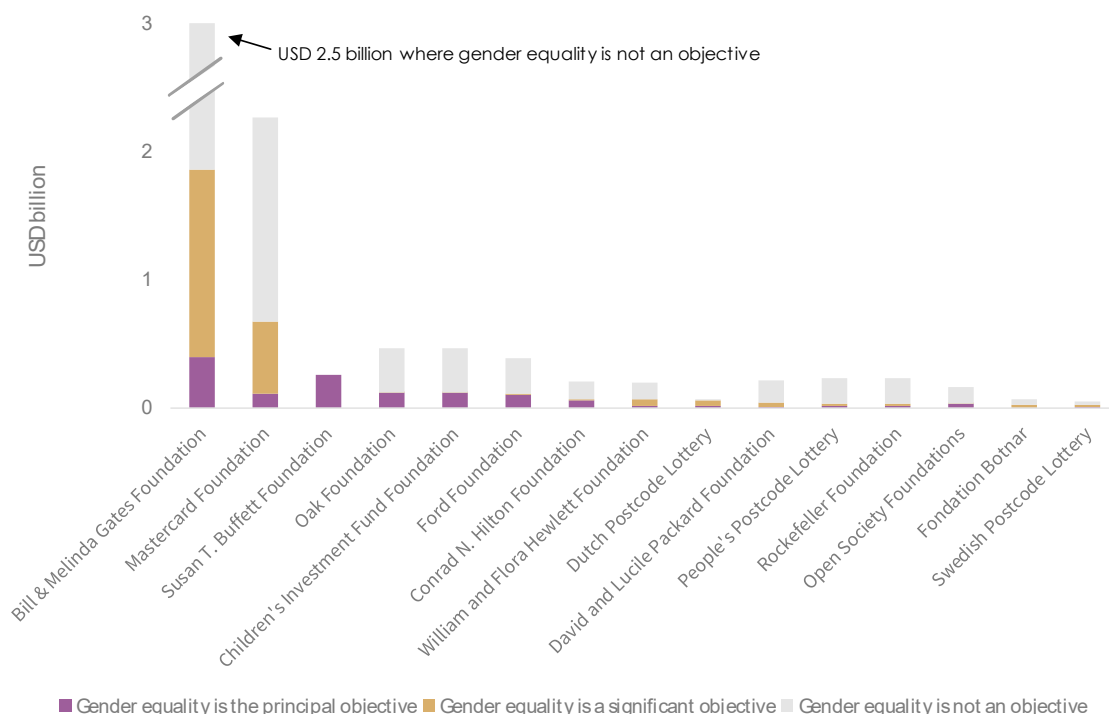


Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/61zirf>

Data shared by many of the largest private philanthropic foundations include information on the DAC gender equality policy marker, such as the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation, the Mastercard Foundation, the Susan T. Buffett Foundation, the Rockefeller Foundation and the Ford Foundation. The Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation remains the largest donor of flows with gender equality objectives by far, followed by the Mastercard Foundation.

Figure 4.7. Volume by the 15 foundations providing the greatest amounts of funding for gender equality, per inclusion of gender equality objectives, 2021-22 averages



Note: The volume for "Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation" goes beyond the axis scale, so the bar is broken, and the value is shown in the data label.

Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

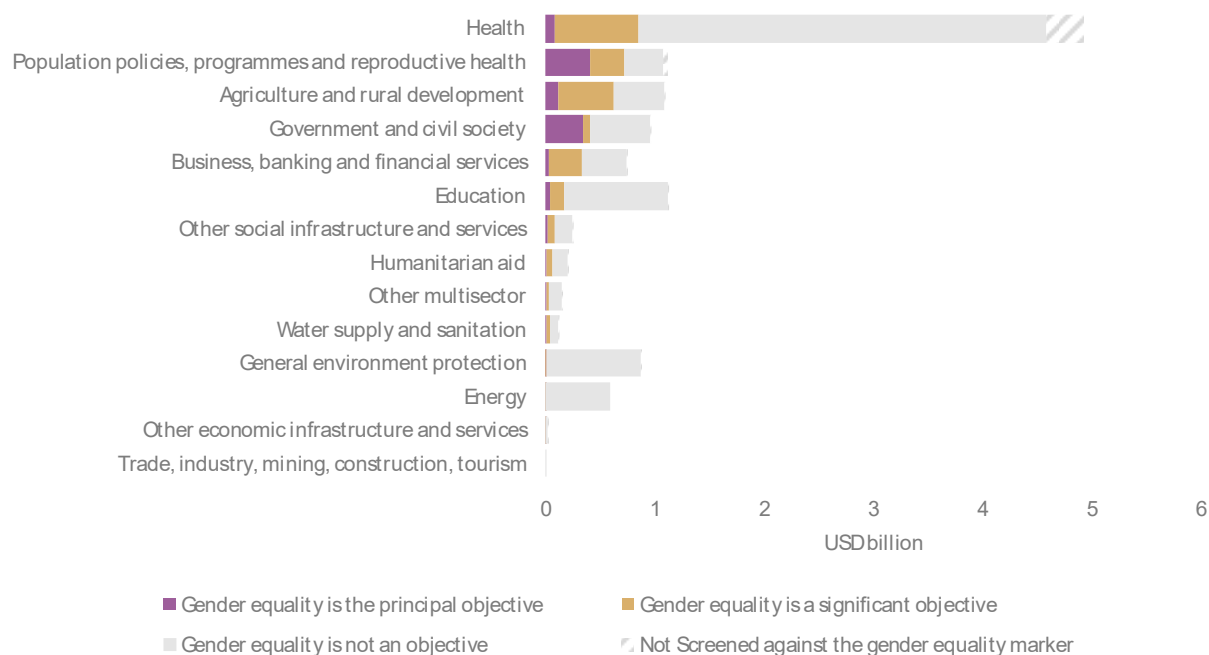
StatLink  <https://stat.link/yIk04s>

Sectoral focus by foundations

Of the USD 3.4 billion of philanthropic funding with gender equality objectives, nearly half was concentrated in the health (USD 860 million on average per year in 2021-22) and population policy/reproductive health (USD 730 million per year) sectors. At the same time, health remains a sector with large volumes committed by private foundations lacking gender equality objectives.

The third-largest sector of funding with gender equality objectives was agriculture and rural development (USD 630 million), followed by government and civil society (USD 406 million). As part of the funding for government and civil society, private foundations provided USD 223 million on average per year to the effectiveness, influence and sustainability of women's rights organisations and feminist movements, with the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation by far the largest philanthropic donor in this area (see also Chapter 3).

Figure 4.8. Volume of philanthropic funding by sector and by gender equality marker score, 2021-22 averages



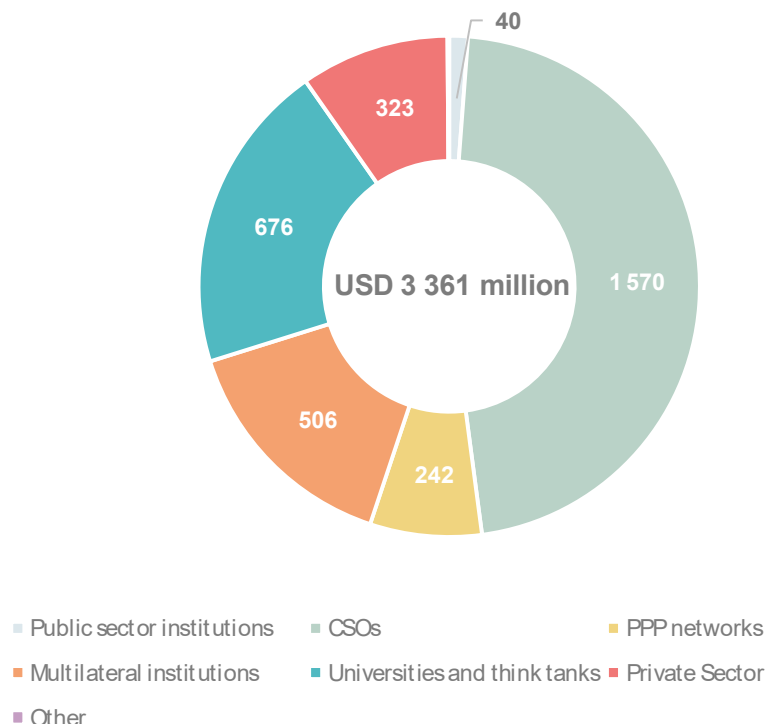
Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/d6i5s7>

Delivery channels used by private foundations

Most of the funding for gender equality provided by private foundations was channelled through civil society organisations based at the international level, in donor countries and in partner countries. A very limited part of funding with gender equality objectives was channelled through public sector institutions.

Figure 4.9. Volume of finance with gender equality objectives by foundations per channel of delivery, 2021-22 averages



Note: CSO: civil society organisation; PPP: public-private partnership. There is only USD 4 million for Other, so it is not visible in the figure.

Source: OECD (2024^[5]), OECD Data Explorer, Creditor Reporting System (Database), <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/a9>.

StatLink  <https://stat.link/wa4thx>

For further analysis of the financial flows with gender equality objectives reported to the OECD CRS by private foundations, see OECD (2024^[20]).

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Notes

¹ Previously, up to 2018 flows, the World Bank reported International Development Association (IDA) flows to the OECD against the gender equality policy marker.

² According to the TOSSD, South-South co-operation providers can report non-monetised support (e.g. technical co-operation, training, in-kind donations). Therefore, a financial analysis on South-South co-operation is not sufficient to see the whole support those providers are giving. Peru and Uruguay reported five and nine non-monetised South-South co-operation activities in TOSSD, respectively.

³ Data for mobilised flows are shown by individual year and not two-year averages because these data are available only in current prices.

5

Conclusions and recommendations

This chapter closes with overarching conclusions and policy recommendations. It also suggests areas for future work.

To ensure that every development intervention contributes to advancing gender equality, gender equality needs to be considered throughout policy frameworks, in design and planning, programming and financing, implementing, monitoring and evaluation, and in development partners' own internal structures and systems. The *2024 DAC Recommendation on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of All Women and Girls in Development Co-operation and Humanitarian Assistance* and the *2022 Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls: DAC Guidance for Development Partners* together set out a comprehensive standard and provide good practice guidance for how to do this.

Financial reporting against a robust system, such as the *OECD Creditor Reporting System* and the DAC gender equality policy marker, enables tracking of efforts for gender equality and the mobilisation of additional finance.

Based on OECD data and the reporting by various development actors, this report estimated that USD 108.4 billion of international development finance included gender equality objectives on average per year in 2021-22, while an additional USD 271.2 billion was available but either lacked a gender equality focus or its focus was not reported. These data also allow highlighting development partners' positive efforts and identifying behaviours and trends that should be changed. For example, it is clear that positive change towards a stronger focus on gender equality by Development Assistance Committee (DAC) members is underway in the energy sector, in particular for energy generation from renewable sources. On the contrary, DAC members need to urgently strengthen efforts to support gender equality in crisis situations.

5.1. DAC members' development finance for gender equality

- The volume of bilateral official development assistance (ODA) with gender equality objectives has increased over time, along with the increase in ODA overall. However, the share of aid with gender equality objectives out of total aid has dropped for the first time after a decade on the rise, from 45% in 2019-20 to 42% in 2021-22. This drop in share happened in several sectors and for 20 of the 32 DAC members. DAC members should reverse this tendency, ensuring that the focus on gender equality takes an upwards turn while at the same time pursuing capacity development on the DAC gender equality policy marker and statistical reporting to ensure robust data.
- Integration of gender equality objectives is particularly low in major aid recipients affected by conflict, showing that DAC responses to recent global crises have paid little attention to gender equality. For example, only 32% of ODA to Afghanistan, 29% to Yemen and 11% to Ukraine integrated gender equality objectives in 2021-22. It is crucial that DAC members maintain a focus on gender equality in their interventions, especially in contexts exposed to fragility and conflict.
- There is no evidence of correlation between the extent that ODA integrates gender equality and levels of gender inequality, meaning that ODA with gender equality objectives is not necessarily going to the countries where inequality is more pronounced. While all development co-operation should have a positive impact on gender equality, this is even more important in ODA for the most unequal countries.
- DAC members are increasingly using multilateral organisations as a channel for bilateral ODA with gender equality objectives, while civil society organisations (CSOs) are used less and less. CSOs based in partner countries generally receive a marginal share of the ODA channelled through CSOs. Even if funds channelled through intermediary development actors can also reach organisations based in partner countries, it is important that DAC members continue supporting CSOs based in partner countries directly, as they hold contextual expertise and are critical to understand and address structural drivers of inequality.
- DAC members have recently started including gender equality objectives in their other official flows but much more can be done. Reporting of these flows can also improve to allow a more

comprehensive picture of how different forms of finance are responsive to gender inequalities and discrimination.

5.2. Thematic focus of bilateral ODA for gender equality

- Gender equality objectives remain unevenly integrated across sectors in ODA by DAC members, with humanitarian aid and aid in the energy sector consistently showing the lowest focus on gender equality. Other social infrastructure and services, education, and agriculture and rural development have the highest focus on gender equality. DAC members can pursue their efforts to increase the focus on gender equality across all sectors, to promote this development objective and, as a minimum, avoid that any development interventions perpetuate inequalities or have unintended harmful consequences on gender equality.
- While humanitarian aid grew over the decade, its gender equality focus shrunk to only 17%. Similarly, the share of aid with gender equality objectives to extremely fragile contexts seems to decrease as the volume of aid increases. The low and decreasing inclusion of gender equality objectives illustrates important and concerning challenges with maintaining commitments to gender equality while responding to urgent crises and humanitarian situations. DAC members need to ensure a focus on gender equality in emergency situations and extremely fragile contexts, where this is especially important. Successes in improving gender equality integration in ODA to the peace and security sector may serve as avenues for learning.
- The gender equality focus of aid in the energy sector has increased significantly over the past decade. Aid to energy generation from renewable sources has increased considerably, so has the integration of gender equality objectives. This suggests a stronger focus on gender equality in new programmes related to clean energy, reflecting the DAC's recognition of the importance of addressing these objectives in tandem. At the same time, the energy sector more broadly remains one of the sectors with the lowest focus on gender equality, at 30%. DAC members can accelerate efforts to support women's empowerment in this sector, learning from those members with high shares of aid integrating gender equality.
- Despite DAC members' recognition of the importance of women's rights organisations and feminist movements, ODA to enhance their effectiveness, influence and sustainability remains low, at around USD 0.5 billion. This represents less than 1% of ODA for gender equality. A few DAC members stand out as consistent and strong supporters. Other DAC members could follow these champions.
- Funding with the policy objective of supporting reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health (RMNCH) has increased. USD 14.7 billion of aid had RMNCH objectives on average per year in 2021-22, an overall increase compared to USD 11.9 billion on average in 2019-20, driven by 18 DAC members. The additional funds with RMNCH objectives were largely committed in the area of COVID-19 control, while support in the areas of reproductive health care and family planning declined from 2019-20 to 2021-22. DAC members should ensure sustained levels of funding for reproductive health and can further strengthen their statistical reporting on RMNCH.
- Compounding inequalities that intersect with gender position the women who also face these forms of discrimination as the most disadvantaged in their society across the globe. It, however, remains challenging to track funding at the intersection of gender and other inequalities. Only 22 DAC members examine either some or all aid against the DAC policy marker for the inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities, meaning that the disability focus of most bilateral aid is unknown. It is important for more DAC members to report against this DAC policy marker, to gain a more complete picture of funding flows and allow for more in-depth analysis of support at the intersection of gender equality and disability.

5.3. Development finance for gender equality by actors beyond the DAC

- Multilateral organisations and banks play a major role in supporting gender equality and women's empowerment in partner countries. It is positive that the United Nations system has adopted a gender equality policy marker, which can be translated into the DAC marker system, to monitor its development outflows. This will allow for increased transparency and accountability for gender equality as financial information becomes available.
- Other multilateral organisations and development banks could helpfully use a common framework for monitoring their development outflows for gender equality to increase transparency. Given that many these organisations and banks already report their development finance to the OECD, they could also screen their flows against the DAC gender equality policy marker, following the example of those banks that already do so.
- Several countries that are not members of the DAC report their development finance either to the OECD or to total official support for sustainable development, yet only a few screen their development finance against the gender equality policy marker or Sustainable Development Goal 5. More non-DAC and South-South co-operation providers could screen and report the gender equality focus of their development finance.
- DAC members and multilateral organisations and banks increasingly report the private flows mobilised through development finance. When doing so, they could also better report the gender equality focus of these mobilised flows.
- Private philanthropies that report their development finance to the OECD use the DAC gender equality policy marker. With 28% of their finance including gender equality objectives, mainly in the areas of health and population and reproductive health, these actors could further strengthen their focus on gender equality. In addition, more foundations could report their development funding with gender equality objectives.

5.4. Areas for future work

This report is the first edition of what is intended to become a regular publication on development finance for gender equality. Each edition will have selected focus areas. Future research might address a different selection of sector/themes than those highlighted in this edition or focus more in-depth on one or a few specific partner countries. Should development actors beyond the DAC, such as multilateral organisations and banks, strengthen their reporting to the OECD and the DAC gender equality policy marker, more detailed analysis could be undertaken around their efforts to advance gender equality.

Annex A. Methodological definitions and clarifications

The OECD Creditor Reporting System

The OECD *Creditor Reporting System* (CRS) is an activity database aimed at providing a set of readily available basic data to enable analysis on where aid goes, what purposes it serves and what policies it aims to implement. Data are collected on individual projects and programmes. The focus is on financial data but some descriptive information is also made available.

Data are made publicly available at: <http://data-explorer.oecd.org/s/52>.

How the DAC policy markers work

The Development Assistance Committee (DAC) policy markers are a qualitative statistical tool that enable the examination of development finance and the identification of a specific policy objective as either:

- a principal policy objective (dedicated funding, “score 2”)
- a significant objective (funding that integrates/mainstreams the policy objective, “score 1”)
- not an objective (“score 0”).

Several DAC markers exist: gender equality; aid to environment; democratic and inclusive governance (DIG); reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health (RMNCH); nutrition; disaster risk reduction (DRR); and inclusion and empowerment of persons with disabilities (OECD, 2023^[1]).

The DAC gender equality policy marker: History and coverage

The gender equality policy marker with the 0-1-2 scoring system has existed since 1997. Reporting on the gender equality policy marker is mandatory for DAC members as they report their official development assistance (ODA) to the OECD.

Currently almost all bilateral allocable ODA is “screened” against the gender equality policy marker, meaning that its gender equality focus is established and a marker score is allocated and reported to the OECD accordingly. Analyses in this report use the total screened bilateral allocable ODA as the denominator. It cannot be assumed that aid that has not been screened does or does not include gender equality objectives.

The coverage of other official flows (OOFs) and finance provided by actors other than DAC members screened against the gender equality policy marker is smaller, so shares may be calculated based on total finance, in which case this is indicated in the relevant chart or text.

In general, the OECD uses and analyses the financial data in detail only once the development provider has screened at least half of its flows.

Official development assistance

ODA is government aid that promotes and specifically targets the economic development and welfare of developing countries. ODA has been the main source of financing for development aid since it was adopted by the OECD DAC as the “gold standard” of foreign aid in 1969 (OECD, 2024^[2]). Starting with 2018 data, the new grant-equivalent measure of ODA became the standard for reporting, with the headline ODA figures published on that basis (OECD, 2024^[3]). The ODA grant equivalent is a measure of donor effort. Grants, loans and other flows entering the calculation of the ODA grant equivalent measure are referred to as ODA flows. The OECD is the only official source of reliable, comparable and complete statistics on ODA.

Other official flows

OOF are official sector transactions that do not meet ODA criteria. OOF include grants to developing countries for representational or essentially commercial purposes; official bilateral transactions intended to promote development but which have a grant element of less than 25%; and official bilateral transactions, whatever their grant element, that are primarily export-facilitating in purpose. This category includes, by definition: export credits extended directly to an aid recipient by an official agency or institution (official direct export credits); the net acquisition by governments and central monetary institutions of securities issued by multilateral development banks at market terms; subsidies (grants) to the private sector to soften its credits to developing countries; and funds in support of private investment.

Allocable finance

Analyses in this report refer to allocable finance, based on OECD data up to 2022, in 2022 constant prices, using the DAC *Creditor Reporting System*’s gender equality policy marker (OECD, 2024^[4]).

Finance is considered “allocable” when the development provider defines the policy objective. It includes, for example, aid to and through civil society and aid to specific funds or programmes managed by multilateral organisations. Allocable ODA covers types A02 (sector budget support), B01 (core support to non-governmental organisations), B03 (specific funds managed by international organisations), B04 (pooled funding), C01 (projects), D01 (donor country personnel), D02 (other technical assistance) and E01 (scholarships).

The list of “specific funds managed by international organisations” (B03) includes, for example, the Women’s Peace and Humanitarian Fund and the Rural Women Economic Empowerment Multi-Partner Trust Fund (OECD, 2023^[5]). Contributions by DAC members to one of these funds is reported to and count in the OECD system as bilateral aid using a multilateral channel (“multi-bi” aid). DAC members make the contribution to one of these funds with a clear policy objective in mind, and the gender equality policy marker is applied. This means that all contributions by DAC members to the Women’s Peace and Humanitarian Fund and other funds on this list score either 0, 1 or 2 against the gender equality policy marker and are included in the OECD’s data and analyses on “bilateral aid for gender equality”.

Allocable finance does **not include** core funding to multilateral organisations or general budget support to governments, given that the DAC member does not decide the policy focus of such aid. If a DAC member makes a core contribution to a multilateral organisation/agency – for example the United Nations Children’s Fund, the World Bank, the United Nations Development Programme or UN Women – then that counts as “core funding” to a multilateral organisation. It is not “bilateral allocable” aid because the DAC member does not decide the policy objective – the multilateral organisation/agency does – and the gender equality policy marker cannot be applied by the DAC member. These contributions are not included in the OECD’s data and analyses on “bilateral aid for gender equality”.

Instead, multilateral organisations and banks that receive core funding can themselves report their outflows to the OECD, including the gender equality of these outflows. This means there is no double-counting of development finance for gender equality.

Analyses use commitments, rather than disbursements, and two-year averages

Analyses use commitments, rather than disbursements, to capture intentions for the activity at the design stage and the political vision for the finance provided. Two-year averages are used to reduce volatility since commitments are recorded in full in the year they are made, even if they are multi-year, and irrespective of when they are disbursed. For some analyses, a specific year may need to be used, in which case this is specified in the text.

Calculation of shares

The percentage to show the share of ODA with a gender equality objective is usually calculated based on a denominator of ODA with gender equality policy marker scores 0, 1 and 2, and excludes ODA that was not screened/examined against the marker. This is done because most of DAC members' ODA is screened against the marker. However, for OOFs and finance beyond DAC members, since there is less use of the gender equality policy marker, the denominator used for shares may be the sum of 0, 1, 2 and not screened, but this is then clearly indicated in the chart or text.

Total Official Support for Sustainable Development

Total Official Support for Sustainable Development (TOSSD) is an international standard for measuring the full array of resources to promote the sustainable development of developing countries. It is designed to monitor all official resources flowing into developing countries for their sustainable development, but also private resources mobilised through official means. It also measures contributions to international public goods. The Secretariat is hosted by the OECD.

This report uses the data provided to TOSSD by South-South co-operation providers on their cross-border flows focused or not on Sustainable Development Goal 5. See also: <https://www.tossd.org>.

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Development Finance for Gender Equality 2024

This report offers an unprecedented overview of international development finance, aid and beyond, aimed at advancing gender equality. It analyses the data collected by the OECD to explore trends, uncover details, identify possible drivers, and suggest areas where finance can be better used to support gender equality. A special section presents opportunities to increase the gender equality focus of investments in selected thematic areas. This report comes at a time of stalled progress, even pushback against gender equality and the rights and empowerment of all women and girls in many countries. By painting a fresh picture of the financing available and how it is used, it supports accountability and helps accelerate the mobilisation of new resources to resume progress towards gender equality.



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